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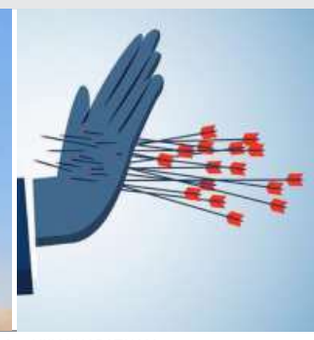
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Hero or Hiroo?

Recognising that global markets could be witnessing a regime change is key

BIG STORY P2



Invest wise.

This World Investor Week (Oct 5-11), put SEBI's safeguards to work for you

YOUR MONEY P3

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Equity bulls have a new competitor in global bonds

PLOT TWIST. Relentless bonds sell-off and soaring yields turn fixed income into an increasingly compelling alternative to equities

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

'...bond markets are continuing to function in an orderly manner' — this was the IMF's reading of global bond markets last week, even as yields were surging across major economies. Economist and Allianz Chief Economic Advisor Dr Mohamed El-Erian described the IMF's comment as 'highly unusual' and said it 'risks raising more questions than it answers' on X.

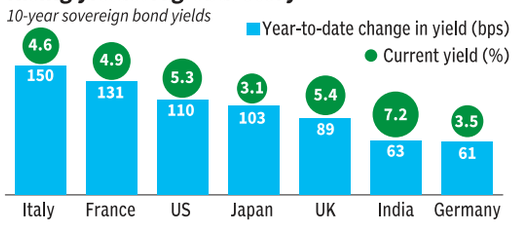
The bond market rout, which has been unabated since the beginning of the US-Iran war, continued its momentum into the week gone by. Sovereign yields of all top 10 global economies surged during the week, except for those of Germany, while China's and Canada's were flat. However, on a year-to-date basis, Germany and Canada too, join the rest in exhibiting a pattern of substantially higher yields now. Only China has bucked this trend.

The week was so chaotic that the CDS spread on French government bonds climbed about 30 bps in just a week to a 13-year high. Some experts are pointing that France could be the next Greece in the making. In fact, German bonds rallying in the second half of the week may largely have to do with investors rotating their French bond positions into German. Across the Atlantic, yields on the US' 10- and 30-year Treasuries hit 24-year peaks, while the US bond market is in its longest drawdowns in the past 50 years. There were also instances during the week when bond yields hardened even as crude oil prices cooled — signalling more structural factors at play.

While we had already warned of the likely implications of such a bond market for equities in our article 'US bond turmoil signals rising global macro pressures' in the same space in our edition dated August 23, 2026, last week's moves reveal that the problem is compounding.

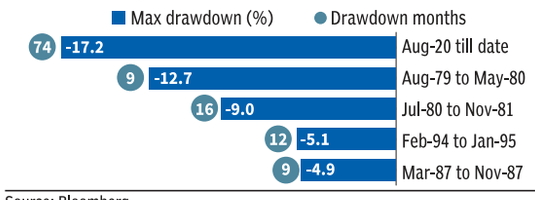
Rising yields: A global story

10-year sovereign bond yields



Deepest, longest drawdown in 50 years

Bloomberg US Aggregate Bond Index



Yields of cash-rich mega-caps harden too

Company	S&P rating	YTM (%)
10-year maturities		
Microsoft	AAA	5.6
Apple	AA+	5.4
Alphabet	AA+	6.0
Nvidia	AA	6.0
Amazon.com	AA	6.0
Meta Platforms	AA-	6.2
Oracle	BBB-	7.5
30-year maturities		
Microsoft	AAA	6.3
Alphabet	AA+	6.7
Amazon.com	AA	6.7
Meta Platforms	AA-	7.3
Oracle	BBB-	8.3

All bonds are ranked senior unsecured, per Bloomberg

Source: Bloomberg

CORPORATE YIELDS UP

As one would naturally expect, the rout has extended to the corporate bond market as well. US-listed long-term corporate bond ETFs namely VCLT, IGLB and SPLB which have an effective duration of around 12 years are down about 8.5 per cent since their 2026 highs in mid-February. The yield-to-maturity (YTM) on these ETFs is currently between 6.2 and 6.6 per cent. Speaking of individual corporate bonds, those of top-rated US tech mega caps currently offer YTMs between 5.4 and 6.2 per cent, for 10-year maturities — in other words, at a spread of 10-90 bps over the 10-year Treasury (see graphic). Yields are even higher for 20- and 30-year maturities.

Some of them are only recent issues and the difference between the coupon at issue and the current yield is staggering. For instance, Nvidia's 10-year bond issued in June this year at 4.95 per cent coupon, yields 5.98 per cent currently — a rise of 103 bps in about three months. Meta's 10-year bond issued in May at 5.25 per cent currently carries a YTM of 6.18 per cent. Further down the rating spectrum, Oracle's 10-year bond issued in February at 5.7 per cent, currently yields 7.48 per cent. The company's investment grade rating of BBB- is just one rung above junk status. One more downgrade could mean yields climb further, as investors such as pension funds that may invest only in investment-grade securities, offload their Oracle holdings.

TINA TO TAMA

That said, what does this situation leave investors in India with? US' Treasuries, considered among the safest and most liquid assets in the world are now yielding 5.3 per cent for 10-year maturities. Now add rupee depreciation of 3.6 per cent (based on mean 10-year rolling returns over the last 25 years), investors get an investment yielding 8.9 per cent per annum, going by this assumption. One could choose a highly rated mega cap corporate's bond or one of the corporate bond ETFs for that extra spread. Returns in that case could work out to 9-10 per cent annually, going by the same rupee depreciation assumption. This is even before factoring in possible gains from capital appreciation of underlying bonds, if one were to be open to take opportunistic calls.

Stacking this up against Nifty's returns of 12.1 per cent, based on mean 10-year rolling returns over the last 15 years, investors now have what could be viewed as a compelling alternative in US Treasuries. With any further spike in yields, US Treasuries could turn out to be instruments offering equity-like returns, without the downside risk and volatility associated with equities. In such an event, even the 13.5 per cent return of the index's total-return twin may not be enough to decisively tilt the scales in its favour.

Ten years ago, when the US 10-year yield was under 2 per cent, this math may not have been this hard to digest. Gone are the days when bonds were competition for bonds themselves. It's time to adapt to an era in which bonds could increasingly compete with equities for investor allocations.

From ABB (anything but bonds), yield spikes are now offering investors BBB (bonding with the best bonds). From TINA (there is no alternative (to equities)), times have now changed to TAMA (there are many alternatives).

Also read Big Story P2

INVESTMENT. FOCUS

ICICI Pru Retirement Fund – Hybrid Aggressive Plan

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

ICICI Prudential Retirement Fund – Hybrid Aggressive Plan has built a strong record since its launch in 2019, aided by an equity-heavy portfolio and a stock-selection approach focussed on earnings improvement.

The fund has outpaced comparable retirement schemes and the aggressive hybrid category on rolling-return measures. Its portfolio reflects a tilt towards mid- and small-cap opportunities.

The debt component provides diversification, while the five-year lock-in can encourage investors to remain committed to their long-term retirement goals.

The trade-offs include lower liquidity, relatively high equity risk and the absence of Section 80C benefits. For investors building a dedicated retirement corpus, the fund could be considered as part of a long-term portfolio.

Details p4

GOLD STRIKE



FINAL FLOURISH. India's Jugraj Singh celebrates after scoring the second goal against Malaysia in the men's hockey final at the Asian Games in Japan on Saturday. Captain Harmanpreet Singh scored 2 goals as India beat Malaysia 5-1 and clinched the gold. The victory also secured India's berth at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics. MOORTHY RV

India's fundamentals remain strong, says FM, lists a four-point strategy to further strengthen economy

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Saturday said India's fundamentals remain intact amid global turbulence and outlined a four-point strategy to further strengthen the economy's resilience to emerging challenges.

Addressing the Kautilya Economic Conclave here, she explained the conference theme — 'Resilience in an Age of Flux' — in the Indian context. According to her, resilience is the capacity to absorb a shock without losing the growth path and to retain the policy space to meet the next shock when it arrives.

"The evidence of resilience lies largely in the counter-factual, in the outcomes that did not materialise: An inflation spiral that did not take hold, queues that did not form at fuel outlets, banking stress that did not surface, and a fiscal correction that was never forced," she said, adding that these counterfactuals deserve as much attention from economists as the headline growth rate.

She said India had navigated the shocks of the past four years with its fundamentals intact, citing 7.8 per cent real GDP growth in Q1 FY27, CPI inflation of 4.82 per cent in August, a current account deficit of 0.5 per cent of GDP in Q1, and foreign exchange reserves of about $766 billion.

RESOURCE SECURITY

With uncertainty now a standing condition,



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman addressing the 5th Kautilya Economic Conclave in New Delhi, on Saturday PTI

Sitharaman outlined four key measures to prepare for emerging challenges.

First, she said, national security requires structural autonomy in strategic inputs. "Strategic resource security sits at the centre of macroeconomic policy." Supply chains optimised for cost alone carry hidden fragility, she added.

"To replace fragile single-source dependencies with domestic operational depth, we have launched the National Critical Mineral Mission, the Rare Earth Corridors, and the India Semiconductor Mission 2.0, and we are focussing on developing the use of Small Modular Reactors (SMRs)," she said.

Second, global economic openness remains important. "Global economic relationships must also remain open, predictable, and rules based. A more resilient global economy will require countries to diversify partnerships, keep markets open, honour commitments, and work together to keep the movement of goods, services, energy and capital as stable and predictable as possible," Sitharaman said.

PRIVATE INVESTMENTS

Third, skill development must prepare people for a changing world of work, she said. AI and frontier technologies are reshaping workplaces, work processes and the competencies required for employment.

Fourth, she called for private investment to lead the investment cycle, including in research and innovation. India's expenditure on R&D stands at 0.83 per cent of GDP, compared with 2.7 per cent for the OECD, while the private sector accounts for only 36 per cent of India's total R&D expenditure.

Raising both the scale of investment and private-sector participation is essential to strengthening India's innovation capacity, she said.

Need to build a financial system that can withstand shocks seen and unseen, says RBI Governor

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The domestic financial system remains resilient, said Reserve Bank of India Governor Sanjay Malhotra even as he flagged several risks.

PK Mishra, Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister, said that resilience is not free and the key question is whether the premium is justified by the risk.

Both were speaking at Kautilya Economic Conclave in the national capital.

Malhotra outlined five priorities for policymakers, stressing that financial stability should focus not on preventing shocks but on strengthening the financial system's ability to withstand and contain their impact. "Today's resilience may not necessarily imply tomorrow's immunity, and we are committed to remain vigilant of emerging vulnerabilities and continue to keep our financial system strong and resilient," he said, highlighting the resilience of the financial system supported by healthy balance-sheets of banks and NBFCs.

SERVICES THAT WORK

He said shocks, whether endogenous or exogenous, are inevitable and the objective should be to build a financial system capable of providing financial services even under severe stress. He also flagged a new generation of systemic risks that are increasingly exogenous, cross-border and interconnected.

The next financial crisis, he said, may not necessarily originate in a bank or even within the financial sector, but could begin with a geo-political event, cyber-attack or technological failure and affect the financial system through multiple channels. He stressed the need to better understand network dependencies and contagion channels while making scenario analysis a cornerstone of risk management. He called for improvements in monitoring and assessment frameworks through better and more granular data.

> Today's resilience may not imply tomorrow's immunity... we are committed to remain vigilant of emerging vulnerabilities
>
> **SANJAY MALHOTRA**
> RBI Governor



On financial innovation, Malhotra said technologies such as artificial intelligence and tokenisation, as well as new forms of financial intermediation, could significantly improve efficiency, but innovation must not undermine the foundations of trust in the financial system. He emphasised sound institutions, settlement finality, singleness of money and financial integrity as fundamental properties that need to be preserved. "The challenge before us is to build a financial system that can withstand shocks that we can anticipate, and even those we cannot yet foresee," he said.

UNCERTAINTY LOOMS

Meanwhile, addressing a plenary session, Mishra said the nature of economic risk has changed significantly, with the world increasingly confronting not merely calculable risks but uncertainty that cannot be reliably assigned probabilities.

The pandemic, geopolitical conflicts, supply-chain disruptions, trade restrictions and rapid technological changes, he said, have brought this distinction into sharp focus.

PSBs clock up to 25% credit growth in Q2

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Public sector banks (PSBs) reported strong credit expansion in the second quarter (Q2) of FY27, with year-on-year (y-o-y) growth ranging from 15 per cent to 25 per cent, even as the gap between credit and deposit growth persists.

Deposit growth has ranged from 7 per cent to 14 per cent y-o-y, trailing credit growth, according to provisional business figures disclosed by five PSBs so far.

The latest RBI data on sectoral deployment of bank credit, for August, showed higher demand than a year ago across all four segments — agriculture and allied activities, industry, services and personal loans.

PNB ADVANCES UP

Punjab National Bank (PNB) reported 14.8 per cent y-o-y growth in gross advances and 9.9 per cent growth in total deposits. As of September-end 2026, gross advances stood at ₹13,42,693 crore and total deposits at ₹17,77,097 crore.

Domestic advances grew 12.59 per cent y-o-y to ₹12,58,583 crore, while domestic deposits rose 9.44 per cent to ₹17,11,696 crore.

The gap between domestic advances and deposit growth stood at 315 basis points as of September-end. One basis point is one-hundredth of a percentage point.

Union Bank of India recorded 18.53 per cent y-o-y growth in gross advances, while total deposits grew 6.87 per cent. As of September-end 2026, gross advances stood at ₹11,55,930 crore and total deposits at ₹13,19,457 crore.

Domestic advances grew 17.36 per cent y-o-y to ₹11,05,807 crore, while domestic deposits rose 6.88 per cent to ₹13,18,977 crore. The gap between domestic advances and deposit growth stood at 1,048 basis points.

INDIAN BANK & OTHERS

Indian Bank reported 16.6 per cent growth in gross advances and 12.4 per cent growth in total deposits. As of September-end 2026, gross advances stood at ₹7.23 lakh crore and total deposits at ₹8.73 lakh crore.

The CASA share of domestic deposits improved to 39.28 per cent from 38.87 per cent a year earlier.

UCO Bank recorded 24.68 per cent jump in gross advances and 14.05 per cent growth in total deposits. As of September-end 2026, gross advances stood at ₹2.88 lakh crore and total deposits at ₹3.49 lakh crore.

Punjab & Sind Bank reported 19.37 per cent y-o-y growth in gross advances and 12.98 per cent rise in total deposits. Gross advances stood at ₹1,26,011 crore and total deposits at ₹1,53,317 crore as of September-end 2026.

A CH-CHE

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WISE WORDS.

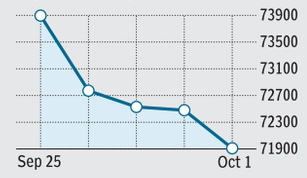
"Two things pop bubbles, booms & bulls – bonds & social upheaval

MICHAEL HARTNETT
Global Market Strategist

MARKET ACTION.

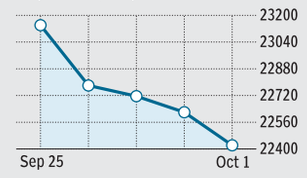
SENSEX

Week ago	Latest	Change (%)
73,896	71,910	▼ -2.7



NIFTY

Week ago	Latest	Change (%)
23,141	22,422	▼ -3.1



Hari Viswanath
bl. research bureau



HERO OR HIROO?

Recognising the possibility that global markets could be witnessing a structural change is the most important message to take away from the bond tantrums playing out in developed countries

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

It is hard to keep track of significant changes when you are not paying attention, but it can be even harder to keep track when you are wide awake and alert, yet trapped in the illusion of an expired era. Take the real-life example of Hiroo Onoda, a soldier in the Imperial Japanese Army. In December 1944, he was tasked with defending a Philippine island from the Allied invasion and ordered never to surrender. The mission failed, the island fell, and the war officially concluded by August 1945. Yet, Onoda took to the jungles and kept "fighting" a non-existent war until March 1974.

While a few of his comrades who had initially followed him and engaged in guerrilla warfare with locals, defected or died over the years, he went on relentlessly. Throughout those three decades, every effort to communicate that the war was over—via dropping leaflets and sending search parties—was dismissed by him as an enemy hoax. He refused to accept the paradigm of the new world until his original commander (who by the way had surrendered soon after giving orders to Onoda to not surrender) finally tracked him down and ordered him to stand down. His stubbornness to not accept reality or at least be open to the possibility that things could have changed had staggering consequences.

A similar stubbornness could be playing out in stock markets today, where one era may have ended and another on course. In an article titled 'One up on the Great Humiliator' published in the Big Story section in *bl.portfolio* edition dated January 4, 2026, we had mentioned in our equities outlook that *"As markets enter 2026, it is the most complicated environment in years and investors will have to play it by the ear."*

While optimism amongst market participants was abounding with lofty year-end Sensex and Nifty targets, we had cautioned against it stating that a few factors — tightening global liquidity that was impacting capital flows and valuations were risks to factor in while making investing decisions. We had also mentioned that the AI bubble and worsening geopolitics clouded the outlook further (https://tinyurl.com/greathumiliator). With these factors impacting markets this year, one more challenge has got added – the possibility that the global markets could be witnessing a regime change from easy money to hard/tight money. A world where the cost of capital is determined by market demand and supply, and not by distortions created by global central banks – this probably is the most important message to take away from the bond tantrums playing out in developed countries today.

Consequently, the hangover effects of the era of easy money that was seeded by the central banks in the aftermath of the global financial crisis and subsequently morphed into the most important force driving markets over the previous decade may have ended. Irrespective of whether market participants acknowledge or not, markets will eventually have to adjust. To understand how this regime shift may impact markets, let us first understand how the reverse played out.

WHEN A CENTURY-OLD PLAYBOOK FLIPPED

It is said that monetary policy impacts the economy with long and variable lags. While this was often said in the context of influencing the level of inflation and economic activity, it has also had its impact on investor sentiment and decisions. For example, for many years after the global central banks embarked on the zero-interest rate regime and quantitative easing, market valuations continued to remain modest. Few years during the economic recovery from troughs of global financial crisis the S&P 500 valuations remained modest (refer Phase 1 in charts 1 and 2). Back then, markets were still under the hangover of the era prior to 2007 when the cost of capital was more market-determined and less distorted by central bank actions.

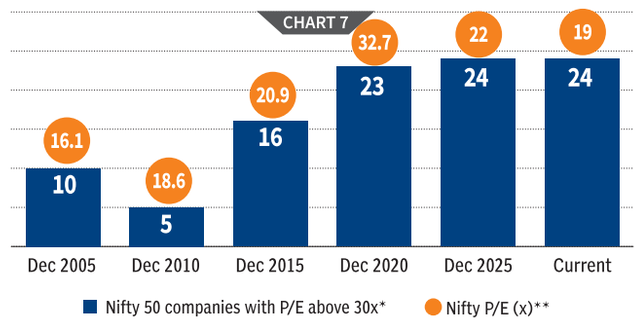
As the phase continued, markets got emboldened to the new era, and probably rightly so. After all, money chases yields all the time except in times of great fear, uncertainty and doubt (FUD). But the central bank backstop laid to rest all the FUD. Equity yields (1/PE) was substantially superior to zero to marginal yield on bonds. However, the higher the equities went and the valuations moved up, equity yields still remained superior and attractive versus bond yields (see charts 3 and 4). As years went by, markets and many investors adjusted to the new normal. There were also a few who did not adjust, famous ones amongst them as well.

Take John Hussman, for example. A market veteran with an impeccable ability to pick value stocks and make prescient bubble calls had a challenging time during the last decade. Just three days before the dotcom bubble peaked on March 10, 2000, he published a note warning that '*valuations will begin to matter with a vengeance*' and based on his valuation analysis, warned of a potential 65-83 per cent decline in technology stocks and also added, '*If you understand values and market history, you know we're not joking.*' And so prescient he was that the tech-heavy Nasdaq 100 index fell 83 per cent from its peak during the 2000-02 bear market. Similarly in April 2007, in his investor newsletter at the peak of the housing bubble, he noted, '*But to rule out a decline of 30-40 per cent on the S&P 500 would be to rule out a move to valuations that have historically been standard, normal, commonplace.*" While S&P still managed a 10 per cent gain from its April 2007 levels during the course of the year, it did fall 50 per cent from April 2007 levels to its March 2009 trough.

However, in the era of distorted cost of capital due to central bank interventions, his view in 2014 that the US markets were in a bubble and that it could be worse than 1929, fell flat. Markets continued to compound through the rest of the decade. Years later, in a note titled, 'Being wrong in an interesting way' in May 2017, he acknowledged his errors stating – '*Clearly, our persistent defensiveness in response to overvalued, overbought, over bullish conditions was wrong in the face of zero interest rate policy*' and '*The lesson was that in the presence of zero interest rates, yield-seeking speculation can persist even in the face of obscene valuations and recklessly overextended conditions*'. In May 2024, in another note, he reflected on his past calls gone wrong stating, '*My openly admitted error in the face of zero interest rate policies was to believe that speculation still had a limit, as it historically had.*' This was in reference to the fact that while history served as an useful tool to make market predictions, in the context of the regime change to the era of zero interest rates and liquidity gush, which had no parallels in history, past data and analysis were insufficient.

Nifty valuation has steadily got more expensive

CHART 7



*includes invalid P/E companies **based on total market capitalisation

Another example is Jeremy Grantham (Co-Founder of global asset management company GMO), a storied value investor with a stellar record for prescient market calls till early last decade. True to his conviction in value investing, he stayed out of irrationally-priced growth stocks during the dotcom bubble. Consequently, in the run-up to the last 15-20 months of the dotcom bubble peak, the asset allocation division of GMO, which he ran, lost half of its investment book as investors lost patience due to his funds' underperformance and withdrew their capital. Although under tremendous pressure from investors to pivot to buying the dotcom stocks that were in bubble territory, he stayed put. In May 2000, in a debate with dotcom bull Henry Blodget, he made a point that sooner or later, the S&P 500 would decline 50 per cent and the Nasdaq 70 per cent from their highs. He couldn't have been more right and the breaking of the bubble in 2000 turned out be a great vindication of his value-investing principles.

He, too, has suffered a similar fate as John Hussman when it came to his bubble calls over the last 10 years. Unfortunately, there are more tragic cases like that of Charles de Vaulx. A famed value investor with solid reputation, the asset management firm he co-founded – International Value Advisors had managed around $20 billion in assets at its peak, but the AUM had dwindled to around $2 billion by end-2020/early-2021 as value funds underperformed even more after the giant monetary and fiscal stimulus unleashed in 2020. After liquidating his fund, one April afternoon in 2021 he walked into his 10th floor office in Manhattan and jumped to his death.

GETTING OUTFOXED

Thus, many of the best in class in the investing world got outfoxed in the era of easy money. The market structure changed so much that in recent years, good news on the US economy was greeted with down markets while negative news was greeted with a positive reaction. For example, a weak monthly jobs data in the US (less jobs created), which ideally indicates a weaker economy, would be greeted at market opening with bond yields going down (Fed less likely to raise rates) and stock markets going up (this happened last Friday as well) — implying liquidity and interest rates mattered more for stocks than fundamentals!

Many who understood this early on and pivoted generated great wealth, but for some of those only till the interest rate shock of 2022 when the Fed embarked on its massive rate hike program after nearly 14 years of zero to low interest rate regime. A good example here is Arne Alsin and his fund Worm Capital. An article in the *Institutional Investor* explains how Arne Alsin pivoted after he realised his value style of investing was not working post 2008. So at some point he "just totally gave up and said, 'I'm going to do the exact opposite." He apparently discarded every investment principle he had once held. As mentioned in the article, 'Alsin switched from being a classic Warren Buffett-style value investor who scoured balance sheets to being one who obsessively embraced the disruptive promises of Silicon Valley and the new economy.' This enabled him to make early bets in stocks like Amazon in 2012 and Tesla in 2016, and consequently he made exceptional gains, beating his peers. However, things have got volatile for him since 2022.

Since the 2022 interest rate shock, while some of the funds like that of Alsin's and Cathie Wood's ARK Capital started facing pressure as growth fads without earnings (barring those in AI) have got crushed, broader markets globally have continued to trend up as the AI theme, stronger economic and earnings growth and passive or price/valuation-insensitive buying have continued to feed the market rally.

As mentioned earlier, interest rates act with long and variable lags not just in the economy but in stock markets and the sentiment surrounding it as well. As it did take three-five years post 2008 for broader markets to appreciate the zero interest rate regime, so too may be the case today. While interest rates started increasing in 2022, and have remained high, global 10-year bond yields today testing two-three-decade-old levels could be signals that the 'long and variable lag' effect is in its final phase.

Adapting to the new (old) normal

To the surge of easy money of the previous decade was added the force of fiscal profligacy, from 2020. While the cost of capital has been increasing since 2022, fiscal profligacy continues in many developed economies. Bond yields, today, are giving a push back to such fiscal profligacy.

In this context, investing decisions must include a debate on what is the right valuation to buy a stock when interest rates are higher than in the last two decades, and government spending probably gets curbed in reaction to the surging bond yields.

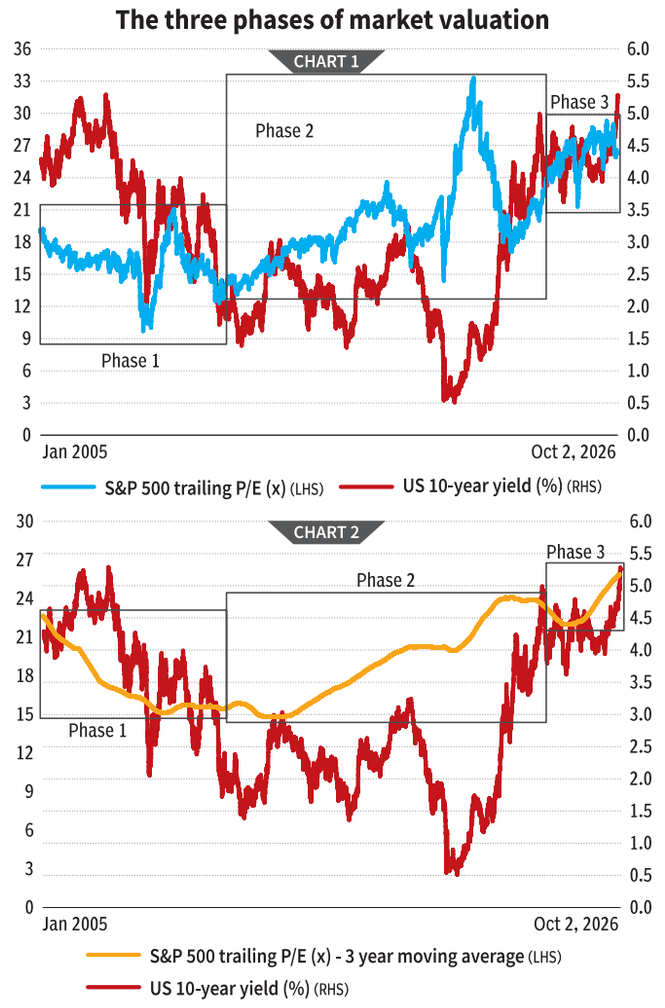
Investors need to be alert to possibly pivoting to the pre-2007 era investing style, if warranted. Investors in India must note that just as a rising tide lifts all boats, this had its impact across global markets including India with foreign flows chasing yields, making the demand-supply dynamics favourable for valuations to expand. Paint, FMCG, Private banks and IT Services stocks reaching obscene valuation levels in 2021 was not just about performance but also the global liquidity regime. The FII's equity outflows exceeding a staggering ₹4 lakh crore over the last two years clearly indicate that cost of capital and valuation matter more than ever now in the last two decades.

As the new regime evolves, global and domestic capital flows are going to get rewired in ways that are hard to predict. In such an environment, absolute valuation and the margin of safety are factors that will matter more. Mean reversion in valuation, and corporate profit margins too may play out. Valuation averages of the last five years might be less reliable metrics given they played out in an era of higher liquidity and fiscal profligacy. So averages of the last many decades might matter more.

2008-25 was an era where more wealth was made in the stock markets than in the real economy. We are likely now shifting to an era where, for a while, more wealth will be created in the real economy than in stock markets (see charts 5 and 6)– implying valuation compression to levels that is more in sync with cost of capital in the new (old) era. As Milton Friedman said: ***The stock market and economy are two different things***. The adjustment process likely has started. Those sleeping through, risk being the next Hiroo Onoda.

The three phases of market valuation

CHART 1



Phase 1 - PE valuation remained low even when bond yields declined as markets stuck to pre-GFC regime; **Phase 2 -** PE valuation increases as markets adjust to 'new normal' of ZIRP or zero interest rate regime; **Phase 3 -** PE valuation remains elevated even as bond yields spike. Markets emboldened to assuming 'new normal' is permanent and not alert to possible regime change of back to pre-GFC when it comes to cost of capital

As PE rose equities remained attractive; not anymore

CHART 3

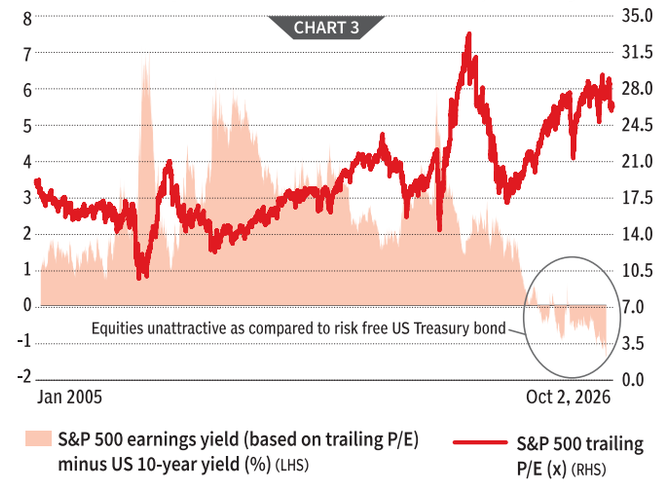
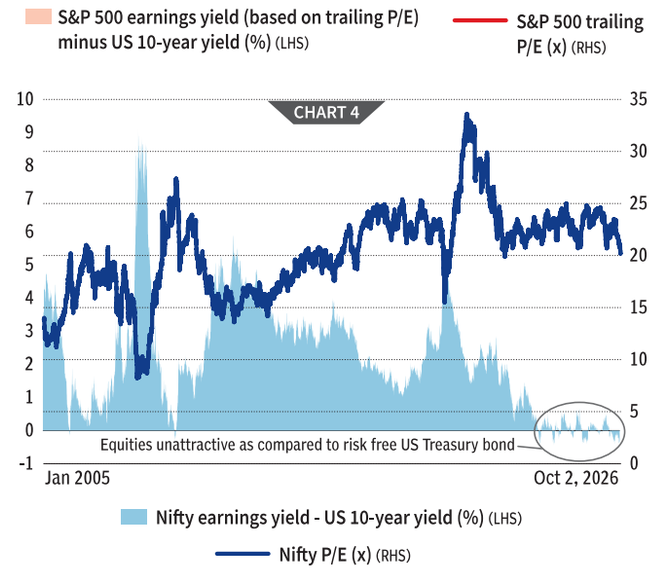


CHART 4



Market cap vs GDP — curved lines that converge every once in a while

Two lines will converge when the real economy outperforms stock markets

CHART 5 ₹ lakh crore

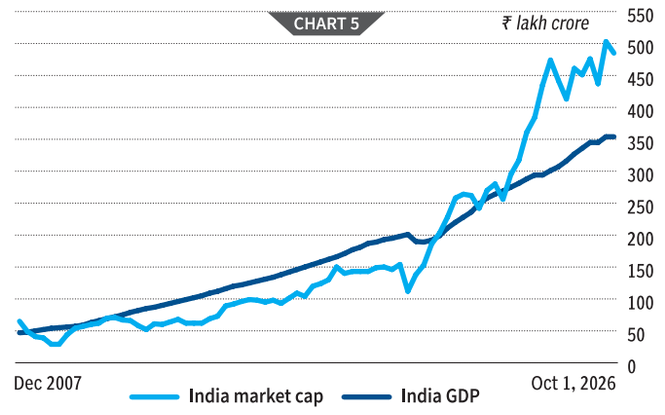
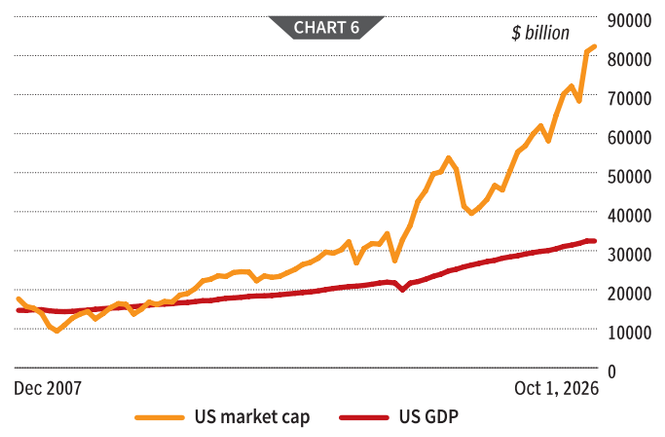


CHART 6 $ billion



Source for raw data: Bloomberg, Capitaline

Put SEBI's safeguards to work for you



INVEST WISE. World Investor Week, October 5-11, puts the spotlight on tools that help protect your money, resolve complaints and recover forgotten investments

GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Before sending money to a broker or adviser, how do you check whether the bank account belongs to them? If your complaint goes unanswered, where do you take it? Can you find a mutual fund investment for which you no longer have the paperwork? These are everyday investor problems. Several measures, introduced by market regulator SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India) in recent years, can help investors in these scenarios and more.

World Investor Week 2026, being observed from October 5 to 11 under the aegis of the International Organization of Securities Commissions (IOSCO) and SEBI, is an opportunity to put the spotlight back on tools and measures that can help protect your money, resolve complaints and recover forgotten investments.

CAVEAT EMPTOR

More knowledge creates greater awareness. To protect your investments, it helps to understand the kinds of scams being perpetrated and the warning signs behind them. SEBI orders relating to stock market scams and investigations offer useful insights into how such misconduct is carried out, detected and investigated. For instance, our article headlined *Know 5 governance traps that destroy investor wealth* (https://tinyurl.com/corpgovsebi) in *bl.portfolio* edition May 3, 2026, analysed over 500 pages of SEBI orders, turning regulatory findings into warning signs investors could watch for.

You can access the latest SEBI order in this link: https://tinyurl.com/sebiorders. SEBI orders show how frauds and governance failures actually unfold: diversion of funds, related-party dealings, false disclosures, price manipulation, insider trading and misuse of investor money. Reading them helps investors recognise warning signs, understand investigative methods, question reported numbers and promoter actions and avoid relying only on market narratives.

UNIQUE TOOLS

A person claiming to represent a registered intermediary sends you a payment link or QR code. The name looks familiar. Should you pay?

First, verify the destination. In October 2025, SEBI rolled out validated UPI handles with the '@valid' identifier and SEBI Check. Investors can access SEBI Check through the SEBI website (https://tinyurl.com/sebicheck) or the **Saa₹thi app** — Android: https://tinyurl.com/androidsebi and App Store: https://tinyurl.com/applesebi — and verify an intermediary's UPI ID or bank-account details before transferring money.

Hence, you have a way to check payment account details independently instead of trusting the message that supplied them. This is particularly useful against fraudsters and scamsters.

Your trading app needs attention too. In March 2026, SEBI launched a Verified Label on Google Play for stock-trading apps of SEBI-registered brokers. Look for it when downloading an app, rather than installing one simply because somebody sent you a link. Stock trading apps offered by SEBI-registered entities now display a 'Verified' label on the Google Play Store, with the facility set to be extended to apps of other regulated intermediaries. This badge helps investors easily identify genuine apps and make impersonation more difficult.

Phone calls are another entry point for impersonation. SEBI has advised regulated entities to use the '1600' number series for service and transactional calls to existing customers. For instance, HDFC Mutual Fund's verified transactional and service-related calls originate from the official 1600-313139 number. The '1600' series is intended to help people recognise official communication. It does not mean that every call from another number is fraudulent. When an unexpected caller seeks money or sensitive information, independently contact the entity before proceeding.

Apply the same approach to social media. A large following does not establish the credentials or genuineness of the person. Check the broker or adviser in SEBI's registered-intermediary directory. You can access the directory online in this link: https://tinyurl.com/sebidirectory

INVESTOR TOOLKIT

- SEBI Check verifies payment account details independently
- SCORES handles unresolved investor complaints online
- SMART ODR resolves disputes through arbitration
- MITRA helps trace forgotten mutual-fund folios
- Saa₹thi offers free investor education resources

SOLVING DISPUTES

You have complained to an intermediary, but the reply does not resolve the problem. Sending the same email repeatedly need not be your only option.

Investors can use SEBI's online complaint-redressal platform, SCORES (https://tinyurl.com/sebiscores) as a route for grievances against brokers, mutual funds and other intermediaries, as well as listed companies. Its upgraded version, SCORES 2.0, allows investors to lodge and track complaints, while providing automatic routing and escalation if grievances are not resolved in time. The timeline for entities to address investor complaints was reduced from 30 to 21 calendar days. Investors also have two levels of review if they remain dissatisfied with the response.

Start by raising the matter with the entity concerned. Save the complaint, acknowledgement and reply, along with transaction records and other supporting documents. If the issue remains unresolved, use SCORES to explain the problem and the remedy you seek. Track the response and review deadlines. Shareholders of a listed company can use SCORES to lodge investor grievances against that company, after first taking the issue up with the company itself.

For disputes that need conciliation or arbitration, investors can use SMART ODR, or Securities Market Approach for Resolution Through Online Dispute Resolution (https://tinyurl.com/smartodr). Introduced under SEBI's 2023 framework, it provides an online mechanism for investors and market participants to resolve securities-market disputes. In simple terms, SCORES is the route for complaints, while SMART ODR is for disputes that require conciliation or arbitration. For example, if a broker does not respond to a complaint about an incorrect charge, use SCORES.

If the broker disputes your claim and the matter needs formal resolution, SMART ODR can take it to conciliation or arbitration.

Sometimes, the problem is an investment you have lost track of. Perhaps you bought a mutual fund years ago, changed your address and stopped receiving statements. Or family records mention an investment without enough details to locate it. MITRA, the Mutual Fund Investment Tracing and Retrieval Assistant, was established in 2025 to help investors trace inactive and unclaimed mutual fund folios. Investors can search using credentials such as PAN and authenticate through an OTP sent to their registered mobile number or email. If a match is found, MITRA identifies the mutual fund concerned, after which the investor can approach the fund house to retrieve the investment. Check it here: https://tinyurl.com/mfmitra

Nomination deserves a place in the same exercise. Under SEBI's modified rules for demat accounts and mutual-fund folios, investors can register three nominees and submit or change nominations. For new single accounts and folios, investors must either provide a nominee or formally opt out, while nomination is optional for jointly held accounts. The rules were further modified in May 2026. Investors should, therefore, check whether a nominee is registered in each demat account and mutual fund folio, whether the details are current, and whether the allocation among nominees still reflects their wishes.

Demat-account nomination can be checked or updated through the broker/depository participant or the relevant CDSL or NSDL facility.

KNOW MORE

In the age of AI you do not have to pay for a course or buy an investment product to learn the basics. AI tools apart, the free SEBI Investor website and Saa₹thi 2.0 app offer educational material on securities, mutual funds, market processes, frauds and investor safeguards. The SEBI Investor website also provides an overview of fundamental and technical analysis, covering financial statements, valuation ratios, price trends, and commonly used technical indicators, along with online links to more educational material. Start with questions relevant to your next investment: What am I buying? What risks could cause a loss? What charges will I pay? How easily can I exit? For stocks, learn to examine the business, earnings, debt and valuation rather than relying only on tips or recent price movements. If someone promises assured returns or pressures you to transfer money quickly, verify the person, product and claim independently before acting.

Finally, use your rights as a shareholder. SEBI's single-login framework allows individual shareholders holding securities in demat mode to access e-voting through their depository or demat-account login, without separately registering with different e-voting service providers. Depository platforms such as CDSL's MyEasi and NSDL's SPEED-e also provide investors with unified access to information, including a consolidated view of demat holdings across the two depositories.

This Investor Week, take time to become more aware of the tools and resources at your disposal and know when to use them. These small steps can help you protect your investments, resolve problems faster and stay better prepared on your journey towards financial freedom.

Tax query

Tax matters can be complex.

Send your queries to **taxtalk@thehindu.co.in**
We will get them answered by an expert

Interest rates on home loans (%)

Institution	Loan amount		
	Under ₹30 lakh	₹30 to 75 lakh	Over ₹75 lakh
BANKS (Floating rates)			
Axis Bank	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10
Bank of Baroda	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95
Bank of India	7.10-10	7.10-10	7.10-10
Bank of Maharashtra	7.0-9.65	7.0-9.65	7.0-9.65
Canara Bank	7.15-10	7.10-10	7.05-9.90
Central Bank	7.0-8.75	7.0-8.75	7.0-8.75
DBS Bank	<=8.70	<=8.70	<=8.70
Dhanlaxmi Bank	>=7.65	>=7.65	>=7.65
Federal Bank	7.35-9.6	7.35-9.6	7.35-9.6
HDFC Bank	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20
ICICI Bank	>=7.55	>=7.55	>=7.55
Indian Bank	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55
IOB	7.20-8.30	7.20-8.30	7.20-8.30
IDBI Bank	7.40-11.90	7.40-11.90	7.40-11.90
J&K Bank	>= 7.25	>= 7.25	>= 7.25
Karnataka Bank	7.51-11.83	7.51-11.83	7.51-11.83
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Kotak Mahindra Bank	>=7.60	>=7.60	>=7.60
Punjab National Bank	7.25-9.10	7.20-9.10	7.20-9.0
Punjab & Sind Bank	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75
RBL Bank	>= 9.0	>= 9.0	>= 9.0
State Bank of India	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55	7.25-8.55
South Indian Bank	>=7.25	>=7.25	>=7.25
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30
BANKS (Fixed rates)			
Indian Bank	9.20-9.40	9.20-9.40	9.20-9.40
Bank of Baroda	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95
Punjab National Bank	8.25-10.60	8.20-10.60	8.20-10.50
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Floating rates)			
Tata Capital	>=7.50	>=7.50	>=7.50
PNB Housing	7.75-10.05	7.60-10.05	7.50-9.95
Central Bank Housing	10-12.85	10-12.85	10-12.35
Samman Capital	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
Aditya Birla Housing Fin	>=7.75	>=7.75	>=7.75
Bajaj Finserv	7.25-20	7.25-20	7.25-20
GIC Housing Finance	>=8.80	>=8.80	>=8.80
Sundaram Home Finance *	>=10.65	>=10.65	>=10.65
Piramal Finance Limited	>=9.99	>=9.99	>=9.99
IIFL Home Finance	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
LIC Housing Finance	7.15-9.65	7.15-9.75	7.15-10.10
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Fixed rates)			
LIC Housing Finance	10-10.25	10-10.25	10-10.25

Note: Rates that vary with tenures or credit score within the specified loan amounts are indicated as a range. Fixed interest rates may be subject to a revision after a specified tenure. Rates may also apply only for a definite period and change to floating thereafter. Data taken from respective bank's website as on Oct 02, 2026. Contributed by BankBazaar.com. *Annual percentage rate;

ALERTS.

SEBI pushes investor awareness messages

Market regulator SEBI has directed stock brokers to prominently display investor-awareness messages on their websites and trading apps under Project Jagrook, its nationwide investor-awareness initiative. From October 5 to October 31, brokers must display SEBI's investor-awareness messages and existing risk disclosures on their websites. During this period, displaying the awareness messages on trading apps will be voluntary. From November 1, brokers will have to display the prescribed investor-awareness messages on the landing page of their websites. On trading apps, brokers must display the messages and risk disclosures on alternate days, with the messages appearing on the landing page. SEBI said the investor-awareness messages may be modified from time to time.

Dhanvesttor targets financial literacy for over 2 lakh women

Dhanvesttor, a women-focused wealth management firm with a social impact mission, said it plans to expand its footprint into North and West India, with a target to provide financial literacy to over two lakh women in 12-18 months. It combines wealth management with community-led learning designed to help women make informed financial decisions.

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Last date: 09.10.2026, 5.00 PM.

For Tender Forms, Terms and Conditions and further details, please visit the above website.

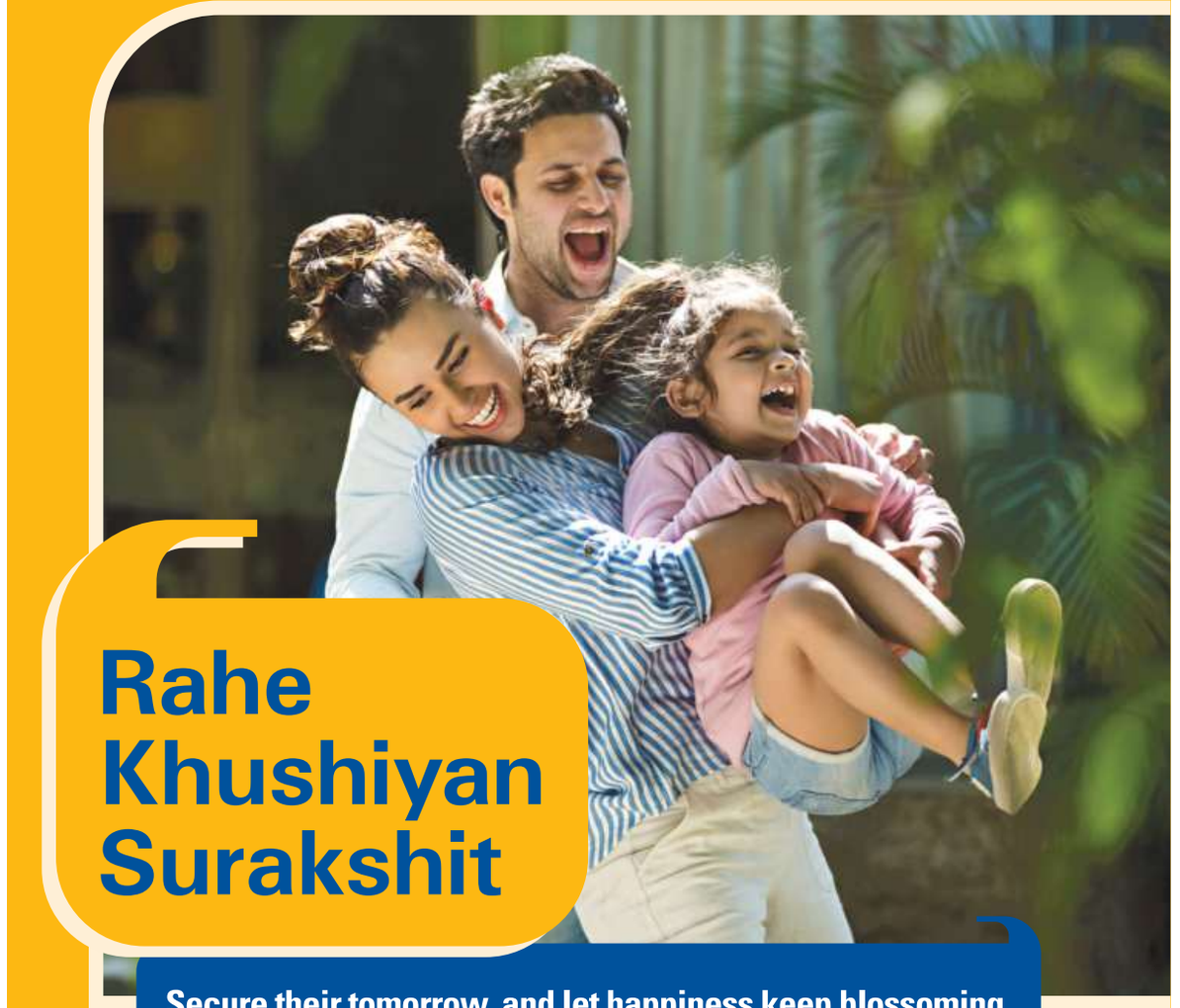
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CHENNAI
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SUNDAY - OCTOBER 4 - 2026

◉ **FUND VIEW.** **ICICI Prudential Retirement Fund – Hybrid Aggressive Plan**

Retirement savings with an equity edge

Combines equity-led growth with a measured debt allocation, but comes with a mandatory lock-in



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Retirement funds offered by mutual funds have recently seen a regulatory shake-up. There are 29 such schemes under the solution-oriented category, managing over ₹33,400 crore.

In February 2026, SEBI announced the discontinuation of solution-oriented schemes, including retirement and children's funds, and introduced Life Cycle Funds as a new category. In March, however, it revised the framework and allowed fund houses to retain their existing retirement and children's funds, subject to restrictions on launching Life Cycle Funds of certain tenures.

Consequently, AMCs retaining their retirement funds can launch only four Life Cycle Fund variants, compared with the maximum six otherwise permitted. Following this relaxation, almost all fund houses chose to retain their existing retirement schemes.

Retirement funds are open-ended schemes designed to build long-term wealth for investors after retirement. They allow fund managers to vary equity and debt exposure within specified limits. AMCs can offer up to four variants based on asset allocation, equity, aggressive hybrid, conservative hybrid and pure debt. For instance, HDFC Mutual Fund offers three variants, while ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund offers all four. These schemes generally have a mandatory lock-in period of five years or until the investor turns 60, whichever is earlier.

However, only a handful qualify for tax benefits under Section 80C. This allows eligible investments of up to ₹1.5 lakh a year to be deducted from taxable income under the old tax regime.

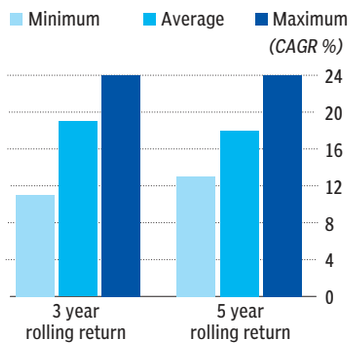
Among these schemes, ICICI Prudential Retirement Fund – Hybrid Aggressive Plan has been one of the better performers. Similar to aggressive hybrid funds, it allocates around 80 per cent of its portfolio to equities, with the balance invested in debt. It has outperformed several retirement schemes with similar mandates as well as the aggressive hybrid fund category.

Since its launch in February 2019, the fund has delivered a CAGR of 14 per cent. However, it does not qualify for tax benefits under Section 80C. As of August 2026, the fund managed assets worth ₹1,321 crore.

POINTS TO NOTE

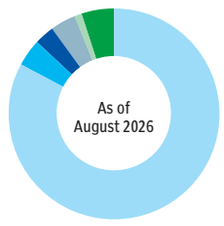
- Flexible allocation supports retirement investing
- Lock-in encourages long-term investing discipline
- Midcap exposure raises portfolio volatility

How the fund performed on rolling return basis



The chart illustrates the fund's performance based on 3-year and 5-year rolling returns calculated from the last seven years NAV history, highlighting the minimum, average, and maximum returns achieved over these periods.
Source: ACEMF Value as of Oct 1, 2026

Portfolio asset class break-up (%)



Equity	83.0
Government securities	4.0
AAA rated bonds	3.0
AA rated bonds	4.0
REIT	1.0
Cash & others	5.0

ing on companies approaching an earnings turnaround.

It looks for businesses where much of the negative sentiment is already priced in and earnings are expected to improve over the next few quarters. The strategy is to identify such opportunities early and hold the stocks as long as earnings momentum persists.

Stock selection is driven primarily by earnings prospects and revisions. The fund looks for companies whose earnings potential is underappreciated by the market, as well as businesses poised for strong growth on favourable business-cycle trends. Valuations are assessed based on the potential for re-rating or de-rating rather than absolute P/E multiples. As per the latest portfolio, the top 10 equity holdings accounted for about 23 per cent of the fund's overall assets.

Market-cap allocation is an outcome of stock selection rather than a predetermined target. Over the past five years, the fund has allocated an average 48 per cent of its total assets to large-cap stocks, 16 per cent to mid-caps and 13 per cent to small-caps.

Currently, mid- and small-cap exposure stands at 19 per cent and 18 per cent, respectively, reflecting the fund manager's assessment of better earnings opportunities in these segments. With nearly 80 per cent of its portfolio invested in equities, the fund is exposed to market volatility. Its significant allocation to mid- and small-cap stocks further increases the risk, particularly during market corrections.

The fund is currently overweight on banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI), capital goods, and metals and mining, while underweight on information technology and consumer staples.

Banks, retailing and industrial products are its three largest sector exposures. Over the past year, it has increased allocation to banks, insurance and healthcare services, while reducing exposure to transport services, finance, and cement and cement products.

DEBT STRATEGY

On the debt side, the fund invests across permissible debt instruments including government securities, corporate debt and money market instruments. Given its aggressive hybrid mandate and the scheme's lock-in period, the fund is comfortable taking relatively higher duration exposure.

Over the past five years, the fund's Macaulay duration has ranged from 0.3 to 4.9 years. As of August 2026, it stood at 2.9 years, with a portfolio yield to maturity (YTM) of 6.8 per cent. The portfolio had 4 per cent exposure to government securities, 3 per cent to AAA-rated and 4 per cent to AA-rated assets. It also held about 1 per cent in REITs and 5 per cent in cash equivalents.

PERFORMANCE

Over the past seven years, the fund's five-year rolling returns averaged 18 per cent CAGR, compared with 14 per cent for the average of six other retirement schemes with similar investment mandates. The aggressive hybrid fund category averaged 15 per cent over the same period. The fund's five-year rolling returns ranged from 12.8 per cent to 24.4 per cent during this period.

On a three-year rolling-return basis, the fund delivered an average CAGR of 19 per cent, compared with 14 per cent for its relevant peers.

The fund's annualised standard deviation, a measure of volatility, stood at 16.6 per cent, higher than the aggressive hybrid fund category average of 13.5 per cent.

The regular plan has a base expense ratio of 1.85 per cent, lower than the category average of 1.92 per cent.

The direct plan's expense ratio is 0.72 per cent, also below the category average of 0.87 per cent.

Unlike aggressive hybrid funds, retirement funds have a mandatory lock-in, which can help investors maintain discipline and avoid premature withdrawals. However, this comes at the cost of liquidity, and the scheme does not offer Section 80C tax benefits. It is, therefore, more suitable for investors specifically earmarking investments for retirement rather than those seeking flexibility.

Anthropic braves November chill

GLOBAL VIEW. An IPO launch would see the AI giant break from the trend of deferred market debuts

Bloomberg

Anthropic PBC is seeking to go public as soon as the middle of November, according to people familiar with the matter, after the artificial intelligence model maker pushed back plans to list.

The firm behind Claude could start formal marketing for its IPO as soon as the week of November 9, putting it in line to begin trading before Thanksgiving, the people said. Dealmaking typically grinds to a halt in the days around the holiday, which is on November 26.

Anthropic is still expected to make its debut no later than the end of the year, the people said.

Deliberations are ongoing and the timeline could continue to shift, they said, asking not to be identified as the information isn't public.



REUTERS

CONCERNS ABOUND

Anthropic, ascendant for much of this year, now faces renewed competition from the likes of OpenAI, which has gained sales momentum in recent months. The companies are also at the centre of mounting public scrutiny over AI safety after a string of high-profile hacking incidents by rogue agents, ramping up concern about the potential impact on Anthropic's market debut.

Chief Executive Officer Dario Amodei published an essay on his personal website arguing the speed at which new AI models are advancing must be slowed down. OpenAI, a chief rival to Anthropic, has postponed its IPO plans, with CEO Sam Altman arguing it'd be ill-advised to go public now.

The concern doesn't appear to have discouraged prospective investors, who believe a fair valuation for Anthropic is in the $1.8-trillion to $2-trillion ballpark, some of the people said. The company expects to match or beat the size of SpaceX's IPO.

Anthropic had a net loss of almost $42 billion in 2025, a roughly five-fold increase from about $8.3 billion the year before.

DELAYED IPOS

Anthropic is set to meet prospective investors on October 14 at its San Francisco headquarters in preparation for the IPO, people familiar with the matter have said. Powering ahead with an IPO would see Anthropic defy the string of delays and postponements in the market for new listings.

Oura Inc. was the third company in a matter of weeks to formally postpone its debut just hours before a planned first-time share-sale, after some potential buyers balked at a fully-diluted valuation target of about $15 billion.

A range of other companies have seen their targeted timelines slip as the performance for this year's class of IPOs stumbled., data compiled by Bloomberg show. The figure sharply lags a 12 per cent return for the S&P 500 Index and a 20 per cent gain for the tech-heavy Nasdaq 100 this year.

◉ **STUMBLING LISTINGS**

When removing SpaceX and SK Hynix Inc.'s record-setting listings, the weighted-average return for the more than 100 newly-listed stocks is a loss of 4 per cent

ALERTS.

HDFC FTSE India Equity ETF NFO closes Oct 7



HDFC Asset Management Company, investment manager to HDFC Mutual Fund (HDFC MF), has launched HDFC FTSE India Equity ETF. This is an open-ended scheme replicating/tracking the FTSE India Equity Index (TRI). The New Fund Offer (NFO) period closes on October 7. The scheme seeks to generate returns that are commensurate (before fees and expenses) with the performance of the FTSE India Equity Index (TRI), over long term, subject to tracking error. The FTSE India Equity Index offers exposure to approximately 90 per cent of the market capitalisation of the FTSE India All Cap Index and comprises 276 constituents.

Motilal Oswal Nifty REITs & Realty Index Fund open



Motilal Oswal Mutual Fund has announced the launch of its latest fund offer, Motilal Oswal Nifty REITs & Realty Index Fund. The scheme is an open-ended scheme replicating/tracking the Nifty REITs & Realty Total Return Index (TRI), subject to tracking error, providing exposure to India's listed REITs and real estate companies. The Motilal Oswal Nifty REITs & Realty Index Fund provides exposure to listed REITs and realty companies through a transparent, index-based approach. The index is reviewed and rebalanced quarterly. The NFO period closes October 9.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹) as on Oct 01	Price (₹) as on Oct 01	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
ETF				
Mirae NYSE FANG+ ETF	179.7	248.2	4.1	2,386
Mirae Asset S&P500 Top50	68.5	101.5	3.1	3,492
SBI Private Bank ETF	273.1	278.3	1.4	17
UTI Nifty 5 Yr G-Sec ETF	65.7	66.5	1.3	6
SBI IT ETF	314.0	313.3	0.4	22
Nippon India Nifty IT ETF	31.5	31.4	0.3	40,524
UTI Nifty IT ETF	298.0	297.3	0.2	3
GOLD ETFs				
Zerodha Gold ETF	23.1	23.2	-2.1	42,201
Mirae Asset Gold ETF	143.0	143.1	-2.2	5,563
Baroda BNPP Gold ETF	142.3	141.9	-2.3	30

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on October 1, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Oct 01	Returns (% CAGR) 3-year	5-year	10-year	Assets (₹ cr)
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
ICICI Pru Pension	70	9	9	12	32,619
UTI Pension	67	9	8	12	5,827
Kotak Pension	63	8	8	12	4,874
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
ABSL Pension	19	7	6	-	3,626
UTI Pension	37	6	6	7	4,465
LIC Pension	31	6	6	7	9,328
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension	31	8	7	8	36,660
ICICI Pru Pension	46	7	6	8	14,933
SBI Pension	47	7	6	8	16,782
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
ICICI Pru Pension	55	9	9	12	865
ABSL Pension	28	9	8	-	56
Kotak Pension	56	8	8	12	233

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on October 01, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR) 1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	379	21.3	19.1	23.7
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE Bluechip	4	8.7	16.6	15.4
ICICI Pru	Largecap	945	11.1	18.8	15.0
Nippon Life India	Absolute Freedom	NA	10.7	15.8	13.6
MULTI CAP					
New Berry Capitals	Seeking Alpha	9	22.8	18.8	42.0
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	NA	26.0	19.3	23.7
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	9,547	18.2	32.7	23.6
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	119	14.2	22.2	23.5
Systematix Shares And Stock (I)	Dynamic Investment	NA	33.7	25.7	21.8
Turtle Wealth Management	Profit Mantra	NA	28.3	18.5	21.3
MID-CAP					
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	26.1	15.0	18.0
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	47.5	24.0	15.9
Nippon Life India	Emerging India	NA	15.4	15.8	15.3
Renaissance Invest. Managers	Midcap Portfolio	NA	0.9	8.3	15.1
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	2,380	34.7	27.4	32.5
Counter Cyclical Invest.	Diversified Long Term Value	1,087	14.7	18.6	29.2
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,633	1.1	18.2	22.7
Green Portfolio	Super 30 Dynamic Fund	267	25.1	18.6	22.3

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on August 31, 2026



PHARMACEUTICALS. Aurobindo Pharma (₹1,675)

With key projects moving into commercial production, the drugmaker has stronger near-term growth visibility and also a long runway

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Aurobindo Pharma has developed multiple growth opportunities which should play out both in the long term and short term. As the company has commercialised most ventures, its risk reward is getting more favourable and may offer value for investors, with adequate margin of safety on dips from current price levels. The long-tailed development of different growth segments should ensure a long growth runway for the company.

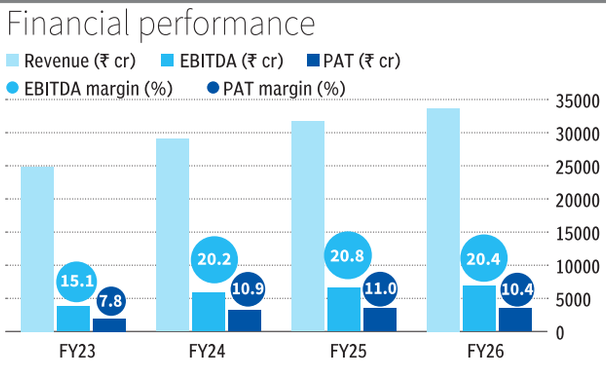
CURRENT DRIVERS

The current revenue drivers include the US — supported by the Lannett acquisition, Europe — supported by the Chinese facility, and India — supported by the Pen-G facility.

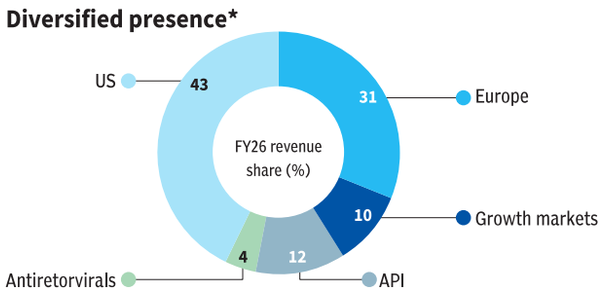
The US is the largest segment for Aurobindo, which generated $1.6 billion in revenues in FY26. Owing to gRevlimid loss during the year, the segment reported a 7 per cent year-on-year decline in FY26 revenue growth. However, the company aspires to generate $2 billion in revenues in the near term.

A bulk of the growth can be from the Lannett acquisition, completed in June. The acquisition provides a large US-based capacity (Seymour, Indiana), which can scale up to four billion tablets a year but currently stands at 40 per cent capacity utilisation. Scaling up operations is the first value-addition the acquisition provides. The management and selling costs' rationalisation and procurement savings are the other avenues to generate synergies from the acquisition.

Financial performance



Diversified presence*



*Company splits its revenue reporting into a matrix of geographies (e.g., US, Europe, Growth Markets) and specific business

On the product front, the company has launched generic Advair, a respiratory asset of significant value. The pipeline includes generics Spiriva and Flovent as well, which are under development. Over the next few years, respiratory assets and controlled substances offer a portfolio of consistent revenue generators for Aurobindo.

The European segment reported 17 per cent CAGR revenue growth in FY23-26, driven by product and geographic expansion. A critical factor has been the supply security from Aurobindo's Chinese plant. The facility, which is a recent development, is starting supplies to the US as well this year. It has a two-billion tablet capacity and is likely to be fully utilised this year compared to 500 million tablets last year.

In India, Aurobindo's Penicillin-G (Pen-G) facility is now eyeing full capacity — 15,000 tonnes per annum (tpa) this year, having achieved 10,000-tpa production with good yields in FY26. The higher capacity utilisation along with downstream products 6-aminopenicillanic acid (6-APA) and amoxicillin (anti-biotics) drive revenue growth along with margin support from backward integration.

LONGER-TERM DRIVERS

Aurobindo is developing its longer-term opportunities mostly focused on biologics and biosimilars. Aurobindo's contract manufacturing operations (CMO) for innovator biologics should generate revenues of $150-200 million per year from FY31-32 from two units. Aurobindo has signed Merck (MSD) as anchor client for its CMO operations — a bioreactor facility with world-leading capacity of 1,20,000 litres by 2030. These facilities will produce biologics for two of Merck's innovator products. Aurobindo is also developing a unit-3 for the same client for another product. Aurobindo will utilise the CMO operations to develop a CDMO as well. While a CMO manufactures a pre-formulated drug, a CDMO partners with the innovator right from early-stage drug development through to commercial rollout

Aurobindo has invested close to $450 million for capacity and operational expenses since 2018 to develop a biosimilar portfolio. The company now has four approvals in hand in Europe/Canada and four more are expected by FY28. It will also be filing two-three biosimilars in the US this year, which should be ready for commercialisation in a year. This portfolio will initially be marketed by Aurobindo's own front-end in Europe and also with two other partners in their respective regions. The portfolio is also expected to be commercialised in Latin America, with the company targeting Mexico and Brazil in the first phase.

This is the first phase of launches for Aurobindo, but the products will not be in the first wave of biosimilar launches (biosimilars after biologics lose patent protection), as there will be existing competition for most of the products. Aurobindo is also developing another suite of biosimilars, which may be in the first wave of launches from 2032 and also differentiated (subcutaneous or device combination), which should ensure a higher market share.

KEY POINTS

- Lannett, Europe and Pen-G should drive near-term revenue growth and margin gains
- Biologics CMO and biosimilars offer a longer-term growth runway
- Valuations have rerated

FINANCIALS, VALUATION

Aurobindo reported 11 per cent/22 per cent revenue/EPS CAGR in FY23-26 and reported revenue and EPS of ₹33,653 crore and ₹60.3 in FY26. Margin expansion was supported by product mix and margin measures, with EBITDA expanding from 15 per cent in FY23 to 20.4 per cent in FY26.

Aurobindo should sustain a similar top-line growth with the current set of revenue drivers and sustain a similar momentum over long term with biologics/biosimilars. Margin expansion should also sustain, supported by Lannett synergies and other measures.

The company also reported a strong balance sheet with net cash of $42 million (₹400 crore) after paying for the $247-million Lannett acquisition.

Valuations have rerated owing to the improved margin profile and product mix to 19 times one-year forward earnings compared 15 times a year back.



FMCG. Orkla India (₹536.55)

The spice of the matter

While return of double-digit revenue growth is partially offset by a few challenges, the valuation is getting better

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Shares of multi-category food maker Orkla India, owner of the MTR and Eastern brands, have fallen 25 per cent since its November 6, 2025, listing—largely in step with the 22 per cent drop in the Nifty FMCG (TRI) index and peer Tata Consumer Products' (TCP) 20 per cent slide in the same period.

Following this broader FMCG de-rating, Orkla trades at 25x trailing earnings (₹537 levels), down from its IPO valuation of about 39x FY25 earnings and at a sharp discount to TCP's current 58x P/E. Even at the time of the IPO, Orkla India's valuation discount was over 50 per cent to TCP.

While Q1FY27 double-digit revenue growth and digital traction improve the outlook, muted 1.7 per cent volume growth, severe spice inflation and an ongoing distribution overhaul in Kerala suggest earnings recovery still needs confirmation. For long-term investors, however, the risk-reward is tilting favourably. Further share price weakness would improve the valuation cushion and provide an opportunity for investors entering at those levels.

WHAT WORKS

The MTR brand was established in 1924. In 2007, as part of an internal reorganisation undertaken before the acquisition by Orkla ASA, MTR Foods (now Orkla India) formally acquired the exclusive rights to the MTR brand for use in processed and packaged foods and beverages. These rights are held in perpetuity by Orkla India for packaged-food operations.

The Eastern brand, founded in 1983 in Kerala, built leadership in spices and regional convenience foods. Orkla India acquired Eastern Condiments in March 2021, blending MTR's Karnataka dominance with Eastern's Kerala and export strength.

MTR and Eastern give Orkla a strong regional base. Rather than rely on one national taste profile, the company builds products around regional cuisines. Its FY26 revenue mix reflects that focus. South India contributed 70 per cent of revenue, while international markets accounted for 21 per cent and Rest of India 9 per cent. MTR and Eastern also serve different culinary preferences, giving the company room to broaden its portfolio without relying solely on one brand.

The categories are developing at different speeds. Spices remain the larger business, at 65 per cent of FY26 revenue, while ready-to-eat and ready-to-cook convenience foods (including breakfast, meals, sweets) contributed 35 per cent. In FY26, convenience-food revenue rose 11.3 per cent, faster than spices, which grew 2.9 per cent. In Q1FY27, both categories grew at over 11 per cent. Meals led the convenience-food performance, with the management citing double-digit growth in that portfolio.

The channel mix offers another avenue for expansion. Recent quarterly numbers illustrate this shift. In domestic market, digital commerce grew 38.1 per cent in Q1 FY27 and contributed 8.9 per cent of domestic revenue, up from 7.2 per cent a year earlier. This indicates a good growth runway.

Modern trade (organised retail chains and supermarkets) grew 18.6 per cent. The management says the digital channel has a favourable product mix, led by convenience foods and blended spices. Orkla is also extending breakfast products, including dry batter into more metros, wet batter into Hyderabad and a protein-led range for younger consumers.

International sales add diversification. The business grew at a resilient 10.1 per cent in Q1FY27, with Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) revenue up 18.1 per cent. The company says it maintained availability despite West Asia-related freight and supply-chain disruption. A reformulated non-dairy MTR Minute Meals range is being prepared for the UK and European markets, though this is groundwork for a potential new business stream, not yet evidence of sales.

The balance sheet gives Orkla room to fund these efforts. It reported a nearly ₹600-crore cash surplus as of March 2026. It is a virtually debt-free company.

WHAT TO MONITOR

The key question is whether sales growth can become more volume-led. Product sales rose 11.5 per cent in Q1FY27, but consolidated tonnage grew only 1.7 per cent against 8.5 per cent in Q1FY26. The management put price-led growth at 11.4 per cent, up from 6.5 per cent in Q4FY26.

Excluding Kerala, however, consolidated volume growth was 4.4 per cent; domestic growth excluding Kerala was 6.3 per cent. That points to a meaningful Kerala drag, but also shows that inflation and price changes are doing much of the work in the headline sales figure.

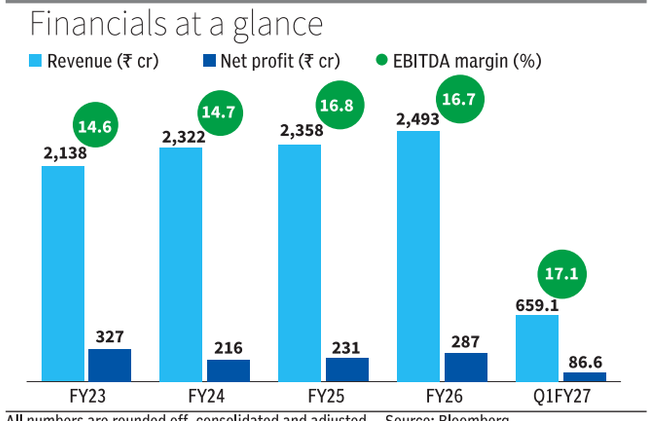
Input costs are a substantial monitorable. The management said spice prices were up over 32 per cent year on year in Q1FY27, with chilli up 78 per cent and coriander 40 per cent. Orkla passes through increases differently across pure and blended spices: it broadly mirrors wholesale prices for pure spices, while calibrating increases on blended products against costs and competition. Whether those actions protect margins without slowing demand will become clearer in subsequent quarters.

Kerala is another execution test. The Eastern foods-distribution programme, launched in February 2026, was substantially completed in June; sales productivity improved 14 per cent and effective outlet coverage increased 6 per cent in Q1FY27 versus Q4FY26. The modern-trade and spice-coverage workstreams remained in planning or pilot stages, and the management said the full programme would take several quarters to mature. The early figures are encouraging, but the remaining work has yet to prove it can lift distribution and sales.

Investors should track any increase in advertising and sales-promotion spending. The management is open to higher outlays to support volume growth; annual advertising and sales promotion as a share of total expenses for the firm is around 6-7 per cent. The key is whether added promotion lifts volumes enough to offset its impact on margins.

Finally, Production Linked Incentive (PLI) is uncertain. FY27 is the scheme's final year, and the management said it was too early to confirm whether Orkla would qualify. In FY25, it got ₹20.5 crore. In FY26, it fell short of a threshold and did not realise anything.

Financials at a glance



All numbers are rounded off, consolidated and adjusted Source: Bloomberg

KEY POINTS

- Good valuation cushion
- Execution remains strong
- Growth levers intact

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — **Editor**

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	Sept 25	Oct 1		
Kotak Mahindra Bank	403.4	419.8	▲	4.1
Infosys	1,001.0	1,035.0	▲	3.4
TCS	2,084.0	2,079.3	▼	-0.2
Axis Bank	1,220.0	1,214.0	▼	-0.5
Tech Mahindra	1,547.0	1,539.0	▼	-0.5
HCL Tech	1,259.4	1,246.0	▼	-1.1
ICICI Bank	1,326.5	1,305.5	▼	-1.6
Asian Paints	2,445.0	2,406.3	▼	-1.6
Bajaj Finserv	1,769.0	1,729.9	▼	-2.2
HDFC Bank	735.8	719.4	▼	-2.2
Sun Pharma	1,853.5	1,810.0	▼	-2.3
Bharat Electronics	393.0	383.5	▼	-2.4
Bharti Airtel	1,786.9	1,741.0	▼	-2.6
Trent	2,666.0	2,597.4	▼	-2.6
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,784.0	1,738.0	▼	-2.6
UltraTech Cement	11,100.0	10,799.0	▼	-2.7
SBI	982.5	954.0	▼	-2.9
NTPC	326.2	316.7	▼	-2.9
Tata Motors PV	290.3	280.0	▼	-3.5
ITC	269.0	257.0	▼	-4.5
Tata Steel	187.7	179.1	▼	-4.6
Bajaj Finance	995.0	949.4	▼	-4.6
Reliance Industries	1,226.0	1,166.0	▼	-4.9
L&T	3,879.0	3,685.5	▼	-5.0
HUL	1,940.0	1,841.0	▼	-5.1
Power Grid	269.3	254.7	▼	-5.4
Maruti Suzuki	12,071.0	11,400.0	▼	-5.6
M & M	3,031.4	2,851.1	▼	-5.9
Eternal	334.8	313.5	▼	-6.4
Titan	4,879.0	4,535.0	▼	-7.1

How sectoral indices moved

	Sep 25	Oct 1	Movement	% change
IT	27,143.7	27,198.8	▲	0.2
TECK	14,350.4	14,283.2	▼	-0.5
BANKEX	62,833.1	61,356.1	▼	-2.4
CAPITAL GOODS	75,958.8	74,133.3	▼	-2.4
POWER	7,337.0	7,145.0	▼	-2.6
REALTY	6,776.7	6,554.3	▼	-3.3
HEALTHCARE	51,596.1	49,899.9	▼	-3.3
OIL&GAS	25,510.6	24,621.7	▼	-3.5
PSU	20,027.7	19,298.0	▼	-3.6
METALS	41,357.8	39,634.3	▼	-4.2
FMCG	17,375.4	16,651.3	▼	-4.2
CONSUMER DURABLES	61,053.0	57,809.5	▼	-5.3
AUTO	59,648.4	56,364.1	▼	-5.5

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

1. I have undergone several mergers and changes in control over my history of less than five decades.
2. My chairman is a member of several illustrious boards and is well respected for successful joint ventures, as well as a few hostile ones.
3. One of my founding promoters made a complete exit through an IPO recently.
4. My valuation quadrupled within three years of listing, but lost half its value over the subsequent year.
5. I am a small-cap stock despite belonging to a multi-billion-dollar group and being an industry leader in a sub-segment of a large industry.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to **who-am-i@thehindu.co.in**, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

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Investing With Conviction

Last week's stock: Godrej Agrovet
Last week's winner: Priyanka Joshi

CHENNAI
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - OCTOBER 4 - 2026

Bears stay firm

F&O TRACKER. Futures and options positioning points to further decline



GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Bears continue to dominate and the market keeps extending the decline. Benchmark index Nifty 50 (22,422) lost 3.1 per cent last week, thereby posting eighth consecutive loss. Whereas Nifty Bank (54,451) was down for the sixth week as it slipped 2 per cent.

Both chart and F&O (futures and options) show downward inclination and so, the likelihood of further decline is high.

NIFTY 50

Nifty (Oct) futures (22,530) was down 3.2 per cent last week. The outstanding OI (Open Interest) of this contract increased from 104.2 lakh contracts to 191.6 lakh contracts during this period. This implies fresh short build-up.

The PCR (Put Call Ratio) of October options stood at 0.69 by the end of last week. A ratio less than 1 is because of selling (writing) of relatively more call option contracts compared to puts. This is a bearish sign as traders write calls when they are bearish.

So, the derivatives data shows a clear dominance by the bears. The chart also substantiates this as the price action indicates strong downward momentum.

The October futures breached the support at 23,000 and 22,600 last week. It marked a low of 22,321 on Thursday (Friday was market holiday) before ending the week at 22,530.

As it stands, there are no signs of a bullish reversal in trend. So, Nifty (Oct) futures might decline to the nearest support at 22,250. If this level is broken, the downtick might extend to 22,000-21,800 support band.

However, if there is a rally from the current level, the contract will face resistance at 22,600. A breakout of this can lift it to 23,000-23,125, a resistance band.

Nevertheless, as mentioned above, the derivatives data and the chart shows that the bears are in the driving seat and the probability of further decline from the current level is high.

NIFTY BANK

Nifty Bank (Oct) futures (54,795) lost 2.1 per cent last week. But as the contract dropped, the outstanding OI went up from 14.2 lakh contracts to 23.5 lakh contracts. A drop in price along with an increase in OI shows fresh addition of short positions by participants.

The PCR of October options stood at 0.86 on Thursday whereas that of November contracts stood at 0.40. Thus, the option positioning by traders aligns with the bearish bias shown by the futures.

BEARS REIGN

- Fresh shorts pile up
- PCRs signal weakness
- Rallies face resistance

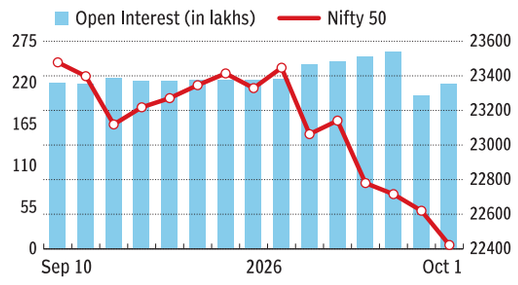
The chart shows that the negative bias is intact in Nifty Bank futures. But when compared to Nifty futures, the strength of the bears is less in Nifty Bank futures – while the former fell through the week, the latter largely remained flat in the second half despite witnessing considerable volatility.

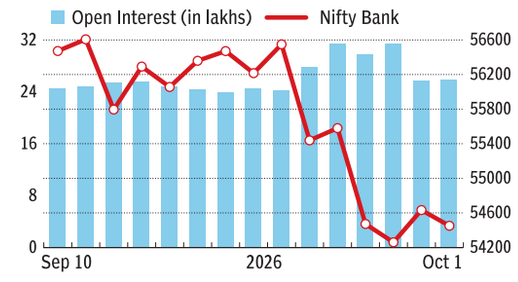
Yet, the chances are high for further fall from the current level with the nearest notable support at 54,600. In case this support is invalidated, Nifty Bank futures can see a deeper fall to 54,000.

Instead, if Nifty Bank (Oct) futures rallies from the current level of 54,795, the barrier at 56,000 is likely to block the bulls from gaining further ground. In case this is breached, the contract can rise to 56,750.

Overall, given the prevailing conditions, the October futures is likely to decline either from the current level of 54,795 or after a minor rise to 56,000. The fall might be arrested within the broader range of 54,000-54,600.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)

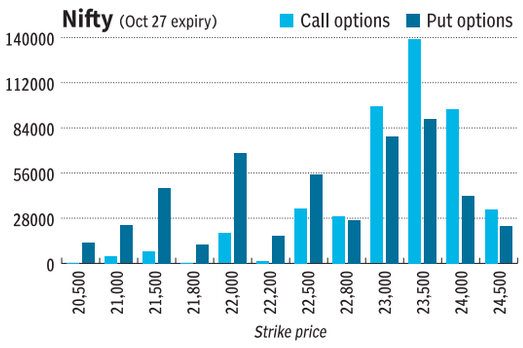




Open Interest chain

(as on Oct 1)

Put-Call ratio Nifty **0.96** | Nifty Bank **0.86**



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Oct 1	Weekly change %	As on Oct 1	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	29,605	-36	306,566	-1
Future Index Short	339,779	-5	56,754	-14
Net Futures	-310,174	-1	249,812	2
Index Call options Long	670,483	-22	3,743,798	-4
Index Call options Short	1,101,948	0	3,448,314	-8
Net Call options	-431,465	79	295,484	70
Index Put options Long	1,114,773	-20	2,363,022	-19
Index Put options Short	448,195	-38	3,206,170	-17
Net Put Options	666,578	-3	-843,148	-11

FIIs retain strong net short positions on index futures. They've significantly increased net short on call options. Overall, the bias is bearish.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Oct 1)				
MAXHEALTH	940.95	-7.2	209.1	26.6
APOLLOHOSP	8,133.50	-8.5	58.8	20.7
BAJAJ-AUTO	10,045.00	-11.0	56.6	14.6
APLAPOLLO	2,115.70	-4.5	197.9	4.4
FORTIS	785.00	-6.3	197.8	3.8
FALL (as on Oct 1)				
NAM-INDIA	1,046.00	-9.6	54.6	-56.6
LODHA	1,105.60	-5.1	97.6	-54.7
POWERINDIA	31,290.00	0.8	7.7	-53.7
SOLARINDS	19,400.00	-1.7	18.9	-52.6
OFSS	10,420.00	-3.2	23.6	-49.3

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Oct 5)

AMBUJACEM	BANDHANBNK	SAIL

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹) (Weekly change %)	OI (Weekly change %)	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on Oct 1)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Oct	336.6 (-3.5)	4,033 (12)	Short build-up
COPPER	30-Oct	1,399.6 (-1.4)	8,319 (-6)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOIL	19-Oct	8,916.0 (0.8)	11,210 (-14)	Short covering
CRUDEOILM	19-Oct	8,913.0 (0.7)	35,750 (-9)	Short covering
GOLD	4-Dec	150,390.0 (-1.9)	15,955 (24)	Short build-up
GOLDGUINEA	30-Oct	1,19,993.0 (-2.0)	13,525 (3)	Short build-up
GOLDM	5-Nov	149,055.0 (-2.1)	42,632 (90)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Oct	15,002.0 (-2.0)	1,98,482 (9)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	30-Oct	1,49,436.0 (-2.1)	29,866 (19)	Short build-up
LEAD	30-Oct	192.2 (-1.4)	520 (-4)	Long unwinding
NATURALGAS	27-Oct	287.5 (-7.4)	54,157 (108)	Short build-up
SILVER	4-Dec	2,25,877.0 (-3.8)	16,584 (12)	Short build-up
SILVERM	30-Nov	2,28,048.0 (-3.6)	39,424 (8)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Nov	2,28,108.0 (-3.6)	1,33,628 (15)	Short build-up
ZINC	30-Oct	410.6 (-2.8)	2,669 (7)	Short build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Oct 1)				
USDINR	28-Oct	96.50 (0.4)	12,37,881 (136)	Long build-up
EURINR	28-Oct	109.18 (-0.6)	6,374 (212)	Short build-up
GBPINR	28-Oct	127.62 (0.0)	2,615 (44)	Long build-up
JPYINR	28-Oct	61.27 (1.9)	536 (8833)	Long build-up

F&O Strategy

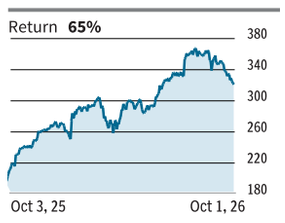
Long strangle on Federal Bank

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of The Federal Bank (₹318.20) currently maintains a negative bias. Support are at ₹303 and ₹290. A close below the latter will trigger a fresh sell-off.

Resistances are at ₹331 and ₹345. A close above ₹345 will change both the long and short-term outlook positive.

Event: RBI policy announcement is on October 7.



F&O pointers: Federal Bank Oct futures closed at ₹320.40 versus the spot close of ₹318.20, maintaining a premium. The counter witnessed steady accumulation of open positions despite a fall in share price. Option trading indicates a range of ₹300-350 .

Strategy: Consider strangle on Federal Bank. This can be initiated by buying 305-put and 330-call. These options closed with a premium of ₹3.90 and ₹5.35, respectively. As the market lot is 2,500 shares, this will cost traders ₹23,125, which would be the maximum loss in this trade.

This loss will happen if the stock is stuck between ₹305 and ₹330. The position will turn profitable either on a close above ₹339.25 or a close below ₹295.75.

Traders can aim for a profit of ₹2,000 or exit the position if the loss mounts to ₹2,000. The stock will be volatile due to RBI monetary policy and may provide profit opportunity.

Follow-up: Hold the long strangle on HDFC AMC for one more week.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Managing intraday futures positions

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Manually closing futures position earlier eases execution risk

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

The closing auction session (CAS) has been a topic of debate since its implementation by the NSE in August 2026. This week, we discuss the impact of NSE's trading architecture relating to CAS on your intraday futures positions.

FLEXING PRICES

Suppose you have a bullish outlook on an underlying and initiate a long futures position for intraday trade. It is best to close your position before 3.15 pm. Why? NSE applies a dynamic price band on futures contracts. A price band of 10 per cent is first applied on the previous day's closing price of futures to arrive at an initial trading range for the day. What happens if futures price hits the upper or the lower price band? Contracts are allowed to change by 5 per cent in the direction of the price if certain liquidity conditions are met. NSE uses a sliding rule to revise the trading range for futures contracts. This rule changes at 3.15 pm when NSE implements the CAS. Between 3.15 pm and market close, NSE switches to a static price band of 3 per cent. Brokers typically square off clients' intraday positions between 3.15 pm and 3.26 pm. It is best to manually close your futures position earlier. This may lower potential gains but could moderate execution risk – the risk is that you may be unable to close your position manually at a reasonable price.



GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

EASING RISKS

it may be optimal to set up your futures position as overnight trade

Sometimes, you may initiate an intraday position but later decide to carry over the position to the next day. Why? You believe the futures price will move further in the direction of your bet, or the contract may not have reached your desired price target. Brokers typically allow you to convert your intraday position until their automatic square-off process is implemented. It is optimal to convert your intraday futures position, if required, before 3.15 pm. Note that the SPAN margin requirements are the same whether you set up the position as intraday or overnight trade. So, it may be optimal to set up your futures position as overnight (positional) trade to reduce the risk that you may be unable to convert your position as desired.

OPTIONAL READING

Applying the 10 per cent rule on the previous day's close of 2000, the upper and lower price band on a futures contract is 2200 and 1800. Suppose the price hits the upper band and NSE applies the 5 per cent rule to flex the price band. The upper price band will move to 2300, an increase of 100 points (5 per cent of previous day's close of 2000 added to the current upper band). The lower price will slide to 1900 (100 points added to the current lower band). Existing orders below 1900 will be automatically cancelled. A complex trading system requires mindful position management. It is best to initiate trades as overnight positions, especially on Nifty futures, to have the flexibility of closing the position intraday or keeping the contract open.

(The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments)

Short Take

A staggered approach

bl. research bureau

In commodities trading, futures contracts can either be physically- or cash-settled. Compulsory delivery contracts have a staggered delivery period. So, if the buyer doesn't want to take delivery, then he/she has to mandatorily close the contract before it enters the staggered delivery period. This applies to all compulsory deliverable contracts (agri/non-agri).



Staggered delivery period means the period beginning a few working days prior to the expiry of the contract and ending on the date of expiry. The minimum duration of staggered delivery period is three working days, as per SEBI guidelines. However, exchanges have the flexibility to set a higher duration, considering the open interest, volumes near expiry and demand.

Thus, the seller/buyer having an open position has an option of submitting an intention of giving/taking delivery, on any day during the staggered delivery period. During this period, the buyer to whom the delivery is allocated will not be allowed to refuse delivery. If the seller fails to deliver, penal provisions apply.

On expiry , all the open positions in compulsory delivery contracts are marked for delivery. In other words, traders who prefer physical delivery of the goods would keep an open position till the expiry, while others should close their contracts before the staggered delivery period. Applicable tender/delivery period margins may also be levied during this period.

Support fails

BULLION CUES: Near-term outlook is bearish

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Price of precious metals saw a decline over the last week. Gold ($4,141/ounce) and silver ($60.40/ounce) were down 3.4 and 6.1 per cent, respectively. In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,50,390/10 gm) fell 1.9 per cent whereas silver futures (₹2,25,877/kg) was down 3.8 per cent.

In the domestic market, the decline is relatively low as the market was closed on Friday whereas in the global market, both gold and silver extended the fall, posting a bigger loss.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,50,390)

Gold (Dec) futures opened with a gap-down last week. It began last Monday's session at ₹1,50,399 versus preceding week's close of ₹1,53,277. While it made a low of ₹1,47,961 the same day, the contract did not see further decline.

After opening lower, the contract has largely remained flat, largely oscillating between ₹1,48,000 and ₹1,51,000. However, gold futures will retain a bearish bias as long as it stays below ₹1,52,000, a support-turned-resistance level.



The contract is likely to fall. Support is at ₹1,44,000. However, in case the bulls gain traction and lift the December futures above ₹1,52,000, it can extend the rally to ₹1,56,000.

Nevertheless, the bias is bearish and so, the probability for a fall is higher.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,25,877)

Silver (Dec) futures began last week on the weak foot and breached the support at ₹2,30,000 early last week. The price action indicates a weak trend and further decline from the current level is highly likely.

The nearest support from the current level of ₹2,25,877 is ₹2,19,000. This is an important base. A breach of this can intensify the sell-off, possibly leading to a swift fall to ₹2,10,000.

On the other hand, if silver futures reclaim ₹2,30,000, it can recover to ₹2,42,000.

Bullish posture

CRUDE CHECK. Key support holds

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



Oil prices, after witnessing some volatility through the last week, ended flat. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) ($102.3/barrel) was down 2 per cent whereas crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,916/barrel) was up 0.8 per cent.

Note that the domestic commodity market was closed on Friday.

BRENT FUTURES ($102.30)

Brent crude futures which remained weak in the first half of last week, found support in the second half and rebounded. The recovery happened on the back of a trendline support.

The chart set-up appears bullish. From the current level, the contract is likely to hit $110 soon. If this level is taken out, the uptick can extend up to $115 in the near term.

On the other hand, if bears gain traction and drag the contract, it can decline to $96 and then subsequently to $94. A breach of $94, where the 50-day moving average coincides, can change the near-term outlook bearish. Notable support below $94 is at $84.

MCX CRUDE OIL (₹8,916)

Crude oil (Oct) futures saw some moderation in price during the first half of last week. Nevertheless, the contract stayed above the support at ₹8,500. This indicates that the broader uptrend is valid.

Supporting this, the price action shows that crude oil futures has been forming higher bases since July.

From the current level, we expect the contract to see a fresh leg of rally. This upswing can lift the October contract above the prior peak of ₹9,769 made in mid-September. The price can touch ₹10,000 or even ₹10,500.

However, if the support at ₹8,500 is taken out, the contract might drop to ₹8,200. A breach of ₹8,200 can turn the near-term outlook weak.

At a critical juncture

INDEX OUTLOOK. A bounce from the upcoming support is needed to avoid more fall



GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index were knocked down badly last week. Nifty was down 3.11 per cent for the week. Sensex and Nifty Bank index on the other hand fell 2.69 per cent and 2.03 per cent. Indeed, Sensex and Nifty are down for the eighth consecutive weeks. Nifty Bank index is down for six consecutive weeks.

The Indian benchmark indices have come close to their crucial support. We expect them to sustain above this support and bounce back in the coming weeks. Failure to do so can trigger a much steeper fall, going forward. So, the price action this week is going to be very important.

FPIS SELL

The Foreign Portfolio investors sold heavily last week. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about $2.91 billion in the past week. Continued selling by the FPIs is keeping the benchmark indices under pressure.

NIFTY 50 (22,421.95)

Short-term view: The trend is down. But crucial supports are coming up at 22,000 and 21,800. A fall to test these supports cannot be ruled out. However, there are good chances for the Nifty to reverse higher from this 22,000-21,800 support zone. Such a bounce can take it back up to 22,500-22,700. A further rise above 22,700 and a subsequent rise past 23,000 can turn the outlook bullish to revisit 24,000 and higher levels.

If Nifty breaks below 21,800, it will come under more selling pressure. If that happens, 21,400-21,300 can be seen on the downside.

Medium-term view: Nifty has come down to the lower end of its 22,000-26,500 range. A bounce from the 22,000-21,800 support zone and the rise to 24,000 mentioned above will keep this sideways range intact.

As long as the Nifty stays above this 22,000-21,800 support zone, there is no change in our long-term bullish view. We retain our view of the Nifty breaking above 26,500 and rise to 28,000 and 30,000.

A sustained break below 21,800 will negate this bullish view. If that happens, the fall can extend to 20,500 or even lower.

Nifty 50: Crucial support



KEY SUPPORT

- Nifty 50: 22,000, 21,800
- Sensex: 71,000, 70,700
- Nifty Bank: 53,800

NIFTY BANK (54,450.75)

Short-term view: An important support is at 53,800. If Nifty Bank index manages to sustain above it, a relief rise to 56,500 is possible. But a break below 53,800 will increase the selling pressure. Such a break can drag the Nifty Bank index down to 51,000 in the coming weeks.

The price action around 53,800 will need a close watch this week.

Medium-term view: The region around 51,000 is a strong support which can halt the current fall. A bounce from around 51,000 will keep our broader bullish view intact. So, for now, there is no change in our long-term bullish view of seeing 65,000 and 68,000-69,000 on the upside.

A fall below 51,000 will prove our bullish view wrong. If that happens, Nifty Bank index can go down to 49,000-48,000.

SENSEX (71,909.70)

Short-term view: Immediate support is in the 71,200-71,000 region. A bounce after testing this support zone can give some relief. Such a bounce can take the Sensex higher to 73,500 or even 75,000 again in the short term.

But a break below 71,000 will keep the downtrend intact. In that case, an extended fall to 70,700 or even 69,800 is possible.

The price action in the 71,200-71,000 region will need a close watch this week.

Medium-term view: The bounce from around 71,000 and the rise to 75,000 mentioned above will keep the broader 71,000-86,000 range intact. In that case, the chances of rising above 86,000 will remain alive. It will also keep intact our long-term bullish view of seeing 90,000 and 94,000 on the upside.

This bullish view will come under threat only if the Sensex breaks below 69,800. If that happens, a steeper fall to 67,000 and even lower levels will come into the picture.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (21,643.85)

The key support level of 22,000 was broken last week. That keeps the short-term picture weak. Resistance is now in the 21,900-22,100 region. Support is in the 21,400-21,350 region which is holding well for now. A break below 21,350 can drag the Nifty Midcap 150 index down to 20,800 or even 20,500.

We expect the index to rise back from this 20,800-20,500 region and go up to 22,000. In case, a break below 20,500 is seen, then the fall can extend to 19,000.

There is no change in our long-term bullish view. We retain our view of seeing 26,000-26,500 and 28,000 over the long term. The region between 19,000 and 18,500 is a crucial support zone. The long-term bullish view will go wrong only if the index declines below 18,500. If that happens, then 17,000 and lower levels can be seen. But such a fall looks less likely.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (17,589.05)

The break below 18,000 and the fall to 18,400 happened last week as expected. Important support is in the 17,300-17,200 region. We expect this support to hold and the index to rise back to 18,000-18,300 again.

Such a rise will keep our broader bullish view intact. An eventual break above 18,300 will then clear the way for the rally to 22,500-23,000 and 24,000-24,500 over the long term.

If the index declines below 17,200, a fall to 16,600 can be seen initially. It will also keep the downside open to see 15,500 as well.

The 15,500-15,000 region is a strong support zone. The index has to decline below 15,000 to negate our long-term bullish view. In that case, 14,000 and even 13,000 can be seen on the downside.

bl.portfolio video

Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English *Tamil*

MARKET WRAP.

Global shares gain on bond recovery, oil fall

Reuters

Global shares rose on Friday as wild volatility in bond and currency markets eased and oil prices fell, while weaker-than-forecast US jobs data scuppered chances of a rate hike from the Federal Reserve later this month.

Nonfarm payrolls increased by 29,000 jobs last month after a downwardly revised 133,000 rise in August, the Labor Department's closely watched employment report showed on Friday. Economists polled by *Reuters* had forecast payrolls advancing 90,000.

Bets on a second rate rise from the Federal Reserve this month faded after the data. Markets now assign a 15% chance of a hike in October from around 25% before the data.

Schroders senior economist George Brown said Friday's figures may ease some concerns that previous interest rate cuts from the Fed could stoke inflation problems, but that it doesn't alter the inflation backdrop.

Wall Street futures extended gains after the data. Nasdaq futures were up 1.2% and S&P 500 futures gained0.8%. The benchmark 10-year Treasury yield fell 6 basis points to 5.1717%, down from the 24-year high of 5.3445% reached the day before. The two-year yield, which is sensitive to changes in expectations for interest rate policy, fell 6.5 bps to4.7204%.

In Europe, longer-dated sovereign bond prices rose on the day, although those in more indebted countries, like France and Italy, lagged the gains in Germany, reflecting growing investor demand for protection against rising fiscal risks.



The German 10-year yield, the euro zonebenchmark, was down 12 basis points on Friday, as investors preferred the relative safety of German bonds compared to their euro zone counterparts. Bond yields move inversely with prices.

In France, the 10-year yield was down slightlyat 4.927%, pushing the gap between the German and French 10-yearyields to over 154 bps, the widest level since the euro zonedebt crisis in 2011.

"I wouldn't call it a crisis yet, but it looks like it has the potential to be one," said George Lagarias, chief economistat Forvis Mazars.

Global bond markets have been under a sustained selloff in recent weeks as the US-Israeli war with Iran pushed up energy prices again. But oil prices fell on Friday, providing some relief for stocks and bonds. US West Texas Intermediate crude futures fell 3.7% to$89.43 a barrel. Brent crude futures were down 2.7% to $99.45 a barrel, while European gasoil futures, a benchmark fordiesel prices, fell about 5% to $1,378 a metric tonne.

In Asia, MSCI's broadest index of Asia-Pacific sharesoutside Japan fell 0.1% and settled for a weeklydecline of 1.3%. Japan's Nikkei dropped 0.9% but gained almost 3% for the week.

The US dollar index, which gauges the currency against six peers, fell 0.1% to 101.86 after the US data, having rallied 0.6% the day before to hit the highest level since April 2025. It was still set for a third straight week of gains, upabout 0.8%.

The rout in European bonds helped pin the euro lower and benefited the safe-haven yen and Swiss franc.The euro was at $1.1248, having weakened 0.8% on Thursday to hit the lowest level since May 2025.

The Swiss franc was upsharply against both the dollar and euro.

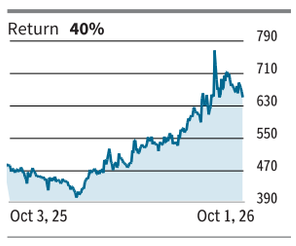
The yen firmed 0.6% to 157.11 per dollar afterdata showed underlying inflation in Japan's capital acceleratedto an annual rate of 2.7% in September, bolstering the case for further interest rate hikes.

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Balrampur Chini Mills (₹648.65)

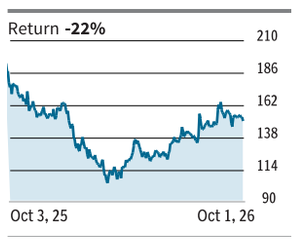
Broader uptrend intact



The stock of Balrampur Chini Mills hit an all-time high of ₹781 on August 20. But then, the price started to drop and it closed at ₹648.65 last week. The chart now shows that the stock has formed a good base at ₹640. Below this is an important rising trendline support at around ₹610. Until these levels hold, the outlook will be bullish. We expect the stock to resume the uptrend either from the current level of ₹648 or after extending the ongoing corrective decline to ₹610. Once the rally resumes, the scrip can surpass the prior peak of ₹781 and touch ₹820. However, a breach of the support at ₹610 can turn the outlook weak, possibly leading to a decline to ₹560.

Paradeep Phosphates (₹151.15)

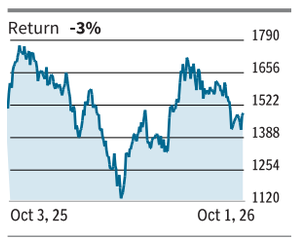
Key support ahead



The stock of Paradeep Phosphates has been in an uptrend since March. It established a rally after finding support at ₹100. In August it broke out of a key resistance at ₹150, a strong indication that the medium-term trend has turned positive. But after hitting a nine-month high of ₹168 on August 28, there has been a moderation in price. However, the stock remains above the crucial resistance-turned-support of ₹150. Also a trendline support lies at ₹145. So, the probability of the uptrend resuming soon is high. On the upside, the stock has the potential to rise to ₹190 over the next few months. In case the support at ₹145 is invalidated, the price might fall to ₹132.

Prestige Estates Projects (₹1,494.10)

Faces a resistance



The stock of Prestige Estates Projects has been on a downtrend since July. A couple of weeks ago, it breached the support at ₹1,500, turning the outlook bearish. But since then, there has not been much of a decline, where the stock has largely been flat recently. However, the stock is now hovering near the support-turned-resistance level of ₹1,500, where the 21-day moving average coincides. The likelihood of the price falling from the current level is high. In the near-term, the stock can drop to ₹1,310. A breach of this can trigger a decline to ₹1,200. That said, in case there is a recovery from the current level, a breakout of ₹1,560 can lift scrip to ₹1,740.

Dollar, Yield stay strong

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

US MARKET OUTLOOK. The outlook remains bullish and there is more room to rise



GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

The Dow Jones Industrial Average fell for the fifth consecutive week. The index was down 1.26 per cent. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index on the other hand managed to stay afloat. The S&P 500 was marginally down by 0.26 per cent while the NASDAQ Composite index closed higher by 0.45 per cent for the week.

On the currency front, the dollar index has risen well for the third consecutive week. The index has gone up by 2.86 per cent in the past three weeks. The US 10Yr Treasury Yield on the other hand stayed higher but was stable all through the week.

Here is an analysis of where the US markets are headed from here.

DOW JONES (51,182.11)

The break below 51,000 happened last week in line with our expectation. The Dow Joens touched a low of 50,552 and then has risen back from there. A follow-through rise from here can take the Dow Jones index up to 51,800-52,000 and not beyond that. The index can reverse lower thereafter, and fall back to 50,400-50,300.

The trend remains down. The Dow Jones can fall to 49,700-49,500 in the coming weeks. After this fall, a fresh leg of upmove can begin.

S&P 500 (7,722.72)

Contrary to our expectation to breach 7,780 and rise, the S&P 500 fell last week. However, the support at 7,600 limited the downside very well and the index has risen back from the low of 7,616.78. That keeps intact the overall bullish view.

Supports are at 7,700 and 7,670. Below that, 7,600 will continue to act as a strong support. Resistance is in the 7,790-7,800 region which can be tested if the index manages to sustain above 7,700.

A decisive break above 7,800 can boost the momentum. Such a break can take the S&P 500 index up to 8,100-8,200 in the coming weeks.

BULLISH OUTLOOK

The dollar index has potential to see 103.30 on the upside.

The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index breaks below 7,600.

If that happens, then 7,500-7,400 can be seen on the downside. But such a fall looks less likely.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (27,190.86)

Barring the gap-up open and the rise on Friday, the NASDAQ Composite index remained broadly stable last week. Resistance is around 27,450. A break above it can take the NASDAQ Composite index higher to 28,300-28,500. Failure to breach 27,450 can drag the index down to 26,900.

From a big picture, the 28,300-28,500 is a strong resistance zone where the current upmove can halt.

A reversal from this resistance zone can drag the index down to 27,000 and even lower thereafter. So, we reiterate that as the index approaches 28,300-28,500, more caution is needed.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

As expected, the dollar index (101.92) broke the resistance at 101.50 last week. It made a high of 102.21 and has come down from there. The outlook is bullish. Cluster of supports are there in the 101.40-101 region. A dip to 101.40 is a possibility initially this week. But thereafter the dollar index can rise back again. The upside now remains open to see 103.30.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (5.28 per cent) continues to move up. It touched a high of 5.34 per cent last week. The support at 5.15 per cent is holding very well in line with our expectation. The trend is up and strong. Immediate support is in the 5.2-5.15 per cent region. The US 10Yr can rise to 5.6 per cent in the coming weeks. From a big picture, there is potential for the US 10Yr Treasury Yield to touch 6 per cent. In case the yield declines below 5.15 per cent, a corrective fall to 5 per cent can happen first. Thereafter the broader uptrend can resume.

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

BANDU'S PICKS

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

1. **Engineers India**
2. **Cyient**
3. **City Union Bank**
4. **Lenskart Solutions**
5. **Dr Lal PathLabs**

Last week's prize winner
H A Munaff

Last week's winning stock
DLF

Closing price (Sept 25)
₹ 680.50

Closing pric (Oct 1)
₹662.60

Return:
-2.63 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to **bandublockbuster@gmail.com** with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Scan to know the winner selection process

CHENNAI
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - OCTOBER 4 - 2026

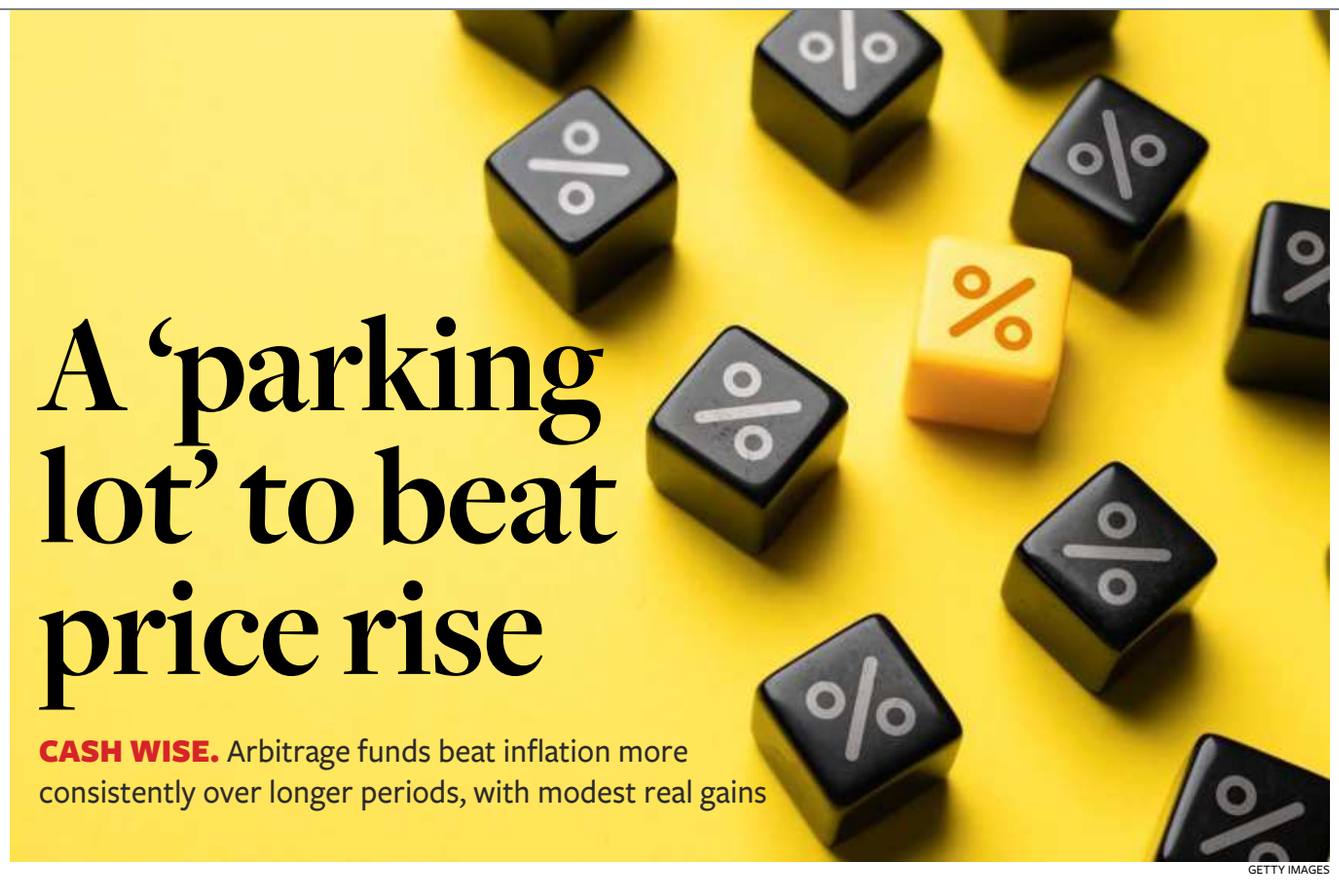
Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 2.7 and 3.1 per cent respectively last week. BSE IT was the sole gainer at 0.2 per cent. BSE Auto and BSE Consumer Durables declined the most by 5.5 and 5.3 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Teck
P/E	19.2	19.1	33.1	13.1	49.6	57.2	31.0	43.7	18.5	16.7	10.9	30.5	10.7	38.3	19.0
P/BV	2.8	3.9	6.8	2.2	14.5	15.9	6.9	7.8	5.7	3.2	1.5	4.7	2.1	5.3	7.7
Dividend Yield	1.2	1.2	1.1	0.7	0.5	0.6	1.0	0.5	2.1	0.5	2.4	1.2	2.1	0.5	1.8
Weekly Return (%)	-3.1 ▼	-2.7 ▼	-5.5 ▼	-2.4 ▼	-2.4 ▼	-5.3 ▼	-4.2 ▼	-3.3 ▼	0.2 ▲	-4.2 ▼	-3.5 ▼	-2.6 ▼	-3.6 ▼	-3.3 ▼	-0.5 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	-6.8 ▼	-6.5 ▼	-10.3 ▼	-5.5 ▼	-5.6 ▼	-9.6 ▼	-5.5 ▼	-2.7 ▼	-9.6 ▼	-5.0 ▼	-5.9 ▼	-3.6 ▼	-5.7 ▼	-5.8 ▼	-8.5 ▼
Annual Return (%)	-9.7 ▼	-11.2 ▼	-5.6 ▼	-1.7 ▼	7.8 ▲	-0.3 ▼	-17.8 ▼	14.5 ▲	-18.7 ▼	18.6 ▲	-8.6 ▼	5.6 ▲	-2.5 ▼	-3.8 ▼	-13.8 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr.High	Yr.Low
360 ONE [1]	1045.0	30.9	33.8	4.6	202606	34.5	16.1	36.8	19.5	-2.3	12.1	1.6	1235.7	906.2
3M India	30744.8	391.4	78.6	19.6	202606	19.0	-0.4	15.7	-11.2	-9.4	47.3	0.1	38300.0	28747.3
A														
A B B [2]	6854.4	72.7	94.2	15.6	202606	21.0	8.0	10.0	-13.0	-2.9	9.8	0.1	7923.4	4640.5
A B Lifestyle	74.4	1.7	42.6	6.4	202606	11.1	20.6	9.1	31.5	-5.5	12.5	2.2	150.8	73.5
A B Real Estate	1101.6	-29.2		3.3	202606	30.4	-255.2	-55.2	-267.7	-10.5	-4.1	1.4	1914.0	1074.0
Aadhar Hsg. Fin.	448.7	26.3	17.1	2.6	202606	17.1	19.0	17.7	21.5	1.0	11.3	2.5	563.0	425.1
Aarti Industries [5]	464.8	14.4	32.3	2.8	202606	42.5	256.5	27.0	122.2	-5.0	6.9	0.8	551.5	338.2
AAVAS Financiers	1192.5	61.9	19.3	2.5	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	-6.1	9.9	3.2	1775.0	1050.3
Abbott India	26832.1	759.9	35.3	11.9	202606	4.3	17.1	6.3	11.2	-0.4	43.8	0.0	30598.0	25140.5
ACC	1183.2	101.2	11.7	1.1	202606	-4.6	-56.3	11.5	-18.6	-4.3	11.2	0.0	1986.9	1167.5
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	432.5	8.4	51.3	3.9	202606	67.8	64.8	47.5	45.4	-2.2	8.1	3.2	476.4	195.7
Action Const.Eq. [2]	1212.0	36.7	33.0	7.2	202606	20.5	22.3	5.2	3.3	-1.3	31.6	0.0	1267.1	746.1
Acutaas Chemical [5]	3195.3	47.2	67.7	15.8	202606	59.1	67.7	40.9	104.3	-2.3	32.2	0.0	3735.0	1290.1
Adani Energy Sol	1325.5	23.9	55.5	5.6	202606	42.4	124.2	20.9	21.8	-1.0	9.5	1.9	1789.0	804.7
Adani Enterp. [1]	2824.3	19.0	148.5	4.0	202606	49.9	14.9	18.1	-28.8	-3.1	5.6	1.5	3245.0	1753.5
Adani Green	1288.0	11.9	107.8	11.0	202606	15.6	16.6	7.2	1.0	-0.4	8.0	5.7	1631.4	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1738.0	57.7	30.1	4.2	202606	18.6	9.2	23.8	16.8	-2.6	13.8	0.7	1891.8	1293.1
Adani Power [2]	197.0	7.4	26.6	6.1	202606	34.0	42.0	6.6	14.9	-3.0	16.6	0.8	254.2	128.4
Adani Total Gas [1]	583.2	5.7	101.4	13.2	202606	27.2	-14.2	19.8	-2.4	-4.5	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	992.4	34.9	28.4	7.1	202606	3.5	11.7	6.6	3.9	-2.2	32.2	0.0	1224.4	708.0
Aditya Bir. Fas.	44.5	-6.1		0.9	202606	10.6	-201.5	11.4	-1.4	-9.5	0.0	0.9	89.0	44.1
Aditya Birla Cap	375.3	14.7	25.5	2.7	202606	28.2	40.1	16.3	18.2	-3.8	8.8	4.9	430.6	286.7
Aditya Infotech [1]	3799.1	38.9	97.6	13.8	202606	89.5	332.5	51.8	214.8	2.8	28.1	0.3	4094.5	1301.1
Aegis Logistics [1]	1400.8	35.6	39.3	8.1	202606	37.1	268.9	30.4	88.7	2.5	16.1	0.8	1528.0	576.0
Aegis Vopak Term	291.3	2.4	119.2	9.5	202606	12.4	-7.0	26.1	42.9	1.3	8.7	1.9	321.4	158.8
Aether Industri.	1671.8	18.1	92.5	9.0	202606	27.2	28.0	34.4	30.4	-5.4	11.6	0.1	1796.8	723.2
Afcons Infrastr.	242.7	5.6	43.6	1.6	202606	-20.8	-77.7	-11.9	-61.5	-3.9	10.5	0.6	479.1	225.6
Affle 3i [2]	1449.8	33.9	42.8	5.6	202606	20.4	21.7	19.8	19.2	-8.1	16.7	0.0	1997.9	1251.9
AIA Engineering [2]	3824.5	136.0	28.1	4.5	202606	12.4	-1.3	5.5	14.7	-2.4	21.1	0.0	5175.0	3053.5
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3582.2	90.8	39.4	9.9	202606	24.8	30.9	20.2	22.0	0.9	31.8	0.0	3797.0	2380.0
Alkem Lab [2]	5240.0	190.6	27.5	4.5	202606	10.9	-20.5	13.4	0.2	-0.6	19.7	0.1	5933.0	5052.1
Allied Blenders [2]	679.4	8.0	85.2	11.4	202606	6.1	-13.0	8.0	-7.1	-5.0	18.3	0.6	753.6	382.7
Alok Industries [1]	7.1	-1.5		-0.2	202606	6.5	-178.8	3.9	18.6	-6.0	0.0	0.0	18.5	6.9
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	747.7	39.9	18.7	1.7	202606	23.9	15.9	12.7	-6.9	-5.6	11.7	0.0	1022.5	671.5
Amber Enterp.	6499.4	56.1	115.8	5.2	202606	12.7	-3.4	14.6	-28.1	-6.6	10.6	0.7	8970.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cements [2]	363.0	19.2	18.9	1.5	202606	-7.7	-29.1	7.1	5.7	-5.7	6.7	0.0	588.6	356.6
Anand Rathi Wea. [5]	2105.1	28.0	75.2	35.0	202606	17.5	73.8	22.7	45.2	-0.9	59.8	0.1	2267.0	1354.0
Anant Raj [2]	579.2	16.1	36.0	3.6	202606	6.6	18.9	17.0	25.7	-6.1	12.0	0.1	744.1	403.0
Angel One [1]	276.0	11.3	24.5	4.1	202606	25.4	102.1	9.1	3.8	-4.2	14.8	1.0	360.2	208.9
Anthem Bioscienc [2]	854.1	10.5	81.1	15.8	202606	-22.6	-11.7	-2.1	17.6	-2.3	29.3	0.0	977.0	579.5
Apar Inds.	17648.7	287.9	61.3	9.4	202606	29.2	77.8	24.0	36.7	-0.7	31.1	0.2	19269.2	6800.0
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	2119.9	44.3	47.9	11.1	202606	8.7	10.9	10.6	53.4	-3.9	30.6	0.1	2300.9	1686.0
Apollo Hospitals [5]	8116.0	146.3	55.5	12.3	202606	20.6	34.2	17.2	33.7	-8.7	18.1	0.7	9326.8	6680.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	405.5	33.6	12.1	1.5	202606	12.8	0.1	11.2	72.5	1.3	13.4	0.3	540.3	365.4
Aptus Value Hou. [2]	226.7	19.7	11.5	2.3	202606	15.4	19.0	21.1	23.3	-7.3	15.4	1.6	331.9	193.5
Asahi India Glas [1]	944.5	17.5	53.9	6.1	202606	14.2	165.4	9.3	37.0	-1.6	11.2	0.7	1073.0	775.1
Ashok Leyland [1]	151.0	6.4	23.7	6.2	202606	11.7	0.8	16.4	17.1	-5.1	13.8	4.3	215.4	134.2
Asian Paints [1]	2406.3	50.9	47.3	10.8	202606	17.9	40.0	9.9	26.7	-1.6	25.9	0.2	2985.5	2116.0
Aster DM Quality	708.8	4.5	159.2	14.7	202606	21.6	-17.0	15.7	8.6	-6.7	11.8	0.6	891.0	519.8
Astral [1]	1339.0	22.1	60.7	8.9	202606	15.9	48.2	16.8	22.3	-4.1	19.4	0.1	1768.0	1311.9
Ather Energy [1]	1405.1	-9.7		13.7	202606	88.8	-128.5	67.2	52.4	-6.1	0.0	0.4	1741.9	566.0
Atul	5855.9	270.2	21.7	2.8	202606	25.0	92.0	15.8	59.1	-3.6	14.9	0.0	7198.2	5563.0
AU Small Finance	990.6	38.0	26.1	3.8	202606	21.1	37.0	17.3	30.8	-2.5	0.0	0.0	1144.7	719.5
Aurobindo Pharma 1]	1675.0	65.7	25.5	2.5	202606	16.9	28.1	9.4	11.5	-2.1	12.4	0.2	1739.6	1066.0
Authum Invest [1]	539.4	24.7	21.8	3.1	202606	20.9	17.8	-34.6	-48.7	-3.6	13.6	0.2	683.5	400.0
Avenue Super.	3809.7	46.9	81.3	10.2	202606	14.9	11.3	15.6	13.0	-0.5	17.2	0.1	4642.0	3528.7
AWL Agri Busine. [1]	175.8	9.0	19.5	2.2	202606	17.5	48.2	16.7	2.3	-4.5	17.1	0.2	282.9	171.2
Axis Bank [2]	1214.0	89.2	13.6	1.7	202606	9.9	22.2	5.6	-0.3	-0.5	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1131.9
B														
B H E L [2]	422.0	7.0	60.4	5.6	202606	40.3	-17.3	27.0	739.4	0.7	5.6	0.3	446.8	229.7
B P C L	301.0	35.7	8.4	1.3	202606	34.4	-154.5	12.3	-11.7	-2.1	24.9	0.6	391.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto	10069.9	428.9	23.5	7.1	202606	65.0	45.9	36.3	55.2	-11.2	28.4	0.4	12470.0	8490.1
Bajaj Finance [1]	949.4	32.9	28.9	5.2	202606	19.6	27.4	18.8	17.6	-4.6	10.9	3.8	1177.6	788.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1729.9	64.9	26.6	3.6	202606	19.4	12.3	15.1	9.3	-2.2	11.8	5.2	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings	10537.8	795.8	13.2	1.6	202606	21.5	32.2	30.2	27.3	-3.3	12.6	0.0	13245.0	8597.5
Bajaj Housing	82.9	3.2	25.6	3.1	202606	17.1	22.6	16.3	19.4	-0.3	8.8	4.4	113.6	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2081.8	72.7	28.6	3.7	202606	25.2	56.4	9.8	-3.3	-4.6	10.9	0.4	2775.0	1971.5
Balrampur Chini [1]	648.7	17.5	37.0	3.0	202606	6.1	-14.4	15.0	-11.3	-5.4	9.3	0.7	781.0	393.4
Bandhan Bank	175.3	8.4	20.9	1.1	202606	2.8	34.9	-0.2	-34.1	-6.3	0.0	0.0	220.7	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	231.8	42.9	5.4	0.7	202606	6.8	68.2	4.9	14.1	-1.5	0.0	0.0	325.6	223.9
Bank of India	129.2	25.9	5.0	0.7	202606	8.8	49.8	6.2	19.4	-6.3	0.0	0.0	178.5	122.2
Bank of Maha	80.4	9.8	8.2	1.8	202606	13.9	34.5	15.8	31.0	-5.1	0.0	0.0	94.5	54.7
Bata India [5]	612.8	13.5	45.3	4.9	202606	3.9	15.9	1.9	-20.7	-2.6	12.0	0.9	1236.9	605.6
Bayer Crop Sci.	3555.5	162.9	21.8	5.4	202606	-4.2	15.4	-2.8	23.6	-4.3	28.0	0.0	5133.0	3515.0
Belrise Industri [5]	237.6	5.3	45.0	3.3	202606	12.6	8.9	11.6	29.1	-4.3	14.4	0.6	268.0	142.8
BEML Ltd [5]	1960.8	21.4	91.5	5.6	202606	29.3	-142.1	12.8	-40.3	-3.7	5.7	0.1	2276.8	1361.1
Berger Paints [1]	452.3	10.5	42.9	7.6	202606	12.0	18.2	5.2	5.1	-1.3	21.3	0.1	594.2	391.5
Bharat Electron [1]	383.5	8.4	45.6	11.7	202606	24.9	8.7	19.8	11.7	-2.4	34.8	0.0	473.3	378.6
Bharat Forge [2]	1866.1	20.7	90.2	7.9	202606	18.7	-57.6	17.5	-1.3	-6.9	11.7	0.7	2293.0	1182.9
Bharti Airtel [5]	1741.0	51.0	34.1	6.2	202606	18.4	41.6	19.6	9.7	-2.6	19.3	1.6	2174.7	1726.1
Bharti Hexacom [5]	1380.0	37.0	37.3	9.6	202606	10.9	23.2	7.9	28.6	-6.9	20.5	1.0	1955.0	1365.5
Bikaji Foods [1]	504.0	10.4	48.3	7.9	202606	13.1	0.4	14.6	29.2	-12.1	20.1	0.2	768.3	498.0
Billionbrains [2]	180.2	3.9	46.3	11.7	202606	66.0	94.3	37.7	30.8	-3.8	37.2	0.1	227.0	112.0
Biocon [5]	370.9	4.5	82.8	1.8	202606	9.8	287.2	10.1	103.2	-2.7	3.8	0.6	447.0	338.0
Birlasoft Ltd [2]	269.7	21.3	12.6	1.8	202606	7.4	51.3	1.3	26.1	-1.6	20.0	0.0	473.8	267.1
BLS Internat. [1]	216.0	17.1	12.6	3.6	202606	25.3	11.2	31.8	24.9	-3.7	33.8	0.2	358.9	212.2
Blue Dart Expres	4504.1	136.6	33.0	6.0	202606	15.0	81.2	9.2	30.8	-5.1	15.0	0.6	7030.2	4472.0
Blue Star [2]	1475.0	25.7	57.3	8.8	202606	13.3	-21.0	5.9	-0.9	-6.1	19.6	0.2	2032.0	1432.0
Bosch	45599.9	801.2	56.9	9.1	202606	22.0	5.2	13.6	6.5	-5.2	21.0	0.0	49629.5	28650.1
Brainbees Solut. [2]	174.8	-2.0		1.9	202606	13.1	-141.4	11.7	24.2	-3.3	0.0	0.3	389.3	161.6
Brigade Enterpr.	568.9	20.8	27.3	2.7	202606	-12.9	16.1	4.8	-9.6	-5.0	10.7	1.0	801.6	461.3
Britannia Inds. [1]	4794.9	108.1	44.4	22.6	202606	9.5	13.6	7.5	18.7	-2.9	55.3	0.3	6269.9	4740.0
C														
C P C L	1346.2	280.3	4.8	1.8	202606	84.8	2471.9	33.5	2379.9	-2.2	34.1	0.3	1677.0	714.9
C.E. Info System [2]	845.9	25.1	33.6	5.1	202606	14.9	7.9	1.8	-12.5	-4.1	18.9	0.0	2000.0	795.3
Cams Services [2]	675.0	19.9	33.9	12.7	202606	11.5	17.4	7.7	5.1	-4.5	46.0	0.1	844.8	611.7
Can Fin Homes [2]	709.3	84.8	8.4	1.6	202606	7.4	19.6	8.2	28.2	-5.8	9.1	6.7	970.0	702.0
Canara Bank [2]	118.5	21.9	5.4	0.9	202606	4.5	3.0	3.1	7.3	-5.2	0.0	0.0	162.9	116.6
Caplin Point Lab [2]	2632.4	87.5	30.1	5.9	202606	19.6	15.8	15.0	17.7	-7.2	24.8	0.0	2990.6	1502.5
Capri Global [1]	249.5	11.7	21.3	3.3	202606	61.5	102.0	51.6	95.2	-1.7	11.7	3.5	287.5	151.2
Carborundum Uni. [1]	1240.0	15.9	77.8	6.1	202606	16.9	23.4	10.2	2.9	-3.0	10.7	0.1	1369.1	734.7
Castrol India [5]	199.0	10.9	18.2	10.3	202606	25.0	42.5	11.8	12.8	-1.3	58.8	0.0	207.0	170.2
CCL Products [2]	1054.7	32.4	32.6	6.0	202606	13.7	61.3	35.8	38.9	0.8	15.8	0.7	1241.9	815.6
CEAT	3287.1	157.4	20.9	2.6	202606	22.4	-96.7	21.5	38.5	-2.1	17.7	0.6	4431.6	3061.3
Cello World [5]	323.0	14.1	22.9	3.2	202606	-0.4	0.5	7.2	-3.3	-4.6	17.1	0.0	673.0	314.0
Cemindia Project [1]	1176.9	35.0	33.6	8.4	202606	5.6	2.6	8.9	46.8	-6.4	32.5	0.5	1650.0	481.4
Central Bank	30.0	5.0	6.0	0.7	202606	12.8	8.0	9.4	8.3	-3.8	0.0	0.0	40.9	29.4
Cera Sanitary. [5]	5099.3	191.6	26.6	4.9	202506	5.4	-1.1	5.2	7.0	-5.3	22.0	0.0	6730.0	4463.0
CESC [1]	131.5	11.7	11.2	1.4	202606	5.4	3.9	8.7	12.8	-6.0	10.2	1.6	204.4	129.8
CG Power & Ind [2]	876.8	8.1	108.5	17.3	202606	14.0	16.3	21.4	26.9	-1.0	27.0	0.0	981.2	525.5
Chalet Hotels	830.2	24.4	34.0	4.9	202606	-42.7	-54.4	6.0	87.8	-5.7	16.6	0.7	990.0	690.0
Chambal Fert.	399.4	48.1	8.3	1.5	202606	-11.8	-4.6	15.6	10.2	-4.4	25.4	0.1	521.9	396.2
Choice Intl.	719.6	10.2	70.3	9.8	202606	32.0	22.8	26.5	32.5	-4.3	19.1	0.6	860.0	568.6
Chola Financial [1]	1371.4	142.1	9.6	1.7	202606	19.5	39.3	17.5	21.1	-2.2	10.5	13.8	2061.5	1305.0
Cholaman.Inv.&Fn [2]	1583.0	67.3	23.5	4.4	202606	21.9	45.6	19.6	29.1	-4.6	9.7	7.1	1952.0	1299.8
CIE Automotive	377.0	23.6	16.0	1.9	202606	10.6	15.5	12.5	14.5	-3.3	14.4	0.1	525.9	367.4
Cipla [2]	1346.9	44.3	30.4	3.2	202606	3.5	-39.2	2.2	-33.6	-3.6	15.7	0.0	1672.2	1165.6
City Union Bank [1]	229.8	14.2	16.2	2.2	202606	23.6	25.1	19.8	20.4	1.8	0.0	0.0	248.8	157.2
Clean Science [1]	804.1	21.9	36.7	5.4	202606	10.5	4.7	-0.3	-13.3	-0.4	20.7	0.0	1112.0	652.8
Coal India	421.5	50.6	8.3	2.2	202606	7.8	0.6	10.1	-6.0	-0.9	20.8	0.1	490.9	369.6
Cochin Shipyard [5]	1288.5	25.9	49.8	5.8	202606	2.4	-19.4	-1.4	-19.1	-6.4	16.1	0.2	1930.0	1186.6
Coforge [2]	1825.2	43.7	41.7	3.1	202606	49.2	99.6	35.7	100.2	2.0	21.9	0.1	2022.0	1008.5
Cohance Life [1]	451.5	2.8	160.4	4.4	202606	-23.1	-144.2	-19.8	-77.5	-1.7	5.0	0.1	917.5	267.9
Colgate-Palmoliv [1]	1735.0	50.3	34.5	29.8	202606	12.0	7.8	3.7	-1.8	-6.4	104.1	0.0	2329.9	1716.0
Concord Biotech [1]	1375.1	26.6	51.8	7.1	202606	26.2	32.8	-6.7	-22.0	-5.4	18.0	0.0	1667.0	987.1
Container Corpn. [5]	445.6	16.3	27.3	2.6	202606	0.3	0.1	1.7	-6.2	-3.5	12.6	0.1	557.8	421.8
Coromandel Inter [1]	1764.8	63.3	27.9	4.2	202606	15.9	-24.6	23.5	-6.0	-10.2	22.7	0.1	2496.1	1702.0
Craftsman Auto [5]	10250.7	179.1	57.2	5.1	202606	36.3	99.2	37.9	102.8	-4.5	13.9	1.0	11990.0	6251.7
CreditAcc. Gram.	1238.9	75.4	16.4	2.5	202606	21.9	719.7	11.9	524.3	-4.7	10.0	3.0	1634.4	1112.9
CRISIL [1]	4426.7	120.9	36.6	9.9	202606	27.6	26.2	22.0	21.5	-2.1	35.6	0.1	5060.0	3689.0
Crompton Gr. Con [2]	202.1	7.1	28.6	4.4	202606	11.8	14.9	7.9	-13.7	-7.6	19.5	0.1	310.7	201.1
Cummins India [2]	4859.7	88.0	55.2	15.9	202606	18.1	2.5	15.4	14.4	-1.9	37.3	0.0	6142.8	3802.6
Cyient [5]	1105.5	36.9	29.9	2.2	202606	21.3	-32.3	3.2	-34.4	1.0	12.8	0.1	1226.3	751.0
D														
Dabur India [1]	377.0	11.2	33.7	5.9	202606	10.6	15.0	7.4	11.4	-2.6	20.9	0.1	533.8	368.1
Dalmia BharatLtd [2]	1680.6	58.8	28.6	1.8	202606	7.0	-14.5	7.6	19.5	-1.0	7.8	0.4	2320.0	1605.0
Data Pattern [2]	4247.2	48.3	88.0	13.7	202606	16.8	-13.5	33.8	26.0	-3.9	22.7	0.0	5000.0	2131.0
DCM Shriram [2]	904.1	87.8	10.3	1.8	202606	9.2	445.3	11.1	121.9	-7.1	11.2	0.4	1408.8	887.0
Deepak Fertilis.	1301.4	78.0	16.7	2.4	202606	22.5	101.5	13.6	0.3	-4.8	11.7	0.8	1681.3	865.5
Deepak Nitrite [2]	1493.7	58.1	25.7	3.5	202606	36.4	207.5	7.1	30.5	-5.9	11.3	0.3	1895.0	1280.4
Delhivery [1]	400.6	1.6	251.6	3.1	202606	27.8	-65.0	23.1	-40.0	-5.4	0.6	0.2	524.3	374.4
Devyani Intl. [1]	127.0	-0.1		10.2	202606	16.5	277.6	14.7	43.9	-5.9	0.0	2.6	173.6	91.6
Divi's Lab. [2]	9294.4	112.2	82.8	14.7	202606	27.8	65.5	16.3	29.2	-3.3	21.0	0.0	10000.0	5648.0
Dixon Technolog. [2]	12700.0	306.9	41.4	16.6	202606	21.1	194.9	14.3	128.5	-5.3	32.1	0.2	17495.0	9605.1
DLF [2]	662.6	17.4	38.1	3.6	202606	-52.9	4.1	-27.7	1.6	-2.6	6.6	0.1	786.4	489.3
DOMS Industries	2098.4	35.8	58.6	10.4	202606	19.2	-22.3	19.9	4.6	0.7	25.4	0.2	2704.0	2006.9
Dr Lal Pathlabs	2006.6	33.5	59.9	13.4	202606	19.1	28.0	14.3	9.6	2.8	27.5	0.1	2035.0	1272.0
Dr Reddy's Labs [1]	1200.1	38.6	31.1	2.6	202606	-5.6	-68.7	-0.9	-43.3	-0.2	13.7	0.2	1414.4	1080.1
E														
eClerx Services	1803.0	77.5	23.3	5.8	202606	23.3	16.0	23.2	27.6	-5.1	33.8	0.2	2493.0	1319.1
Eicher Motors [1]	6949.9	211.9	32.8	7.6	202606	31.2	21.3	27.9	20.2	-5.5	29.1	0.0	8232.8	6439.5
EID Parry [1]	674.5	45.6	14.8	1.4	202606	3.4	-42.5	15.6	4.3	-4.3	25.0	0.4	1116.6	672.3
EIH [2]	298.0	11.6	25.6	3.5	202606	14.5	-7.8	8.3	-8.4	1.1	20.9	0.1	414.9	271.4
Elecon Engg.Co [1]	440.3	13.5	32.7	4.3	202606	6.1	-34.6	3.0	-32.7	-3.8	20.0	0.1	625.5	352.0
Elgi Equipments [1]	585.2	14.6	40.0	8.3	202606	22.6	27.0	15.9	27.9	-3.0	23.1	0.3	653.2	409.0
Emami [1]	372.4	17.4	21.5	5.6	202606	14.9	-16.4	2



A 'parking lot' to beat price rise

CASH WISE. Arbitrage funds beat inflation more consistently over longer periods, with modest real gains

GETTY IMAGES

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

While equity mutual funds are expected to beat inflation over the long term, low-risk investment avenues are seldom assessed on this parameter. Our analysis of debt mutual funds, 'Debt mutual funds ace the inflation test' (*bl.portfolio* edition dated September 27), found that several debt fund categories outperformed inflation more often than commonly believed.

We now extend the analysis to arbitrage funds, which have also demonstrated a notable ability to beat inflation despite being viewed primarily as short-term parking avenues.

A *bl.portfolio* analysis of rolling returns shows that arbitrage funds beat CPI inflation in 68 per cent of one-year periods. The success rate was 61 per cent over two years, rising to 70 per cent over three years and 81 per cent over five years.

Although arbitrage funds must invest at least 65 per cent in equities and equity-related instruments, their returns resemble those of debt products. Fund managers exploit price differences between the cash and futures markets by buying stocks in the spot market and simultaneously selling futures.

As the futures contract approaches expiry, the price gap narrows, allowing the fund to lock in the spread as income.

Since the equity position is hedged with futures, the fund has limited exposure to market direction. However, returns are not assured and depend on the availability of arbitrage opportunities, market liquidity, transaction costs and the cost of carrying positions.

WHY CONSIDER

- Uses cash-futures price differences
- Keeps directional equity risk limited
- Offers equity-oriented tax treatment
- Suits surplus money beyond one year
- Aims for stability, not wealth creation

WHAT WE ANALYSED

We analysed both point-to-point and rolling returns over the past 10 years, based on the availability of schemes with sufficiently long track records. The point-to-point analysis covered all available arbitrage funds for each holding period, using their direct plans, while the rolling return analysis was restricted to 15 schemes with at least a 10-year track record.

To assess performance across different entry points, we calculated one-, two-, three- and five-year rolling returns at monthly intervals. Scheme returns were compared with the All-India Combined Consumer Price Index (CPI), adjusted using the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation's linking factors to ensure consistency across its three base-year revisions.

FINDINGS

Odds improve over longer horizons

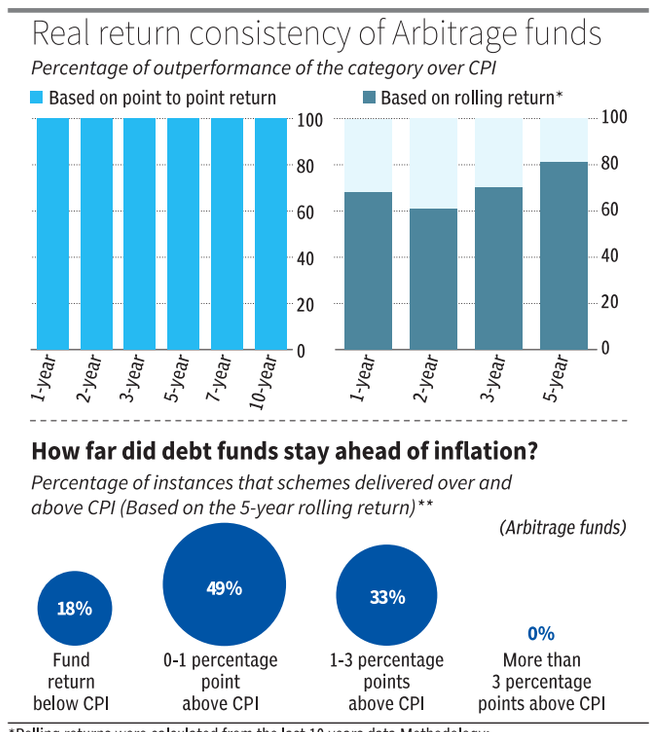
The point-to-point analysis produced striking results. Every eligible arbitrage fund beat CPI inflation across the investment horizons for which it had sufficient history: one, two, three, five, seven and 10 years.

However, rolling returns offer a more realistic picture. Arbitrage funds beat inflation in 68 per cent of one-year periods and 61 per cent of two-year periods. The proportion then rose to 70 per cent over three years and 81 per cent over five years. The success rate did not rise at every step, but the longer holding periods showed better consistency in beating inflation.

High consistency, modest real returns

At the scheme level, Invesco India Arbitrage and Edelweiss Arbitrage Fund outperformed inflation in about 98 per cent of five-year rolling observations. Kotak Arbitrage Fund and Nippon India Arbitrage Fund followed closely, with a success rate of 97 per cent.

However, the magnitude of outperformance remained limited. About 49 per cent of five-year rolling observations delivered returns just 0-1 percentage point above inflation, while 33 per cent were 1-3 percentage points above it. The remaining observations failed to beat inflation. Notably, no five-year rolling observation generated real returns exceeding three percentage points over CPI. This suggests that while arbitrage funds have generally been effective at preserving purchasing power, their ability to generate substantial inflation-adjusted gains remains constrained.



*Rolling returns were calculated from the last 10 years data Methodology:
Each scheme's return for every rolling period was compared with the corresponding-period return of the All-India Combined CPI General Index.

**Instances were classified based on the scheme's return differential versus CPI: below CPI, 0-1 percentage point above CPI, 1-3 percentage points above CPI and more than 3 percentage points above CPI. The figures represent the percentage share of instances in the category.

Returns as of August 31, 2026 Source: ACEMF, *bl.portfolio* compilation

WHAT IT MEANS FOR INVESTORS

Arbitrage funds occupy a distinct position in the investment landscape, combining relatively-low market risk with equity-oriented taxation. For investors in higher tax brackets, this tax treatment can make a meaningful difference to post-tax returns.

While most debt mutual funds purchased on or after April 1, 2023, are taxed at the investor's applicable income-tax slab rate, irrespective of the holding period, arbitrage funds qualify for equity taxation, provided they maintain the prescribed equity exposure. Gains on units held for more than a year are taxed at 12.5 per cent, subject to the applicable exemption for long-term capital gains. This can make them more tax-efficient than debt funds for investors with a longer holding period.

The difference can be meaningful. Assuming both an arbitrage fund and a liquid fund generate an annual pre-tax return of 6 per cent, investors in the 20 per cent and 30 per cent tax bracket would retain about 4.8 per cent and 4.2 per cent respectively from the liquid fund after tax, compared with approximately 5.25 per cent from the arbitrage fund if held for more than a year, ignoring the applicable long-term capital gains exemption, surcharge and cess. Over time, this tax advantage can materially improve realised returns.

Over the past decade, the one-year rolling returns of arbitrage funds' direct plans averaged 6.3 per cent, marginally higher than the 6.1 per cent delivered by liquid funds' direct plans. The advantage persisted over longer periods, with five-year rolling returns averaging 5.8 per cent CAGR for arbitrage funds, compared with 5.5 per cent for liquid funds.

The combination of comparable historical returns and favourable tax treatment makes arbitrage funds an alternative for parking surplus money, particularly when the investment horizon exceeds one year. However, investors should also account for expenses, exit loads and the possibility of short-term fluctuations.

Arbitrage funds are better suited to investors seeking relatively-stable returns and tax efficiency than those pursuing substantial long-term wealth creation. Their historical record of beating inflation is encouraging. However, the modest margin of outperformance also highlights their limitations.

While they can help preserve purchasing power and enhance post-tax returns, their primary role remains managing surplus money rather than building long-term wealth.

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5	Sep 14
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.7	6.25	May 18
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	6.5	6.75	6.25	6	Aug 10
Indian Bank	6.2	6.65	6.6	6.05	Aug 04
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	May 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.35	6.35	Jun 01
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.85	6.1	5.95	Jun 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.6	6.55	6.1	6	Aug 04
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.5	6.5	6.5	Sep 30
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7.45	7.45	7.25	Jun 20
CSB Bank	6	7.1	7	5.75	Sep 05
City Union Bank	6.25	7.25	6.5	6.25	Jun 16
DCB Bank	6.5	7.5	7.5	7.5	Aug 04
Dhanlaxmi Bank	7	7.1	6.5	7.25	Sep 02
Federal Bank	6	6.65	6.5	6.7	Sep 29
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Aug 19
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Oct 01
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.55	Sep 21
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.1	7.1	6.75	Sep 01
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	7	6.65	Jul 24
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.05	6.75	Sep 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	7	6.15	6.15	Jun 08
Kotak Bank	6	6.65	6.65	6.4	Sep 23
Karur Vysya Bank	7	7.2	6.55	6.55	Jun 08
RBL Bank	6.05	7	7	7	Oct 01
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.6	6.8	6.2	Jun 19
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.35	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	6.75	Jun 02
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	7.1	7.75	8	Jun 16
ESAF Small Finance Bank	6	7.75	8	6	Aug 17
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	7.3	8	7.77	Sep 29
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.8	8.1	8.25	Sep 24
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.55	7.25	7.8	Sep 01
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.5	6.5	6.5	Sep 30
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 01

Data as on respective banks' website on 02 Oct 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

ALERTS.

Axis NPS Swasthya Scheme

Axis Pension Fund Management has announced the availability of 'Axis NPS Swasthya Scheme', a voluntary health-linked pension solution designed to help individuals build a dedicated corpus for medical expenses while continuing to grow their long-term retirement savings. It enables subscribers of the NPS to allocate up to 25 per cent of their contributions towards a market-linked medical emergency fund that can be used for hospitalisation, doctor consultations, medicines, diagnostic tests and outpatient care. Axis NPS Swasthya Scheme is available in partnership with Medi Assist and provides access to a network of over 18,000 hospitals across more than 1,000 cities, enabling seamless cashless medical payments. The scheme follows a self-funding model, where healthcare coverage is supported by the market-linked growth of the invested corpus.



Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

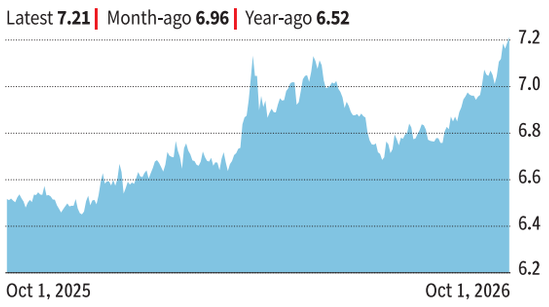
Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%) Jul 1 - Sep 30, 2026	Interest rate (%) Oct 1 - Dec 31, 2026	Compounding frequency
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5#	7.5#	Annually
Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on September 30, 2026
#Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, GoI

Bond yields

10-year benchmark G-Sec yield (%)

Latest **7.21** | Month-ago **6.96** | Year-ago **6.52**



Yields on government securities of different maturities (%)

» 91-day Treasury Bill **5.5** » 364-day Treasury Bill **6.2** » 3-year G-Sec **6.8** » 5-year G-Sec **6.9**

Source: Bloomberg, RBI Note: All data as on October 1, 2026 or latest available

Unpacking bundled insurance

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

IRDAI consultation paper on insurance distribution released recently covered a wide range of topics on commissions, industry structure, mis-selling and proposals for improvement. One of the sections relates to bundled insurance – a practice of adding insurance to an otherwise unrelated product, with or without complete information to the customer or even as a compulsory package.

The two areas covered here are the two prominent platforms where insurance is bundled – car sales and home loans. We look at why adding a motor insurance or a home loan term insurance at the dealer or the branch should be replaced with better alternatives; and what insurance component the consultation paper proposes to unbundle in these two areas.

MOTOR INSURANCE

Motor insurance, though not bundled, is often pushed on to the car purchaser by the insurance agent at the dealer's premises. A motor insurance can be purchased independently, either online or through an agent, and such a purchase serves the policyholder better on three critical counts.

First, the independent motor insurance is 20-30 per cent cheaper than the dealer-provided insurance as the commission component increases the cost. The IRDAI paper also references this high-cost practice, indicating that OEM brokers get an average commission of 24 per cent.



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BETTER DEAL

A policyholders can structure their policy better with additional features on an online platform

Second, the consumer has little access to competing products or their features as the insurance broker is associated with only one insurer while a policyholder can access several insurers and their price quotes online.

Third, policyholders can structure their policy better with additional features on an online platform, starting from a plain base policy. Zero depreciation, engine protection, return to invoice, consumables, 24-hour roadside assistance and several other features/add-ons are available here. In a dealer-provided policy, the scope for comparison and customisation will be limited to the options provided by dealers and also at the cost provided by them.

HOME LOAN TERM INSURANCE

There are two financial products for covering a home loan – home loan insurance and a regular term insurance policy.

A home loan insurance is designed specifically to repay the outstanding loan to the bank in the unfortunate event of a borrower's demise. Although it protects the family from inheriting the debt, the cover generally reduces as the loan balance shrinks. The premium for the insurance though is added to the borrower's loan amount which is repaid as part of the regular EMIs.

A regular term insurance is typically more economical and flexible. For a 35-year-old seeking a ₹1-crore cover, the annual premium is around ₹8,000-9,000, while comparable home loan insurance could cost 10-20 per cent more. But a term insurance policy maintains the full insured amount throughout the policy period, even as the home loan declines or is repaid early. It is also independent of the lender, so refinancing or transferring the loan to another bank does not cancel the protection unlike a home loan term insurance

The most important distinction is control over the payout. Home loan insurance settles the bank's outstanding claim and then ends.

A term insurance policy instead pays the full sum assured to the nominee, allowing the family to decide whether to clear the loan fully, repay a part of it, or retain funds for living costs and other priorities.

IRDAI PROPOSALS

The IRDAI proposal bars banks from compulsorily bundling insurance with their products or services. If the bank wants protection against adverse events affecting borrowers, they may purchase a group policy for the loan portfolio and treat the premium as an institutional expense. This reiterates the above point that home loan term insurance is a benefit for the bank but paid for by the borrower.

The proposal allows package offers only when they provide specific, demonstrable customer benefits. This implies that loans may also carry a lower interest rate when borrowers provide term life cover equal to the loan amount but the bank has to disclose interest rates with and without this additional security, allow customers to buy the insurance from any bank, NBFC, or insurer, and ensure premiums are paid separately and directly from the customer's account, debit card, or credit card, rather than being deducted from or financed through the loan amount. This preserves customer choice.

On motor insurance the proposals are even more far-reaching. For starters, the proposal maintains that insurance products that are mandatory should not receive any premium. As most of the heavylifting of selling insurance is undertaken by the government by making it mandatory, the distributor should not expect a commission. For instance, on the compulsory three-year third party insurance on new purchase of a vehicle, there is zero commission proposed. For other motor insurance products, sales are subjected to a cap on commissions ranging from 5-10 per cent. The remaining proposal on bundling is common to motor insurance as well.

Even without the changes proposed, policyholders should be armed with prior options on insuring their asset and exercise an informed choice without being subjected to a bundled sale.

CHENNAI
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - OCTOBER 4 - 2026



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	Trailing Returns (%) 3 Year CAGR	Trailing Returns (%) 5 Year CAGR	Trailing Returns (%) 10 Year CAGR	Sortino Ratio (%)
	EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Large Cap	101.6	80206	1.1	0.7	-8.0	8.6	9.5	12.3	0.30
★★★★★	Invesco India Largecap	68.1	2021	1.8	0.7	-1.3	11.1	9.0	11.6	0.26
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Large Cap	84.3	54134	1.2	0.6	-7.8	8.6	11.0	12.7	0.36
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	208.4	2641	1.7	0.7	-4.0	8.7	8.3	11.5	0.24
★★★★	Canara Robeco Large Cap	57.9	17092	1.4	0.5	-7.5	7.5	6.8	11.8	0.18
★★★★	JM Large Cap	144.6	394	2.1	0.8	-4.8	7.5	8.2	10.0	0.24
★★★★	SBI Large Cap	88.6	55140	1.2	0.7	-3.5	7.3	7.6	10.7	0.22
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	488.3	29711	1.4	0.8	-6.7	7.4	7.4	10.4	0.20
★★★	Bandhan Large Cap	74.0	2180	1.7	0.8	-3.6	10.2	8.4	11.4	0.23
★★★	DSP Large Cap	429.4	7101	1.5	0.8	-8.8	8.4	7.5	9.5	0.20
★★★	Edelweiss Large Cap	79.1	1434	1.8	0.6	-5.2	7.3	7.6	11.3	0.20
★★★	Franklin Ind Large Cap	951.3	7490	1.5	0.9	-6.5	7.5	6.0	9.5	0.17
★★★	HDFC Large Cap	1057.7	39933	1.3	0.8	-6.7	6.7	8.9	11.2	0.28
★★★	HSBC Large Cap	455.1	1855	1.8	1.0	-3.1	8.1	7.5	10.7	0.19
★★★	Kotak Large Cap	530.8	10937	1.5	0.6	-6.8	7.6	7.0	11.0	0.19
★★★	Mahi Manu Large Cap	20.7	695	2.0	0.7	-8.8	5.4	5.8	-	0.14
★★★	Tata Large Cap	473.8	2765	1.7	0.8	-5.7	7.6	7.4	10.4	0.21
★★	Groww Largecap	40.4	137	2.1	0.9	-5.8	7.6	6.8	9.5	0.18
★★	Mirae Asset Large Cap	105.1	38166	1.3	0.5	-6.5	6.2	5.9	11.2	0.15
★★	Union Largecap	21.7	437	2.1	1.3	-7.1	5.3	5.5	-	0.13
★★	UTI Large Cap	249.7	12189	1.5	0.8	-8.4	5.2	5.1	10.0	0.11
★	Axis Large Cap	56.6	31376	1.3	0.6	-5.8	6.8	4.0	10.8	0.06
★	LIC MF Large Cap	50.8	1385	1.8	0.9	-8.5	5.7	4.4	8.9	0.08
★	PGIM India Large Cap	313.6	538	2.1	0.8	-7.2	4.9	4.4	8.8	0.09
-	Taurus Large Cap	165.0	60	2.1	1.9	5.9	12.2	9.9	9.8	0.26
	EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	134.7	21020	1.4	0.4	0.4	14.9	14.6	14.3	0.45
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	970.5	33592	1.3	0.7	-4.0	12.4	12.8	13.9	0.48
★★★★★	Quant Large & Mid Cap	119.3	3487	1.7	0.6	6.7	12.2	13.3	14.4	0.37
★★★★	Axis Large & Mid Cap	33.3	17320	1.4	0.5	2.5	12.7	10.1	-	0.28
★★★★	HDFC Large & Mid Cap	328.0	30294	1.4	0.8	-3.3	10.3	12.2	13.7	0.39
★★★★	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	104.7	12387	1.5	0.5	4.8	19.8	14.9	15.4	0.42
★★★★	UTI Large & Mid Cap	174.7	6514	1.6	0.8	-1.1	12.3	12.0	12.8	0.39
★★★	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	88.2	529	2.1	0.9	2.2	10.6	9.9	11.5	0.28
★★★	DSP Large & Mid Cap	580.6	18411	1.4	0.5	-5.2	10.5	9.8	12.8	0.29
★★★	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	85.2	4942	1.6	0.5	-0.3	11.1	10.3	13.4	0.32
★★★	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	28.6	5931	1.6	0.7	6.1	15.0	12.3	-	0.31
★★★	Kotak Large & Mid Cap	331.9	32325	1.3	0.5	-2.5	10.5	11.4	13.5	0.33
★★★	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	147.3	45811	1.3	0.5	-1.9	9.2	8.6	14.6	0.25
★★★	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1406.9	7903	1.5	0.9	-3.9	12.1	11.2	11.9	0.35
★★★	SBI Large & Midcap	610.4	42336	1.3	0.6	-1.5	10.3	11.4	13.2	0.37
★★	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	241.7	26331	1.4	0.5	-5.2	9.9	8.4	13.1	0.24
★★	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	178.7	3622	1.6	1.1	-5.5	9.1	7.9	10.4	0.24
★★	LIC MF Large & Midcap	36.7	3198	1.7	0.5	-4.2	10.4	8.8	12.1	0.26
★★	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	88.0	7544	1.5	0.7	3.5	11.7	10.2	13.5	0.29
★	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	904.7	5998	1.6	0.9	1.3	9.2	6.0	9.9	0.14
★	Navi Large & Midcap	34.5	315	2.1	0.5	-1.1	6.6	7.6	11.0	0.22
★	Tata Large & Mid Cap	468.8	7679	1.5	0.6	-8.6	4.5	7.4	10.9	0.20
	EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	HDFC Flexi Cap	1951.4	113606	1.1	0.6	-3.4	13.4	14.8	14.6	0.54
★★★★★	JM Flexi Cap	95.9	5291	1.6	0.5	-1.6	11.8	13.2	14.6	0.39
★★★★★	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	80.4	147405	1.1	0.5	-5.2	11.2	10.3	15.9	0.35
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1863.6	29044	1.4	0.7	4.5	12.7	9.9	12.3	0.29
★★★★	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	36.7	3722	1.6	0.5	-3.2	11.2	10.0	13.1	0.29
★★★★	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1501.0	19385	1.4	0.8	-7.0	8.5	9.7	11.9	0.29
★★★★	HSBC Flexi Cap	225.6	6000	1.6	0.9	3.3	13.7	11.6	12.0	0.31
★★★	Axis Flexi Cap	27.1	13943	1.5	0.6	1.9	11.7	7.2	-	0.17
★★★	Bandhan Flexi Cap	199.4	7508	1.5	1.0	-4.0	8.7	8.3	9.8	0.22
★★★	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	323.5	13679	1.5	0.5	-5.2	9.0	7.5	12.6	0.20
★★★	DSP Flexi Cap	97.8	12500	1.5	0.6	-4.2	8.4	7.8	12.3	0.20
★★★	Kotak Flexi Cap	80.5	56392	1.2	0.5	-4.6	9.1	8.8	11.8	0.24
★★★	Navi Flexi Cap	24.0	297	2.1	0.5	5.6	8.5	8.7	-	0.25
★★★	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.3	5963	1.6	0.5	-2.2	8.2	5.9	12.4	0.15
★★★	Union Flexi Cap	50.2	2452	1.7	0.8	-1.4	8.8	8.4	12.0	0.23
★★	LIC MF Flexi Cap	100.0	1125	1.9	0.9	-0.3	8.8	8.4	9.7	0.23
★★	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	61.0	14160	1.4	0.7	1.0	16.2	11.3	11.6	0.31
★★	SBI Flexicap	103.9	23235	1.4	0.7	-4.7	6.6	6.5	10.7	0.17
★★	Tata Flexi Cap	22.2	3663	1.6	0.6	-8.5	7.1	6.6	-	0.17
★	Shriram Flexi Cap	18.5	131	2.1	0.8	-6.4	4.0	4.9	-	0.10
★	Taurus Flexi Cap	239.3	382	2.1	2.0	7.6	10.9	10.0	9.7	0.27
★	UTI Flexi Cap	308.6	24163	1.4	0.8	-4.2	6.3	3.2	10.9	0.05
-	Quant Flexi Cap	103.6	7364	1.5	0.6	6.7	12.8	12.4	17.6	0.34
	EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS									
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	280.6	3493	1.7	0.8	-0.3	12.1	10.6	12.8	0.30
-	ICICI Pru Multi Cap	808.3	19538	1.4	0.8	3.3	13.1	12.8	13.2	0.42
-	Invesco India Multicap	125.5	4529	1.6	0.6	-1.9	10.3	9.7	12.3	0.26
-	ITI Multi Cap	25.4	1543	1.8	0.5	10.1	14.2	11.5	-	0.32
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	37.7	7662	1.5	0.4	8.6	14.2	13.2	-	0.38
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	286.2	56298	1.2	0.6	-4.3	10.8	14.5	14.4	0.47
-	Quant Multi Cap	640.7	7725	1.5	0.6	3.8	7.9	9.6	16.5	0.25
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	371.3	3070	1.7	0.8	-2.7	10.0	9.9	13.0	0.30
	EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Edelweiss Mid Cap	102.8	19891	1.4	0.4	3.2	17.4	15.6	16.8	0.46
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4273.6	52271	1.2	0.6	3.7	15.5	15.8	16.8	0.48
★★★★★	Quant Mid Cap	211.0	8056	1.5	0.7	2.5	8.3	13.3	16.5	0.37
★★★★	HDFC Mid Cap	197.8	108325	1.1	0.6	2.7	14.4	16.7	15.8	0.55
★★★★	Invesco India Midcap	188.2	15905	1.4	0.5	5.4	20.4	17.0	17.2	0.47
★★★★	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	33.8	5406	1.6	0.5	3.7	13.7	14.6	-	0.44
★★★★	Motilal Oswal Midcap	97.9	42852	1.3	0.6	-2.1	16.0	18.4	15.3	0.50
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	105.2	2658	1.7	0.5	4.7	13.3	12.7	14.1	0.38
★★★	HSBC Midcap	448.3	17188	1.4	0.5	14.7	20.5	16.3	15.8	0.44
★★★	ICICI Pru Mid Cap	322.2	8403	1.5	0.9	9.0	18.3	14.9	15.3	0.47
★★★	Kotak Mid Cap	136.7	71256	1.2	0.3	0.3	14.3	14.1	15.8	0.42
★★★	PGIM India Midcap	63.1	11218	1.5	0.5	-2.2	9.1	8.4	14.0	0.24
★★★	SBI Midcap	229.9	24518	1.4	0.7	1.5	8.3	11.7	12.6	0.35
★★★	Sundaram Mid Cap	1400.3	14863	1.4	0.8	1.9	15.1	14.7	13.1	0.44
★★★	Tata Mid Cap	434.8	6240	1.6	0.5	1.7	11.7	12.6	14.6	0.38
★★	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	804.5	6966	1.6	0.9	3.9	12.2	11.9	12.1	0.35
★★	Axis Midcap	116.3	35425	1.3	0.5	3.6	13.9	11.1	15.8	0.32
★★	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2645.2	13052	1.5	0.8	-1.7	12.8	11.4	12.9	0.33
★★	UTI Mid Cap	297.3	12795	1.5	0.7	0.2	9.3	9.9	12.5	0.28
★	DSP Midcap	146.1	21019	1.4	0.6	-0.3	11.3	9.5	12.7	0.27
★	LIC MF Midcap	29.5	392	2.1	1.2	2.5	13.4	10.9	-	0.30
★	Taurus Mid Cap	126.7	140	2.1	1.7	5.1	9.0	11.3	13.9	0.30
	EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS									
★★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	58.5	3307	1.7	0.4	27.5	19.9	18.2	-	0.44
★★★★★	Quant Small Cap	285.8	35557	1.3	0.6	12.5	15.9	17.3	19.6	0.43
★★★★	Edelweiss Small Cap	45.7	7253	1.5	0.4	5.7	12.7	14.3	-	0.41
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	46.4	15744	1.4	0.4	12.6	19.9	17.6	-	0.46
★★★★	Nippon Ind Small Cap	178.9	82580	1.1	0.5	7.1	13.4	17.1	19.7	0.46
★★★★	Union Small Cap	58.4	2667	1.7	0.8	19.2	15.1	15.5	16.1	0.40
★★★	AXIS Small Cap	113.3	31448	1.4	0.6	7.9	13.5	14.1	17.7	0.42
★★★	Canara Robeco Small Cap	39.3	14661	1.5	0.5	2.5	10.0	12.4	-	0.35
★★★	DSP Small Cap	225.4	21659	1.4	0.7	16.3	15.9	16.2	15.9	0.44
★★★	HSBC Small Cap	88.5	19076	1.4	0.6	11.3	12.6	15.5	17.1	0.39
★★★	Kotak Small Cap	267.2	19679	1.4	0.5	4.6	10.4	10.7	15.5	0.29
★★★	LIC MF Small Cap	34.5	832	2.0	0.8	13.3	16.2	15.8	-	0.40
★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	287.7	4155	1.6	0.7	11.4	14.3	14.5	13.9	0.39
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	172.1	14746	1.5	0.8	3.6	10.8	14.2	13.8	0.37
★★	HDFC Small Cap	135.0	41891	1.3	0.6	-3.7	8.7	12.8	16.0	0.35
★★	ICICI Pru Small Cap	89.9	9821	1.5	0.7	3.1	9.9	12.4	14.7	0.38
★★	Tata Small Cap	39.0	13094	1.5	0.4	-1.6	10.1	13.3	-	0.35
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	97.3	6226	1.6	0.8	16.0	13.4	12.0	12.1	0.31
★	SBI Small Cap	178.1	42631	1.3	0.6	4.6	9.8	12.1	17.0	0.37
	EQUITY - FOCUSED FUNDS									
★★★★★	HDFC Focused	222.2	28201	1.4	0.6	-4.8	13.0	15.3	13.2	0.55
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Focused	89.7	17949	1.4	0.6	-3.1	14.2	12.8	13.6	0.41
★★★★	360 ONE Focused	46.7	6800	1.5	0.7	0.9	9.1	9.5	13.9	0.26
★★★★	Quant Focused	89.4	850	2.0	0.7	5.4	10.9	11.0	13.3	0.30
★★★★	SBI Focused	383.3	51248	1.2	0.6	7.7	13.4	9.9	13.9	0.31
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Focused	138.9	7971	1.5	0.8	-0.2	10.4	8.5	11.4	0.25
★★★	Bandhan Focused	87.8	2094	1.8	0.7	1.3	13.6	10.7	12.2	0.30
★★★	DSP Focused	52.7	2671	1.7	0.8	-2.1	10.6	8.9	10.5	0.24
★★★	Franklin Ind Focused Equity	93.5	11506	1.5	0.8	-13.2	5.1	7.5	11.4	0.22
★★★	Nippon Ind Focused	115.5	8651	1.5	1.0	-3.8	7.0	8.5	11.6	0.25
★★★	Sundaram Focused	159.0	1097	1.9	1.0	0.3	8.3	7.9	12.0	0.21
★★	JM Focused	19.1	293	2.1	0.7	-4.0	8.9	10.3	10.6	0.28
★★	Mirae Asset Focused	24.2	6752	1.6	0.6	-5.5	5.5	4.5	-	0.09
★★	Motilal Oswal Focused	52.4	1827	1.8	0.8	23.3	13.0	9.1	11.7	0.22
★	Axis Focused	52.7	11424	1.5	0.8	-3.1	7.7	2.3	10.3	0.02
★	Baroda BNP Paribas Focused	19.8	660	2.1	0.5	-7.3	5.0	6.1	-	0.14
-	LIC MF Focused	21.5	175	2.1	1.1	0.8	8.0	7.2	-	0.19
	EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS									
★★★★★	HSBC Value	108.4	15373	1.5	0.6	-0.7	12.9	13.8	14.2	0.41
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Value	433.1	60075	1.2	0.8	-8.1	9.6	12.1	13.3	0.47
★★★★	Bandhan Value	140.9	9981	1.5	0.6	-3.7	7.9	10.9	13.7	0.32
★★★★	Nippon Ind Value	209.6	9043	1.5	0.9	-6.7	11.2	11.4	13.8	0.35
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Value	131.7	6925	1.6	0.9	7.8	11.8	12.4	10.8	0.34
★★★	JM Value	93.6	817	2.0	1.0	-2.8	9.9	13.0	14.0	0.37
★★★	LIC MF Value	28.3	302	2.1	0.9	18.1	15.4	12.4	-	0.32
★★★	Templeton India Value	648.8	1922	1.8	0.8	-8.3	6.5	10.5	11.9	0.34
★★★	Union Value	27.2	399	2.1	1.1	-3.0	9.5	10.2	-	0.32
★★	HDFC Value	759.6	8266	1.5	0.9	3.2	13.8	12.1	13.0	0.37
★★	Tata Value	335.4	8656	1.5	0.7	-3.1	10.4	11.4	12.5	0.35
★	Quantum Value	111.2	1122	1.8	0.9	-10.3	7.1	7.8	9.4	0.24
★	UTI Value	156.1	9573	1.5	1.0	-6.8	9.9	9.3	12.1	0.28
-	Groww Value	26.4	74	2.1	0.8	-2.4	10.0	9.2	8.9	0.26
-	Sundaram Value	199.8	1284	1.9	1.4	-8.6	4.9	6.4	9.1	0.17
	EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS									
★★★★★	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	54.7	5134	1.6	0.6	5.8	18.5	15.2	15.3	0.37
★★★★★	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	395.8	13458	1.5	0.7	7.5	12.6	13.1	18.3	0.35
★★★★★	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	404.9	31735	1.3	0.8	-6.2	11.1	13.0	12.8	0.42
★★★★	Bandhan ELSS - Tax Saver	147.4	6965	1.6	0.6	-2.5	7.2	9.3	13.5	0.28
★★★★	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	158.9	1414	1.8	0.8	0.7	9.7	9.6	14.5	0.24
★★★★	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	130.2	16666	1.4	0.7	-5.7	10.4	9.9	13.1	0.29
★★★★	HDFC ELSS - Tax Saver	1292.2	15992	1.4	1.0	-9.0	10.6	12.3	12.0	0.42
★★★★	JM ELSS - Tax Saver	50.4	248	2.1	0.9	3.9	13.8	12.0	14.6	0.35
★★★★	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	47.2	26428	1.4	0.6	-3.4	9.6	8.8	14.7	0.25
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	94.2	930	2.0	0.9	0.1	12.3	9.5	11.7	0.27
★★★	Canara Robeco ELSS - Tax Saver	168.5	8725	1.5	0.5	-3.5	8.9	8.0	13.2	0.22
★★★	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	108.6	462	2.1	0.7	-0.6	10.2	9.2	11.1	0.27
★★★	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1343.6	6223	1.6	0.9	-7.7	8.2	9.5	11.2	0.29
★★★	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	135.8	4229	1.6	1.0	1.1	13.8	11.5	12.3	0.31
★★★	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	887.9	14286	1.5	1.0	-5.5	9.2	8.3	11.4	0.25
★★★	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	112.2	6384	1.6	0.6	-2.1	8.7	9.8	12.6	0.27
★★★	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	124.4	14718	1.5	0.9	-2.7	10.1	10.2	9.6	0.30
★★★	Tata ELSS - Tax Saver	44.4	4747	1.6	0.7	0.9	10.0	10.0	12.3	0.31
★★★	Union ELSS Tax Saver	62.8	872	2.0	1.2	-3.2	8.3	8.6	11.7	0.24
★★	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	120.8	2764	1.7	0.7	-3.0	10.0	7.9	12.0	0.21
★★	Mahi Manu ELSS Tax Saver	25.8	895	2.0	0.7	-8.8	5.0	6.7	-	0.17
★★	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	33.1	722	2.0	0.8	-3.6	6.6	7.6	11.3	0.22
★★	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	110.5	210	1.8	0.8	-10.2	7.0	7.8	9.5	0.24
★★	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	467.1	1285	1.9	1.4	-8.1	6.5	7.7	11.2	0.22
★★	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	189.1	3482	1.7	0.8	-7.0	5.9	5.6	10.4	0.13
★	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	57.9	14543	1.5	0.8	-4.1	8.6	6.4	9.1	0.17
★	Axis ELSS - Tax Saver	92.0	32667	1.3	0.7	-3.5	8.5	4.1	10.8	0.07
★	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	141.4	1021	1.9	0.9	-6.7	7.4	7.1	10.5	0.19
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	17.9	52	2.1	0.8	-9.7	6.1	5.9	-	0.14
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	19.5	48	2.1	0.7	-5.9	4.0	4.5	-	0.08
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	179.4	72	2.1	1.6	-2.2	9.4	9.6	11.9	0.29
	EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS									
-	Invesco India Contra	127.5	20644	1.4	0.5	-4.4	11.5	10.8	13.9	0.32
-	Kotak Contra	145.0	5511	1.6	0.6	-3.6	12.1	11.8	14.4	0.36
-	SBI Contra	357.7	47589	1.3	0.6	-5.3	8.5	12.9	14.1	0.46
	EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS									
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Consumption	178.8	2452	1.7	0.6	-11.2	6.5	9.5	11.5	0.29
★★★★★	Tata India Consumer	44.8	2901	1.7	0.6	-0.1	11.4	10.9	14.5	0.32
★★★★	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	87.4	4742	1.6	0.4	-8.3	7.7	9.7	13.7	0.27
★★★★	SBI Consumption Opport	265.4	2827	1.7	0.8	-13.8	2.9	9.4	12.3	0.27
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	194.4	6085	1.6	0.7	-10.8	6.0	7.3	11.7	0.19
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas India Cons	28.5	1454	1.8	0.6	-10.7	6.7	7.9	-	0.21
★★★	Canara Robeco Consumption	100.9	1987	1.8	0.7	-8.0	7.7	8.9	13.3	0.24
★★★	ICICI Pru Bharat Consumption	23.4	3238	1.7	1.0	-9.2	7.0	10.1	-	0.34
★★	Mahi Manu Consumption	20.5	489	2.1	0.7	-10.6	6.6	8.6	-	0.24
★★	UTI India Consumer	53.4	733	2.0	1.3	-9.2	7.2	6.6	9.8	0.17
★	Sundaram Consumption	89.0	1516	1.8	1.1	-9.5	6.5	8.9	10.1	0.26
	EQUITY - THEMATIC - INFRASTRUCTURE FUNDS									
★★★★★	BOI AXA Manufacturing & Infra	65.3	949	1.9	0.6	15.0	19.2	18.7	17.8	0.52
★★★★★	Quant Infrastructure	39.7	3164	1.7	0.7	5.1	14.9	15.3	18.6	0.39
★★★★	DSP India T.I.G.E.R.	344.4	6467	1.6	0.7	10.6	17.5	19.2	16.4	0.54
★★★★	ICICI Pru Infrastructure	192.3	8558	1.5	1.0	-1.2	15.1	19.0	16.6	0.66
★★★★	Invesco India Infrastructure	65.3	1548	1.8	0.8	4.4	16.4	16.5	17.0	0.44
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Infrastructure	105.5	1251	1.9	1.1	11.4	15.1	16.1	14.0	0.43
★★★	Bandhan Infrastructure	47.1	1433	1.8	0.8	-4.8	13.0	14.8	14.6	0.35
★★★	Canara Robeco Infrastructure	158.2	987	1.9	0.8	-1.4	15.8	17.1	14.4	0.50
★★★	Franklin Build India	134.6	3152	1.7	0.8	-4.4	13.0	16.0	15.3	0.48
★★★	Kotak Infra & Economic Reform	67.9	2493	1.7	0.6	5.1	13.8	16.2	14.5	0.44
★★★	LIC MF Infrastructure	53.2	1174	1.9	0.7	7.5	20.9	20.0	16.2	0.51
★★★	Tata Infrastructure	173.5	2022	1.8	1.0	2.3	10.6	14.4	13.8	0.39
★★	HSBC Infrastructure	49.3	2466	1.7	0.9	6.6	13.5	16.2	15.0	0.43
★★	SBI Infrastructure	47.9	4810	1.6	0.9	-0.4	10.8	14.3	14.2	0.42
★★	Sundaram Infra Advantage	95.4	971	1.9	1.5	1.2	13.2

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Month *Ann	3 Month *Ann	6 Month *Ann	1 Year CAGR	AA & Below
-	360 ONE Liquid	2165.4	629	0.3	0.2	6.0	5.9	6.4	6.2	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Liquid	454.3	69830	0.3	0.2	6.0	6.0	6.8	6.4	-
-	Axis Liquid	3141.2	63343	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.1	6.5	6.5	-
-	Bandhan Liquid	3402.8	20198	0.2	0.1	5.4	5.9	6.4	6.3	-
-	Bank of India Liquid	3250.1	1825	0.1	0.1	5.6	6.1	6.5	6.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3240.2	13194	0.2	0.1	5.5	6.0	6.4	6.4	0.60
-	Canara Robeco Liquid	3393.8	6783	0.2	0.1	5.5	6.0	6.4	6.4	-
-	DSP Liquid	4027.5	27920	0.2	0.1	5.5	6.0	6.5	6.4	0.60
-	Edelweiss Liquid	3608.0	13272	0.2	0.1	5.5	6.1	6.6	6.5	-
-	Groww Liquid	2727.2	381	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.0	6.4	6.4	-
-	HDFC Liquid	5530.0	71323	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.0	6.4	6.4	-
-	HSBC Liquid	2811.0	20975	0.2	0.1	5.4	6.0	6.4	6.4	-
-	ICICI Pru Liquid	417.1	62798	0.3	0.2	5.6	6.0	6.4	6.4	-
-	Invesco India Liquid	3877.1	20748	0.2	0.1	5.6	6.1	6.5	6.4	-
-	ITI Liquid	1463.8	52	0.2	0.1	5.2	5.6	6.0	6.0	-
-	JM Liquid	76.8	1743	0.2	0.1	5.4	6.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	Kotak Liquid	5696.2	49073	0.3	0.1	5.3	5.9	6.4	6.3	-
-	LIC MF Liquid	5096.4	17484	0.2	0.1	5.4	6.0	6.4	6.4	-
-	Mahi Manu Liquid	1835.2	1392	0.2	0.1	5.5	6.1	6.5	6.4	-
-	Mirae Asset Liquid	2953.3	17359	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.0	6.6	6.3	-
-	Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.8	1015	0.4	0.2	5.5	5.6	6.1	5.9	-
-	Navi Liquid	30.4	74	0.3	0.2	4.9	5.3	5.6	5.7	-
-	Nippon Ind Liquid	6879.2	43125	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.0	6.5	6.4	-
-	Parag Parikh Liquid	1563.0	6722	0.2	0.1	5.4	6.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	PGIM India Liquid	367.2	1031	0.2	0.1	5.5	6.0	6.5	6.4	-
-	Quant Liquid	44.3	1426	0.5	0.3	5.5	5.6	5.8	5.8	-
-	Quantum Liquid	37.5	543	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.7	5.8	5.8	-
-	SBI Liquid	4404.3	92192	0.3	0.2	5.6	6.0	6.4	6.4	-
-	Sundaram Liquid	2485.4	9094	0.3	0.1	5.2	6.2	6.5	6.3	-
-	Tata Liquid	4438.9	32370	0.3	0.2	5.6	6.0	6.4	6.4	-
-	TRUSTMF Liquid	1368.5	1203	0.2	0.1	5.4	6.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	Union Liquid	2713.4	7578	0.2	0.1	5.4	6.0	6.5	6.4	-
-	UTI Liquid	462.7	29218	0.2	0.1	5.4	6.0	6.4	6.4	-
-	WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1514.9	743	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.1	6.6	6.3	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Month *Ann	3 Month *Ann	6 Month *Ann	1 Year CAGR	AA & Below
-	Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1480.8	10464	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	Axis Overnight	1457.2	11325	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	Bandhan Overnight	1462.0	1160	0.1	0.0	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
-	Bank of India Overnight	1402.1	109	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.5	5.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1445.0	852	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	Canara Robeco Overnight	1425.1	737	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	DSP Overnight	1471.5	2854	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Edelweiss Overnight	1424.0	192	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	Franklin Ind Overnight	1436.6	685	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Groww Overnight	1413.6	12	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.8	4.9	5.0	-
-	HDFC Overnight	4051.8	12190	0.2	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	HSBC Overnight	1433.8	4535	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	ICICI Pru Overnight	1479.5	14368	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Invesco India Overnight	1391.4	343	0.1	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	ITI Overnight	1387.5	14	0.2	0.1	4.6	4.6	4.7	4.9	-
-	JM Overnight	1393.0	148	0.1	0.1	4.6	4.7	4.8	5.0	-
-	Kotak Overnight	1464.2	8618	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
-	LIC MF Overnight	1420.7	732	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
-	Mahi Manu Overnight	1420.1	77	0.1	0.1	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	Mirae Asset Overnight	1408.1	1727	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Nippon Ind Overnight	147.4	8548	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	PGIM India Overnight	1417.7	153	0.1	0.1	4.7	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	SBI Overnight	4431.3	23407	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Sundaram Overnight	1457.2	1335	0.1	0.1	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.1	-
-	Tata Overnight	1446.5	4571	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
-	Union Overnight	1444.3	411	0.2	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	UTI Overnight	3740.5	5648	0.1	0.1	4.8	5.0	5.1	5.2	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below (%)
-	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.5	27237	0.9	0.3	2.3	5.3	5.8	6.0	-
-	Axis Arbitrage	20.1	10594	0.9	0.3	2.2	5.2	5.7	6.0	-
-	Bandhan Arbitrage	34.7	7796	0.9	0.3	2.2	5.1	5.5	5.7	-
-	Bank of India Arbitrage	14.7	134	0.9	0.4	3.2	5.2	5.3	5.6	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.2	1055	1.0	0.3	1.5	4.8	5.1	5.5	-
-	DSP Arbitrage	16.0	6673	0.8	0.3	2.2	5.1	5.6	5.8	-
-	Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.8	14849	0.9	0.3	2.4	5.2	5.8	6.0	-
-	HDFC Arbitrage	32.9	25509	0.8	0.3	2.3	5.4	5.9	6.1	-
-	HSBC Arbitrage	20.4	3288	0.8	0.2	2.0	5.2	5.6	6.0	-
-	ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.9	34850	0.8	0.3	2.4	5.5	5.9	6.1	-
-	Invesco India Arbitrage	34.3	30618	0.9	0.3	2.6	5.7	6.0	6.2	-
-	ITI Arbitrage	13.9	63	0.8	0.2	3.1	5.2	4.9	5.8	-
-	JM Arbitrage	34.9	482	0.9	0.4	1.9	5.2	5.3	5.6	-
-	Kotak Arbitrage	40.3	75712	0.8	0.3	2.4	5.5	5.9	6.1	-
-	LIC MF Arbitrage	14.8	310	0.7	0.2	2.8	5.6	5.9	6.0	-
-	Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.2	134	1.0	0.3	1.8	4.8	5.2	5.4	-
-	Mirae Asset Arbitrage	14.0	3838	0.8	0.1	2.9	5.6	5.7	5.9	-
-	Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.5	17533	0.9	0.3	2.4	5.2	5.8	6.0	-
-	PGIM India Arbitrage	19.7	99	0.9	0.3	2.8	5.4	5.7	5.8	-
-	SBI Arbitrage	36.3	47283	0.8	0.3	2.2	5.3	5.7	6.0	-
-	Sundaram Arbitrage	15.5	554	0.8	0.2	2.1	5.1	5.8	6.0	-
-	Tata Arbitrage	15.4	24950	0.9	0.3	2.5	5.2	5.7	6.0	-
-	Union Arbitrage	15.1	221	0.9	0.3	2.5	5.7	5.9	6.0	-
-	UTI Arbitrage	37.7	11132	0.8	0.3	2.5	5.4	5.8	6.0	-

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TERM FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below (%)
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Ultra Short Term	593.1	18819	0.5	0.3	6.3	7.1	7.2	6.6	9.15
★★★★★	Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Term	1667.8	666	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.5	-
★★★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short-Term	1415.5	2066	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.2	6.5	11.75
★★★★	Bandhan Ultra Short Term	16.4	4180	0.4	0.2	6.3	6.8	7.0	6.3	-
★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short Term	1463.6	3628	0.3	0.1	6.4	6.8	7.0	6.3	-
★★★★	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.9	15974	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.8	7.0	6.3	8.04
★★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Term	4345.5	12447	0.9	0.3	6.2	6.6	6.8	6.2	19.81
★★★	Axis Ultra Short Term	15.8	6074	1.1	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.6	5.9	10.15
★★★	DSP Ultra Short Term	3661.2	4599	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.9	6.54
★★★	HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.3	17465	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.9	6.2	9.03
★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short Term	2908.4	1497	0.7	0.2	6.2	6.7	6.9	6.1	4.68
★★★	Kotak Ultra Short Term	46.2	15962	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.7	6.1	7.15
★★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Term	1483.7	222	0.6	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.2	2.03
★★★	SBI Ultra Short Term	6448.5	11880	0.5	0.3	6.2	6.7	6.9	6.3	10.96
★★★	Tata Ultra Short Term	15.3	6495	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.5	6.6	5.9	9.97
★★★	UTI Ultra Short Term	4561.0	3348	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.7	6.0	11.61
★★★	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Term	1462.2	584	0.7	0.2	5.8	6.3	6.4	5.7	-
★★	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3398.8	184	0.9	0.4	5.9	6.3	6.4	5.8	-
★★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4082.2	582	0.8	0.3	5.9	6.3	6.5	5.7	-
★★	LIC MF Ultra Short Term	1418.7	678	1.2	0.2	5.8	6.3	6.4	5.7	2.26
★★	PGIM India Ultra Short Term	36.5	211	0.8	0.3	5.6	6.2	6.4	5.8	-
★	ITI Ultra Short Term	1325.0	165	0.8	0.2	5.7	6.1	6.2	5.6	-
★	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.6	524	1.0	0.2	5.3	5.5	5.7	5.1	-
★	Sundaram Ultra Short Term	2866.0	2416	1.3	0.2	5.3	5.8	6.0	5.4	1.28

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT TO SHORT TERM FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below (%)
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Ultra Short to ST	587.7	21047	0.5	0.4	6.2	7.0	7.3	6.5	6.09
★★★★★	UTI Ultra Short to ST	3828.5	2680	0.4	0.3	6.0	6.9	7.1	6.5	7.12
★★★★	Axis Ultra Short to ST	3334.9	4558	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.9	7.1	6.3	7.59
★★★★	Bandhan Ultra Short to ST	41.5	6404	0.6	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.8	6.1	-
★★★★	HDFC Ultra Short to ST	62.0	17793	0.9	0.4	5.5	6.5	6.7	6.1	11.75
★★★★	HSBC Ultra Short to ST	30.9	875	0.8	0.3	5.8	7.3	7.3	6.4	7.56
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Ultra Short to ST	701.9	9727	1.0	0.4	5.2	6.2	6.5	5.9	7.94
★★★	Canara Robeco Ultra Short to ST	45.4	1111	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.7	6.9	6.2	-
★★★	DSP Ultra Short to ST	21.3	4750	0.5	0.3	5.6	6.5	6.8	6.1	-
★★★	Invesco India Ultra Short to ST	4065.3	1833	0.5	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.9	6.1	7.20
★★★	JM Ultra Short to ST	39.8	215	0.7	0.3	5.6	6.6	6.8	6.0	3.48
★★★	Mirae Asset Ultra Short to ST	2425.0	2434	0.7	0.2	5.6	6.5	6.7	6.0	6.15
★★★	Nippon Ind Ultra Short to ST	4024.7	7933	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.6	6.8	6.1	5.09
★★★	Tata Ultra Short to ST	4234.4	2871	0.5	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.9	6.2	4.04
★★	Kotak Ultra Short to ST	3581.7	12093	1.0	0.3	5.4	6.4	6.6	5.9	8.77
★★	LIC MF Ultra Short to ST	42.5	2010	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.5	6.7	5.9	5.21
★★	Mahi Manu Ultra Short to ST	1753.2	535	0.9	0.3	5.5	6.4	6.6	5.9	12.86
★★	SBI Ultra Short to ST	3743.0	11622	0.8	0.4	5.4	6.4	6.7	6.0	4.62
★	Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short to ST	43.0	382	0.9	0.2	5.5	6.3	6.5	5.8	-
★	Sundaram Ultra Short to ST	3697.5	446	1.0	0.3	5.2	6.2	6.5	5.9	1.42

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Money Market	4493.3	23624	0.3	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.3	6.7	-
★★★★★	UTI Money Market	3341.3	19468	0.2	0.1	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.7	-
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Money Market	400.8	29877	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.6	-
★★★★	Axis Money Market	1550.3	21405	0.3	0.1	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.6	-
★★★★	Kotak Money Market	4861.9	29764	0.3	0.1	6.4	7.0	7.2	6.6	-
★★★★	Tata Money Market	5112.9	34511	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.6	-
★★★	Baroda BNPP Money Market	1491.6	3626	0.3	0.1	6.3	7.0	7.0	6.3	-
★★★	Franklin Ind Money Market	54.3	3937	0.2	0.1	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.5	-
★★★	HDFC Money Market	6187.0	33192	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.2	6.6	-
★★★	HSBC Money Market	28.5	6993	0.3	0.1	6.3	6.9	7.1	6.3	-
★★★	ICICI Pru Money Market	410.9	36529	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.6	-
★★★	Sundaram Money Market	16.2	1719	0.3	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.1	6.4	-
★★	DSP Money Market	56.9	10992	0.4	0.2	6.3	6.8	7.0	6.2	-
★★	Invesco India Money Market	3290.3	6607	0.4	0.1	6.2	6.8	7.0	6.2	-
★★	PGIM India Money Market	1431.9	125	0.3	0.1	6.1	6.7	6.9	6.2	-
★★	SBI Money Market	44.7	32208	0.5	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.8	6.2	-
★	Bandhan Money Market	43.6	15338	0.3	0.1	6.4	7.0	7.0	6.2	-
★	Edelweiss Money Market	30.6	2322	0.6	0.1	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.8	-

DEBT - SHORT TERMS FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Short Term	64.4	19403	0.9	0.4	5.2	6.6	7.1	6.4	7.01
★★★★★	UTI Short Term	33.7	1798	0.7	0.3	4.6	6.1	6.8	6.0	4.98
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Short Term	50.7	5782	0.8	0.3	4.8	6.3	6.9	6.1	7.86
★★★★	Axis Short Term	33.1	7501	0.8	0.3	5.1	6.7	7.1	6.1	8.54
★★★★	HDFC Short Term	34.2	14486	0.6	0.3	4.9	6.4	7.1	6.2	8.05
★★★★	Sundaram Short Term	47.1	178	0.7	0.2	4.8	6.1	6.8	6.0	2.81
★★★	Bandhan Short Term	61.2	8731	0.7	0.3	5.6	6.6	7.2	6.0	-
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Short Term	31.1	431	0.9	0.4	4.6	6.2	6.7	5.8	22.46
★★★	DSP Short Term	49.3	3235	0.8	0.3	4.3	5.9	6.5	5.6	-
★★★	HSBC Short Term	28.2	3870	0.6	0.3	4.6	6.3	6.8	5.7	-
★★★	Kotak Short Term	55.2	14436	1.0	0.3	4.4	5.9	6.6	5.6	-
★★★	Nippon Ind Short Term	56.2	6557	0.8	0.3	4.7	6.4	7.0	6.0	5.58
★★★	SBI Short Term	34.1	13435	0.7	0.4	4.4	6.2	6.7	5.9	7.75
★★	Canara Robeco Short Term	26.9	284	0.9	0.3	4.5	5.8	6.3	5.4	-
★★	Invesco India Short Term	3770.1	575	0.9	0.3	4.1	5.9	6.6	5.5	4.85
★★	Mirae Asset Short Term	16.6	518	0.9	0.2	3.9	5.8	6.4	5.5	0.96
★★	Tata Short Term	50.5	2926	1.0	0.3	4.1	5.6	6.2	5.4	-
★	Groww Short Term	2213.3	95	0.9	0.3	4.6	6.1	6.5	5.1	-
★	LIC MF Short Term	15.4	124	1.0	0.3	4.4	5.9	6.5	5.3	8.24
-	Bank of India Short Term	28.4	260	1.0	0.5	4.5	6.8	7.0	10.3	-
-	Mahi Manu Short Term	13.5	81	1.1	0.3	4.6	6.0	6.6	5.6	11.59

DEBT - MEDIUM TERM FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Medium Term	16.9	147	0.9	0.4	5.2	7.5	7.7	6.2	32.41
★★★★	Axis Medium Term	30.1	2112	1.1	0.6	5.6	7.0	7.6	6.6	52.78
★★★★	ICICI Pru Medium Term	48.5	5419	1.2	0.6	6.0	7.4	7.7	6.6	31.20
★★★	HDFC Medium Term	60.3	3599	1.1	0.6	5.5	6.5	7.1	6.0	35.57
★★★	Kotak Medium Term	24.5	1926	1.4	0.6	5.2	6.8	7.8	6.3	39.49
★★★	SBI Medium Term	54.8	6489	1.1	0.6	5.7	6.6	7.1	6.2	41.03
★★	DSP Medium Term	86.2	251	0.7	0.3	3.7	5.8	6.6	5.7	-
★★	HSBC Medium Term	21.7	684	0.9	0.3	4.4	6.1	6.9	5.8	28.82
★	Bandhan Medium Term	48.6	1250	1.2	0.6	5.1	5.9	6.7	5.3	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Medium Term	43.7	3319	1.3	0.7	7.6	10.1	9.7	11.8	31.22
-	Sundaram Medium Term	71.4	33	1.6	1.0	2.4	4.1	5.0	3.9	3.07
-	UTI Medium Term	19.1	36	1.3	0.7	3.6	5.1	6.0	5.2	13.79

DEBT - MEDIUM TO LONG TERM FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below
★★★★★	UTI Medium to Long Term	75.9	305	1.4	1.1	3.0	4.4	5.8	6.6	10.93
★★★★	ICICI Pru Medium to Long Term	42.0	2048	0.9	0.5	3.6	5.2	6.5	5.7	-
★★★★	SBI Medium to Long Term	73.6	2046	1.3	0.7	3.4	4.6	6.0	5.4	29.69
★★★	ABSL Medium to Long Term	128.9	1770	1.0	0.6	2.3	3.8	5.6	4.9	-
★★★	Kotak Medium to Long Term	79.5	1784	1.4	0.6	3.0	4.1	5.9	4.9	-
★★★	LIC MF Medium to Long Term	75.6	175	0.5	0.2	3.9	5.2	6.4	5.5	-
★★★	Nippon Ind Medium to Long Term	92.6	329	1.3	0.6	3.0	3.9	5.7	5.0	-
★★	Bandhan Medium to Long Term	67.9	429	1.7	0.8	4.8	4.3	5.9	4.6	-
★★	HDFC Medium to Long Term	60.2	830	1.2	0.7	2.9	4.2	6.1	4.8	-
★	Canara Robeco Med to Long Term	56.7	111	1.6	0.7	1.8	3.2	5.0	4.1	-
-	HSBC Medium to Long Term	43.5	49	1.1	0.5	2.7	4.0	5.6	4.3	-
-	JM Medium to Long Term	64.0	30	0.9	0.5	2.3	4.4	5.9	4.7	-

DEBT - LONG TERM FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below
-	ICICI Pru Long Term	91.1	832	0.8	0.4	0.9	3.4	5.8	4.7	-
-	Nippon Ind Nivesh Lakshya LT	18.0	6112	0.6	0.3	0.4	2.3	5.6	5.0	-

DEBT - DYNAMIC TERM FUNDS

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%) Regular	Expense Ratio (%) Direct	Trailing Returns (%) 1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	AA & Below
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Dynamic Term	49.0	1422	1.0	0.6	4.7	5.6	7.0	6.6	23.61
★★★★★	UTI Dynamic Term	32.4	401	1.5	0.7	4.1	5.0	6.3	6.8	-
★★★★	360 ONE Dynamic Term	24.0	559	0.5	0.3	4.5	6.4	7.6	6.5	4.48
★★★★	ICICI Pru Dynamic Term	39.0	13163	1.1	0.5	4.1	5.8	6.7	6.2	16.16
★★★★	Quantum Dynamic Term	22.1	84	0.8	0.4	2.3	4.1	6.2	5.7	-
★★★	Axis Dynamic Term	31.5	993	0.5	0.3	5.5	5.9	7.0	5.8	-
★★★	HDFC Dynamic Term	92.6	495	1.2	0.6	3.1	3.9	5.8	4.9	-
★★★	HSBC Dynamic Term	30.6	121	0.7	0.2	2.5	4.1	6.0	5.1	-
★★★	Kotak Dynamic Term	39.5	2342	1.1	0.5	4.4	4.8	6.9	5.6	4.03
★★★	Nippon Ind Dynamic Term	39.2	3875	0.6	0.3	4.0	5.6	6.7	5.7	-
★★★	SBI Dynamic Term	37.6	3553	1.2	0.5	4.5	4.8	6.6	5.9	-
★★	Bandhan Dynamic Term	35.8	1926

CHENNAI
businessline.portfolio
SUNDAY - OCTOBER 4 - 2026

AI Express to expand capacity with aircraft transfers, retrofits

FLEET OPTIMISATION. Tata's low-cost carrier eyes 110-aircraft fleet by mid-Oct

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi



WINTER-READY. Air India Express is expanding its fleet and seating capacity ahead of its winter schedule, with 110 aircraft expected by mid-October 2026 and 50 Boeing 737-8 MAX aircraft due for retrofit by March 2027 REUTERS

Tata Group-promoted Air India Express (AIX) is expanding its fleet through aircraft transfers from Air India and adding seating capacity through a retrofit programme as it prepares for an expanded winter schedule across domestic and short-haul international markets, sources told *businessline*.

As part of the Air India Group's fleet optimisation exercise, Air India transferred six Airbus aircraft to the low-cost carrier in August and September, sources said. Four more aircraft are scheduled to join its fleet.

Air India Express is consequently set to have 110 aircraft by mid-October, providing additional capacity for its winter schedule.

The fleet will comprise Boeing 737 MAX, Boeing 737 NG, Airbus A320neo, A320ceo and A321neo aircraft.

RETROFIT PROGRAMME

Besides fleet additions, the airline is on track to complete the retrofit of 50 Boeing 737-8 MAX aircraft by March 2027, sources said. The programme is expected to add seating capacity equivalent to nearly four additional aircraft.

While the aircraft transfers will support the expanded schedule from October, the retrofit programme will add further capacity as it progresses towards completion.

OPERATIONS TAKE OVER

The Group's network realignment will see Air India Express take over operations at seven stations in September, including locations previously served by Air India, sources said. These are Aurangabad, Bhopal, Coimbatore, Tirupati, Jamnagar, Jodhpur and Madurai.

The transfer of aircraft and station operations is expected to expand Air India Express' domestic footprint, while allowing Air India to sharpen its focus on full-service and long-haul operations.

Air India Express currently operates more than 500 daily flights, connecting 48 domestic and 16 international destinations across South, South-East and West Asia. The airline has a fleet of more than 100 Boeing 737 and Airbus A320 aircraft.

Noel Tata questions 3rd term for Chandra, seeks minutes of Tata Sons Sept 17 board meet

Our Bureau
Mumbai



Noel Tata, Chairman, Tata Trusts

Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata has once again questioned N Chandrasekaran's re-appointment as the Chairman of Tata Sons in a letter to its board members. He has also asked for a video recording and minutes of the September 17 Tata Sons board meeting that approved a third term for Chandrasekaran.

The board had voted 4:1 in favour of Chandrasekaran's re-appointment with Noel Tata the sole dissenter.

In his letter, Noel Tata said the agenda for Chairman's re-appointment was not circulated in advance, but brought before the board as a debrief from the Nomination and Remuneration Committee.

LEGAL OPINION

Noel Tata had attended the September 17 meeting armed with a legal opinion from former Chief Justice of India DY Chandrachud, which said the chairman's appointment requires an affirmative vote of majority of Tata Trusts' nominee directors. It also said that the Tata Sons chairman's casting vote can't defeat Trusts' veto.

In the meeting, while Tata Trusts' nominee Venu Srinivasan voted in favour of re-appointment, Noel Tata had voted against the proposal. Harish Manwani, as the acting chairman for the re-appointment resolution, exercised the casting vote in favour.

Noel Tata had called Chandrasekaran's re-appointment illegal and said the resolution was not validly passed. Subsequently, on September 18, he wrote to board members pointing out procedural flaws in the approval process.

In response, Tata Sons cited legal opinions of former Supreme Court Judges UU Lalit and BN Srikrishna to support its claims.

In his latest letter, Noel Tata also questioned the board's decision to obtain a *post facto* validation for its decision by obtaining legal opinions of two retired judges.



'91% of Mumbai's traffic not hit by T1 redevelopment'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Ninety-one per cent of Mumbai airport's passenger traffic will remain unaffected when Mumbai International Airport Ltd begins the partial redevelopment of Terminal 1 from January 2027, Arun Bansal, CEO of Adani Airports Holdings Ltd (AAHL), said on Saturday in a statement.

"Only the north section of Terminal 1B, which accounts for around one-third of Terminal 1's capacity, is being demolished in Phase 1 to minimise passenger inconvenience and operational disruption," Bansal said.

He said 91 per cent of the airport's passenger traffic would remain unaffected during the redevelopment of the ageing infrastructure. The temporary transition of some operations to Navi Mumbai International Airport would not represent a permanent shift of traffic from Mumbai airport, he added.

FSSAI finds Nestle's low-fat dairy whitener sample substandard, halts sale

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi



The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) on Saturday said a sample of Nestlé India's "low-fat dairy whitener" collected from Hotel Lalit was found to be "unsafe and substandard". It has directed the hotel, located in Connaught Place, New Delhi, to immediately stop the sale of the identified product. The FSSAI has also sent a communication to Nestlé India.

The company said its low-fat dairy whitener is safe for consumption and complies with regulatory requirements, adding that it has shared data with the authorities.

In a social media post on Saturday, the food regulator said its lab had declared the sample collected from Bharat Hotels (The Lalit), New Delhi, "...'substandard' and 'unsafe', indicating non-compliance under the Food Safety and Standards (FSS) Act, 2006." A copy of the laboratory report was provided to the food business operator (FBO) for action. The FSSAI also issued a notice to Bharat Hotels.

NESTLE DENIAL

A Nestlé India spokesperson said the company's low-fat dairy whitener is safe to consume and complies with all regulatory requirements. "Phosphorus is a nutrient that occurs naturally in milk and is therefore present in all milk-based products. FSSAI lab reports reflect total phosphorus against the additive limit, without accounting for the substantial natural phosphorus contribution from milk-based ingredients," the spokesperson said.

"Our product is in full compliance for added phosphorus as per prescribed limits, including on an as-consumed basis."

"We have shared data across other same/similar milk-based products in the category to reflect presence of naturally occurring phosphorus," the spokesperson said.

SILVER PUTT



GOLF GLORY. Silver medallists India's Diksha Dagar, Pranavi Urs and Aditi Ashok celebrate during the women's team medal ceremony at the 2026 Asian Games. The trio made history by winning India's first-ever woman's team golf medal, finishing with a combined score of 14-under 546, behind gold-winners China (22-under 538). Pranavi Urs also became the first Indian to win an individual golf gold REUTERS

US slaps visa bonds on 50 countries, exempts India

Asian News International
Washington DC

The US has designated 50 countries whose citizens face visa bonds reaching up to $20,000 for tourist and business visas, but exempted India from the mandate while encompassing South Asian nations such as Bangladesh, Bhutan and Nepal.

On Friday, the State Department released a revised list of nations whose nationals must post financial bonds upon qualifying for B1/B2 visas.

Under this programme, individuals travelling on passports from the specified countries are required to deposit bonds valued at $10,000, $15,000 or $20,000, with the exact figure fixed by a consular official during the visa interview, according to the State Department.

Holders of Indian passports remain exempt from this obligation. As detailed by the State Department index, Nepal and Bangladesh have faced the mandate since January 21, whereas Bhutan was incorporated beginning January 1.

Additional nations spanning Africa, the Caribbean, Central Asia and the Pacific are similarly featured.

SoftBank-backed Starfish raises ₹88 crore from AceVector IPO

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

SoftBank-backed Starfish I Pte Ltd emerged the biggest beneficiary among selling shareholders in Snapdeal parent AceVector's ₹420-crore initial public offering (IPO), securing about ₹88.3 crore through the offer-for-sale (OFS) component.

Starfish, AceVector's largest shareholder, sold 2.76 crore shares at the IPO's upper price of ₹32 apiece, accounting for roughly two-thirds of the total OFS proceeds. According to AceVector's red herring prospectus (RHP), the shares sold represented a 0.08x return multiple.

Starfish will continue to hold 11.3 crore shares in AceVector post the IPO, worth about ₹361.8 crore at the issue price.

AceVector, the parent of e-commerce marketplace Snapdeal and e-commerce enablement platform Unicommerce, raised ₹287 crore through a fresh issue, while existing shareholders offered up to 4.16 crore shares through the OFS. At ₹32 a share, the issue valued the company at about ₹1,741 crore.

The IPO, which closed on September 29, was subscribed 4.93 times, with the company set to list on the BSE and NSE on October 5.

NEXUS' VARIED RETURNS

Nexus Venture Partners also secured a partial exit through multiple investment vehicles, though the returns varied significantly across funds.

Nexus India Direct Investments II sold 73.9 lakh shares for ₹23.6 crore, representing a 1.03x return multiple. The fund will retain three crore shares, worth about ₹96.7 crore at the IPO price.

Nexus Opportunity Fund sold 8.4 lakh shares for ₹2.6 crore at a 0.14x return multiple, while Nexus Ventures III sold 4.6 lakh shares for ₹1.4 crore, translating into a 0.07x multiple.

OTHER SELLERS

Other selling shareholders included FIH Business Global, Rupen Investment and Industries and Centaurus Trading and Investments. FIH sold 17.4 lakh shares for ₹5.6 crore, while Rupen Investment and Centaurus each sold 2.7 lakh shares for about ₹86 lakh.

AceVector intends to use the fresh capital primarily for marketing, technology infrastructure, acquisitions.

It reported a consolidated loss of ₹60.7 crore in FY26, while revenue from operations rose 29.2 per cent to ₹510.4 crore.

SEBI 'examining position limits for non-agri contracts to boost liquidity'

Press Trust of India
New Delhi



Tuhin Kanta Pandey, Chairman, SEBI

The market regulator is examining position limits for non-agricultural contracts to improve liquidity and depth without weakening risk controls, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Saturday.

Speaking about reforms in the commodity derivatives market, Pandey said the market design should allow contracts to gain scale. In some agricultural commodities, physical settlement from the outset can impede market development, and a phased approach could allow contracts to mature before physical settlement becomes mandatory.

He said SEBI has completed consultations on the matter and guidelines will follow. The regulator is also working to reduce structural friction in commodity markets, including engaging with stakeholders on GST-related issues affecting participants who give or receive commodities through exchange platforms.

Pandey said technology should serve the specific needs of commodity markets, which include producers, commercial users, farmers, processors and physical hedgers. "Technology can improve access and efficiency, but its design must reflect their needs while preserving fair access and market integrity," he said at an event organised by CPAI (Commodity and Capital Market Participants Association of India).

INVESTOR AWARENESS

On investor awareness, Pandey said SEBI will strengthen efforts under Project Jagrook to spread awareness about commodity derivatives among farmers, farmer producer organisations (FPOs), MSMEs, hedgers and other market users. "Access without understanding is not inclusion," he said, stressing the need for participants to understand both the utility and risks associated with commodity derivatives.

SEBI is also working towards deeper and more liquid cash markets, with wider participation, stronger securities borrowing and lending, and efficient hedging and arbitrage expected to improve price discovery and strengthen the interaction between cash and derivatives markets.

Pandey said simpler regulation should not mean weaker compliance, and robust controls over client funds, margins, reporting and supervision remain fundamental. "Trust and market integrity" must not be compromised, he added.

Last month, the SEBI board approved a proposal to allow foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) to participate in physically settled, non-agricultural commodity derivative contracts, subject to safeguards.

Hai An Lines connects Chennai with S-E Asian ports

Our Bureau
Chennai

Hai An Lines, a Vietnam-based container shipping and logistics company, has launched a service connecting Chennai with ports in China and Vietnam.

The service to Chennai commenced on Saturday, with 'Haian Beta' calling at the Chennai Port. The service rotation is Chennai-Port Klang West (Malaysia)-Haiphong (Vietnam)-Nansha (China).

The new service provides an additional regular maritime connectivity option between Chennai and Vietnam, while strengthening Chennai Port's links with key trade centres in Malaysia and South China, the company said in a release.

EXPANDING TRADE

India-Vietnam merchandise trade has continued to expand. According to the Embassy of India, Hanoi, citing Department of Commerce data, bilateral merchandise trade reached $18.29 billion in FY26, a 16 per cent increase year-on-year. India's exports to Vietnam stood at $6.67 billion, while imports were $11.62 billion, the release said.

Major Indian exports to Vietnam in FY26 included meat and meat products, aluminium, seafood, iron and steel, machinery and equipment, electrical equipment, cereals, animal-feed ingredients and auto components.

Imports from Vietnam included mobile phones and electronic items, machinery and equipment, iron and steel, copper, plastics, chemicals, coffee, tea, spices, aluminium and glass products.

The expanding India-Vietnam trade relationship offers scope for strengthening containerised trade through Chennai Port.

India and Vietnam have also agreed to explore practical measures to achieve a bilateral trade target of $25 billion by 2030, providing a broader framework for further expansion of commercial and maritime linkages, the release said.

'Digital technology is the key to sustainable economic growth'

Our Bureau
Chennai



Graduation day at SASTRA Deemed University

The Indian economic growth story balances environmental sustainability and is ahead of Paris Agreement targets by six years," said A Subramanian, Head of Strategy and Sustainability, Siemens India.

Delivering the graduation day address at SASTRA Deemed University, Subramanian stressed on the importance of responsible economic growth towards a sustainable environment and highlighted India as a global showcase in many ways as it emerges a vibrant emerging economy. He also stressed on the role of technology in sustainable growth with opportunities in asset-heavy industries.

Digital technology adoption in capital goods manufacturing, agriculture, transportation, power, etc., offers great potential for digital twins, industrial AI, decarbonisation platform, smart grids and additive manufacturing. He urged students to engage in a co-creator's digital economy to create scalable value.

EMERGING TECH

In his address, T Subramanian, CTO of BMW Techworks India, stressed on the emerging role of connected mobility and the role of emerging technologies in changing user preferences. He wanted today's graduates to immerse their theoretical skills to navigate the sweeping changes that transform automobile manufacturing globally and with the convergence of human and artificial intelligence take calculated risk without fear of failure.

Both the leaders from the industry presented degrees to over 1,000 graduates from the Schools of Electrical and Mechanical Engineering at SASTRA Deemed University.

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